ICTE3002
Human Computer Interface

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ASSIGNMENT 2
REPORT
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1. Introduction

HelpEra is a mobile application for mental health support which is designed for young adults and university students, offering features such as mood tracking, breathing exercises, community support, and emergency crisis resources. This report documents the usability testing and handoff process for the HelpEra high-fidelity prototype, building on the prototype developed in Assignment 1 by our team, UXplorers.

Following that, our team created a copy of the original protype and implemented the preliminary improvements based on tutor feedback. The primary purpose of the Assignment 2 is to conduct simulated usability testing with students as participants, analyse the results to identify further improvements, and implement those improvements before final handoff to developers.

1.1. Purpose of Usability Testing

As discussed in the Lecture 7, usability testing is an important step in development because designers cannot unlearn what they already know about their product. While we conducted extensive user research at the beginning of the design process (including personas, surveys, interviews, user journeys), evaluation must be iterative and involve users at the testing stage (Moran, 2019). The primary purpose of this assignment is to conduct simulated usability testing with students as participants, observe their behaviour as they perform specific tasks, collect data on their interactions, analyse the results to identify further improvements, and implement those improvements before final handoff to developers.

1.2. Ethical Considerations

In accordance with the guidelines from Lecture 7, all the participants will complete a Research Participation Agreement before testing. They will be informed that this is a student prototype, all data will be anonymised, no personal mental health details are required, they can stop at any time without any downsides. As our participants mostly consists of our peers, we acknowledge this limitation while striving to recruit individuals who match our target personas as closely as possible, following the principle that if target users are unavailable, we should choose people with similar knowledge and contextual understanding.

2. Usability Testing Plan

2.1. Research Goals

Based on the priority method from Nielsen Norman Group, we identified five key research goals for usability testing of our app, HelpEra:

Priority	Resrach Goals	Type	Rationale
High	Does the language/visuals feel supportive and non-triggering?	System Aspect	Mental health apps must maintain a sensitive, calming tone
Medium	Do users prefer additional features (guided prompts, report buttons)?	System Aspect	Informs design decisions for future iterations
High	How quickly can users find crisis resources from welcome screen?	System Aspect	Emergency situations require immediate access (this is critical safety feature)
Medium	How quickly/smoothly can users complete tasks?	User Aspect	Efficiency indicates learnability and reduces frustration
High	Can users complete core tasks without assistance?	User Aspect	Core functionality must be intuitive for first-time users

Table 1: Research Goals

2.2. Experimental Set-Up

The usability testing will be conducted as moderated, one-on-one sessions using a think-aloud protocol. Each session will last approximately 20-30 minutes.

Location:

Testing will take place in a quiet tutorial room on campus to minimize distractions and ensure consistent environmental conditions. For participants unable to attend in person, remote sessions will be conducted via Microsoft Teams with screen sharing enabled.

Device and Prototype Presentation:

Participants will interact with the HelpEra high-fidelity prototype on a mobile device provided by the research team. The Figma prototype will be accessed via a URL and displayed within a phone frame to simulate realistic mobile app usage. The prototype will be pre-loaded on the device before each session to avoid loading delays.

Environment Controls:

The room will be arranged with the participant and facilitator seated side-by-side to allow clear viewing of the screen while maintaining a comfortable, non-intimidating atmosphere. A secondary observer will sit slightly behind to take notes without distracting the participant.

2.3. Facilitator Role and Script

Facilitator:

Maria Waheed will serve as the primary facilitator for all testing sessions. The facilitator's role is to guide participants through the session while maintaining objectivity and avoiding leading questions or behaviours that could bias results.

Facilitator's Approach:

Maria will:

- Use only neutral prompts when participants get stuck
- Encourage continuous think-aloud verbalization
- Read tasks aloud from a standardized script

- Remain silent during task execution to avoid interference
- Avoid providing help unless the participant is completely stuck for 30-60 seconds

Facilitator's Script:

(Pre-Test Introduction)

"Thank you for participating today. We're testing our new app, called "HelpEra". It is amental health support app prototype. I want to emphasize that we are testing the app, not you. There are no wrong answers or incorrect ways to use the app.

As you work through the tasks, please think aloud, tell me what you are looking at, what you are trying to do, and what you expect to happen. This helps us understand your thought process.

I won't be able to help you during most tasks because we want to see how the app performs on its own. If you are completely stuck, I will step in. do you have any questions before we begin?"

(During Testing (Neutral Prompts)):

- "What are you thinking?"
- "What are you looking for right now?"
- "Keep talking through what you are seeing?"
- "What do you expect will happen if you tap that?"
- "That's okay, let me give you a small hint…" (only when participant is stuck for more than 30-60 seconds)

2.4. Task Scenarios and Tasks

The following tasks were designed to address our research goals:

Research Goals	Task Scenario	Task Instructions	What We Observe
Can users complete the core tasks?	"You have had a stressful day and want to check in with yourself."	Complete a daily mood check-in and submit how you are feeling.	Can they find the mood check-n? Do they understand the options?
Efficiency + Tone	"You want to track your thoughts and progress over time."	Create a new journal entry. Then find it in Journal History.	Do they know how to save? Can they find history?
Emergency Discoverability	"You are feeling emotionally distressed and need urgent help."	Locate emergency or crisis resources from the welcome screen	**Critical**: How many seconds to find help?
Efficiency + Task Completion	"You are feeling anxious and need to calm down quickly."	Find a guided breathing or relaxation exercise. Start and complete it.	Is breathing exercise discoverable? Do they complete it?
Tone + Feature Preferences	"You want to connect with others who understand."	Explore the community section and find a way to interact.	Is community discoverable? Do they know how to engage?

Table 2: Task Scenarios and Tasks

2.5. A/B Testing

To evaluate potential feature enhancements, we developed two alternative versions for key workflows. Participants will be randomly assigned to experience either Version A or B first (counterbalanced to avoid order effects).

Task	Version A	Version B
Community Interaction	Control: Standard community feed with posts and comments only	Variation: Community feed with added "Report" button for inappropriate content
Journal Entry	Control: Blank journal entry with mood selector	Variation: Guided journal prompts and mood trend graphs in history

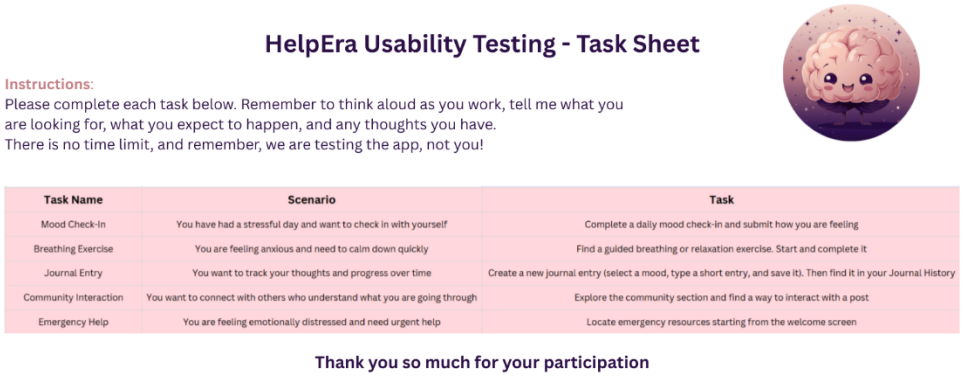
Table 3: A/B Testing Tasks

Hypothesis:

Added guided journal prompts, mood visualization, and community reporting features will increase user satisfaction and task completion rates without adding cognitive load, as measured by post-task ratings and error rates.

2.6. Task Sheet

This sheet will be given to participants or read aloud by the facilitator (Maria):



HelpEra Usability Testing - Task Sheet

Instructions:
Please complete each task below. Remember to think aloud as you work, tell me what you are looking for, what you expect to happen, and any thoughts you have.
There is no time limit, and remember, we are testing the app, not you!

Task Name	Scenario	Task
Mood Check-In	You have had a stressful day and want to check in with yourself	Complete a daily mood check-in and submit how you are feeling
Breathing Exercise	You are feeling anxious and need to calm down quickly	Find a guided breathing or relaxation exercise. Start and complete it
Journal Entry	You want to track your thoughts and progress over time	Create a new journal entry (select a mood, type a short entry, and save it). Then find it in your Journal History
Community Interaction	You want to connect with others who understand what you are going through	Explore the community section and find a way to interact with a post
Emergency Help	You are feeling emotionally distressed and need urgent help	Locate emergency resources starting from the welcome screen

Thank you so much for your participation

Figure 1: Task Sheet

2.6.1. Task Sheet Priming Check

To ensure the task sheet does not introduce bias or prime participants toward specific behaviors, we carefully reviewed the wording of each task instruction against Nielsen Norman Group's guidelines for unbiased task formulation.

Risk	Example of Priming Language	Our Neutral Alternative
Suggesting where to look	"Go to the profile section"	"Create a new journal entry and then find it in your history"
Leading toward expected behavior	"Try to complete this quickly"	(No time pressure mentioned)
Giving away interface labels	"Click the 'Mood' button in the bottom navigation"	"Complete a daily mood check-in and submit how you are feeling"
Revealing system terminology	"Use the breathing exercise feature"	"Find a guided breathing or relaxation exercise"

Table 4: Prime Risks Avoided

Validation Process:

Each task was reviewed by team members not involved in the prototype design to ensure they described the goal rather than the method. This approach allows us to observe whether the interface itself guides users effectively, rather than measuring whether users can follow labeled instructions.

Example of Neutral Task Formulation:

- **Biased**: Click the plus button to add a journal entry
- **Neutral**: Create a new journal entry

The think-aloud protocol will further reveal whether users' mental models align with our interface design, as they verbalize their expectations before clicking.

2.7. Participants

Following Nielsen Norman Group recommendations for usability testing, we will recruit 5-8 participants for this study. This sample size is sufficient to identify most usability issues.

Target Audience Criteria:

- **Age**: 18-25 years
- **Technology Familiarity**: regular mobile app users
- **App Experience**: mixed group (some with prior mental health app experience, and some without)
- **Role**: both individuals who may seek mental health support and those supporting others

Consent and Ethics:

All participants will complete a Research Participation Agreement form before testing. They will be informed:

- All data will be anonymised
- No personal mental health details are required
- They can stop at any time without consequences
- This a student prototype and not some clinical advice
- Sessions may be recorded for analysis purposes only

2.7.1. Screening Questions

To ensure participants match our target audience, we will use the following screening questions during recruitment. These questions help us select a diverse sample that represents our user personas while avoiding bias:

Question	Purpose	Acceptable Responses
What is your age?	Age Verification	18-25 years only
How often do you use mobile apps?	Tech Familiarity	Daily or several times a week
Have you ever used a mental health or wellness app?	Experience Diversity	Mix of 'Yes' and 'No' desired

Are you currently a university student?	Persona Alignment	Any response accepted
Are you comfortable using a prototype and thinking aloud during tasks?	Method suitability	'Yes' required
Do you have any visual or motor impairments we should accommodate?	Accessibility consideration	(used to make accommodations if needed)

Table 5: Screening Questions

Recruitment Strategy:

- Target: 5-8 participants total
- Diversity Goal: at least 40% female participants, mix of tech comfort levels, mix of mental health app experience
- Recruitment Channels: classmates, university student groups, personal metworks
- Backup Plan: if we cannot recruit 5 suitable participants, we will generate mock data based on research literature for remaining participants

Participant Demographics Tracking:

For each participant, we will anonymously record:

- Age range: (18-21, 22-25)
- Gender (optional, for diversity tracking)
- Prior mental health app experience (yes/no)
- Tech comfort level (1-5 self-rate)

This data will be reported in Section 5.1 (Participant Demographics) of our analysis.

3. Piloting

To guarantee that our mental health application, HelpEra, was effective and to minimize the problems, we conducted a pilot test within our group. The aim of this pilot test was to gauge the simplicity and clarity of tasks, the usability of the app and the overall flow of the app before it would be given to the next stage of testing, which is with external subjects.

During this pilot, each team member imitated a different user and completed tasks, namely onboarding, navigation, access to support features and the interaction of core functionalities i.e. mood tracking and guided breathing exercises. We recorded the observations made dependent on the ease of navigation; time consumption of each task and any bugs or errors found within the test.

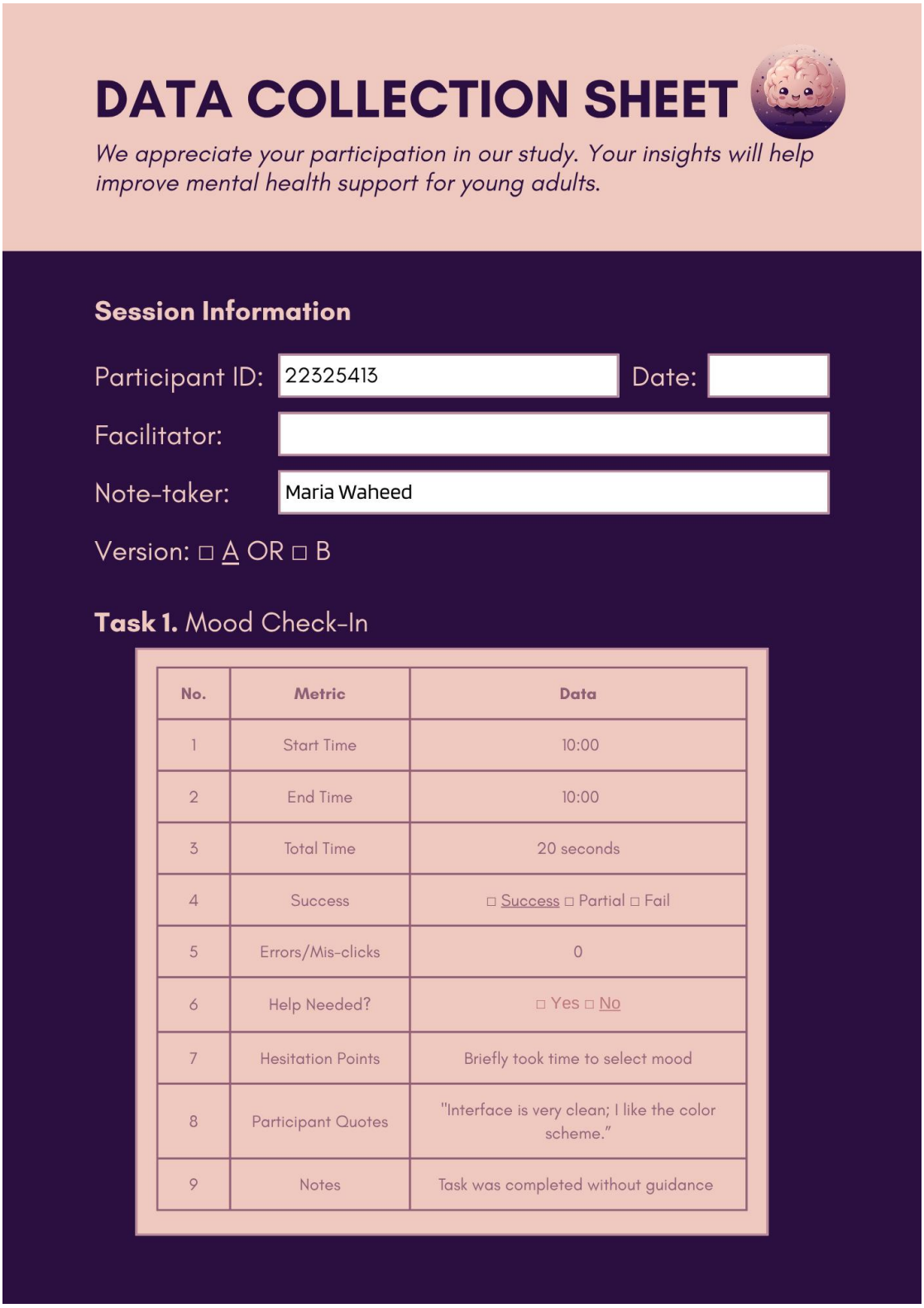
This test helped reveal a few issues, i.e. unclear instructions, lack of efficient chat system and inconsistencies within the expectations of the app. The lack of guided or straight-forward instructions led to confusion and needed explanation which was not conducive to app productivity. The lack of personal chats made the chat page seem redundant and seemed futile within the application. The expectations for the app were similar but also differed, which demanded more than our team had implemented.

As a result, several modifications were made. The instructions for each task were simplified to improve user favorability. We included guided instructions to the journal section to increase the interaction between the user and the app. The test was conducted via a uniform set of questions in a form to ensure data reliability. The results of this test helped us to build on and improve our application.

In conclusion, the pilot test was extremely crucial in identifying the usability of our application and how user-friendly it is. These modifications helped improve the experiment and made it more efficient and reliable for the main study with other users.

4. Experimental Data Collection

4.1. Version A



DATA COLLECTION SHEET

We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 22325413 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:00
2	End Time	10:00
3	Total Time	20 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Briefly took time to select mood
8	Participant Quotes	"Interface is very clean; I like the color scheme."
9	Notes	Task was completed without guidance

Figure 2: Data Collection (Participant a (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:01
2	End Time	10:02
3	Total Time	70 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Briefly waited to read the inhale/exhale text
8	Participant Quotes	"The lotus animation is impressive"
9	Notes	Completed 1 full cycle of 60 seconds

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:05
2	End Time	10:07
3	Total Time	110 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Paused when the keyboard did not respond to touch
8	Participant Quotes	"Does the keyboard not work?"
9	Notes	Participant was confused as to why keyboard does not work

Figure 3: Data Collection (Participant a (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:08
2	End Time	10:09
3	Total Time	45 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Scanned "Your Groups" before selecting "Discover Groups"
8	Participant Quotes	"Globe looks pretty"
9	Notes	Participant viewed public chat

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:09
2	End Time	10:09
3	Total Time	12 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Comprehensive list of countries"
9	Notes	Navigated directly to UAE hotlines

Figure 4: Data Collection (Participant a (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 3
2. What did you like most? Breathing exercise
3. What did you like least? non-interactive keyboard journal
4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference
5. Why? Version B feels more intuitive
6. One thing to change? Add an interactive keyboard
7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
   Possibly, but improvements are needed.

Figure 5: Data Collection (Participant a (iv))

DATA COLLECTION SHEET



We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 21934203 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:24
2	End Time	03:24
3	Total Time	15 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	1 (selected wrong mood)
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Took time deciding between moods
8	Participant Quotes	"Moods are clear and easy to select"
9	Notes	No guidance needed

Figure 6: Data Collection (Participant b (i))

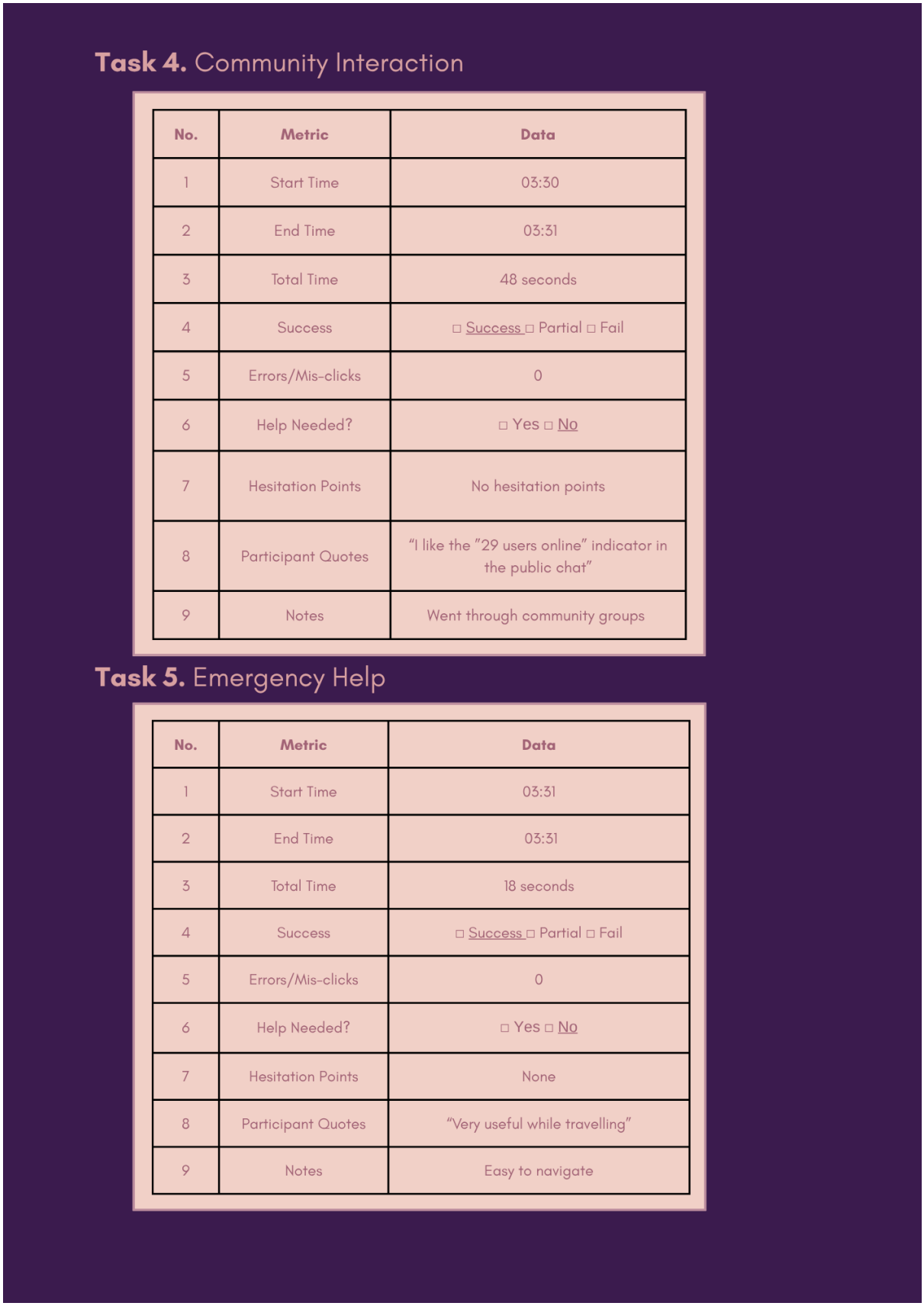
Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:25
2	End Time	03:27
3	Total Time	80 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Looked for a "Back" button mid-exercise
8	Participant Quotes	"Would be nice if I could pause during the breathing exercise"
9	Notes	Completed 1 full cycle of 60 seconds

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:28
2	End Time	03:29
3	Total Time	70 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	2 (Trying to type using keyboard)
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Took time trying to trigger the keyboard
8	Participant Quotes	"Wanted to to write just a word but the keyboard does not work"
9	Notes	Abandoned typing and clicked My Progress instead

Figure 7: Data Collection (Participant b (ii))



Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:30
2	End Time	03:31
3	Total Time	48 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	No hesitation points
8	Participant Quotes	"I like the "29 users online" indicator in the public chat"
9	Notes	Went through community groups

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:31
2	End Time	03:31
3	Total Time	18 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Very useful while travelling"
9	Notes	Easy to navigate

Figure 8: Data Collection (Participant b (iii))

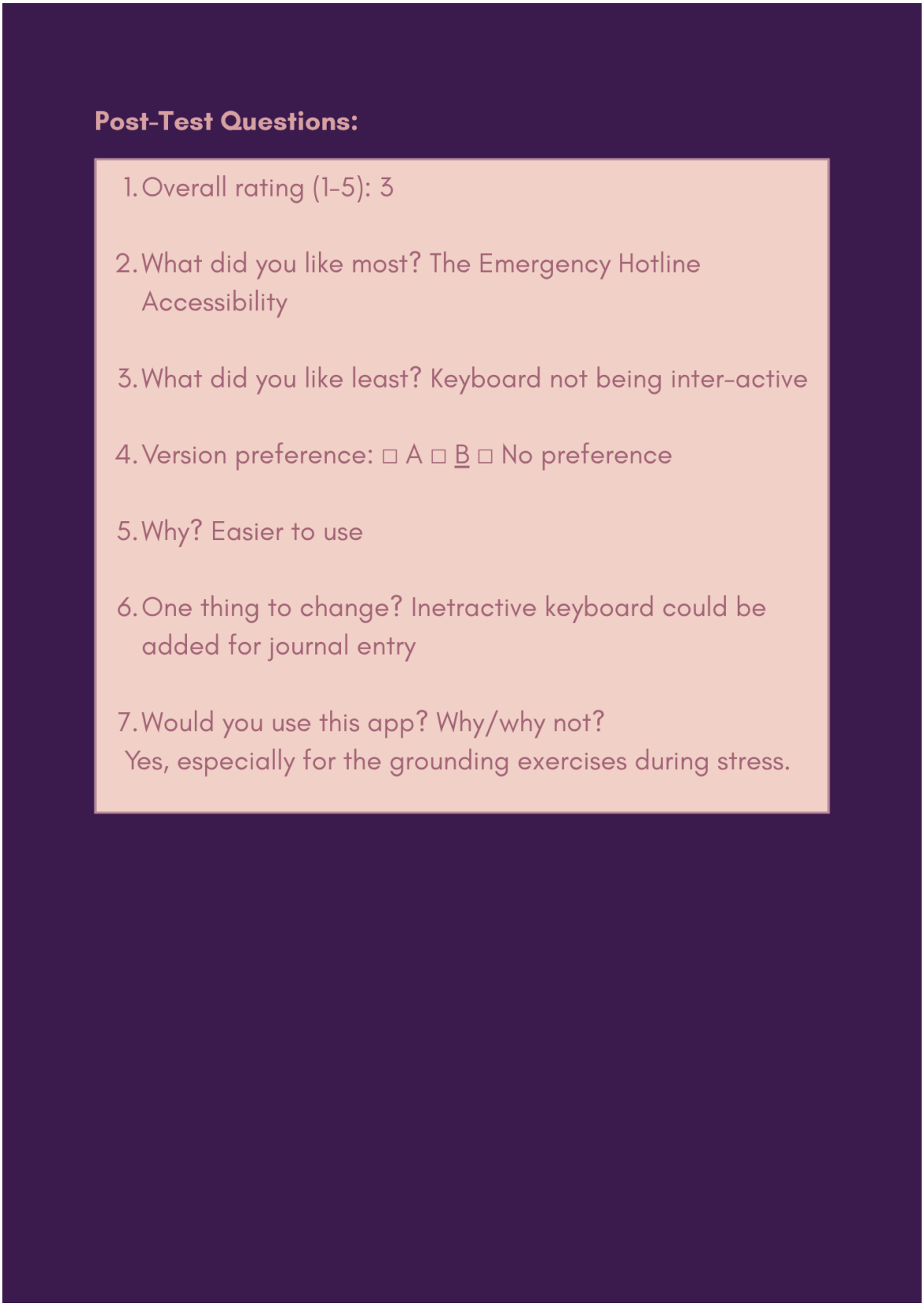


Figure 9: Data Collection (Participant b (iv))

DATA COLLECTION SHEET

We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 22574875 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	05:40
2	End Time	05:40
3	Total Time	15 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Deciding between moods
8	Participant Quotes	"The brief messages after mood selection is a great idea"
9	Notes	Task completed smoothly

Figure 10: Data Collection (Participant c (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	05:41
2	End Time	05:43
3	Total Time	83 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Instructions were clear"
9	Notes	Smooth completion

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	05:44
2	End Time	05:46
3	Total Time	70 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	2 (Trying to type using keyboard)
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Brief pause to locate journal history
8	Participant Quotes	"Wasn't sure where previous journal entries were stored"
9	Notes	Overall smooth completion

Figure 11: Data Collection (Participant c (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	5:46
2	End Time	5:48
3	Total Time	54 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Took time to locate community
8	Participant Quotes	"I had to look around a bit to find the community section"
9	Notes	Navigation labels could be clearer

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	05:48
2	End Time	05:48
3	Total Time	14 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The emergency button is very easy to find."
9	Notes	Fastest Task completed

Figure 12: Data Collection (Participant c (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 4
2. What did you like most? Mood tracking and simple interface
3. What did you like least? Keyboard not being inter-active
4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference
5. Why? I would be comfortable using either version
6. One thing to change? Make journal history easier to find.
7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
   Yes, because it helps with mood tracking and relaxation exercises.

Figure 13: Data Collection (Participant c (iv))

DATA COLLECTION SHEET



We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 21846201 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:12
2	End Time	01:12
3	Total Time	21 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Very straightforward task"
9	Notes	No issues observed

Figure 14: Data Collection (Participant d (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:13
2	End Time	01:15
3	Total Time	91 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	unsure when exercise finished
8	Participant Quotes	"I wasn't sure when the breathing exercise ended."
9	Notes	End indicator should be clearer

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:15
2	End Time	01:17
3	Total Time	75 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	2 (Trying to type)
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Brief pause when they couldn't type since the keyboard is not interactive
8	Participant Quotes	"I was confused when I couldn't type in the journal"
9	Notes	Keyboard should be interactive

Figure 15: Data Collection (Participant d (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:18
2	End Time	01:19
3	Total Time	54 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	1
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Brief pause when clicking on chats
8	Participant Quotes	"I thought clicking on a chat would lead to a chat page"
9	Notes	Clicking on chat should lead to a chat interface

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:19
2	End Time	01:19
3	Total Time	15 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Emergency help is easy to access"
9	Notes	Task completed with no confusion

Figure 16: Data Collection (Participant d (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 4
2. What did you like most? Mood tracking feature and overall design
3. What did you like least? My progress page not being interactive
4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference
5. Why? Version B is more interactive with chats page and progress page
6. One thing to change? Make more interactive features
7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
   Yes, because it provides helpful features like mood tracking and breathing exercises for stress management.

Figure 17: Data Collection (Participant d (iv))

DATA COLLECTION SHEET

We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 22660994 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	3:29
2	End Time	3:29
3	Total Time	24 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Mood icons are easy to understand and select"
9	Notes	Task completed without assisstance

Figure 18: Data Collection (Participant e (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	3:30
2	End Time	3:31
3	Total Time	92 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Participant paused briefly to understand how breathing exercise worked
8	Participant Quotes	"There isn't a button to pause the exercise"
9	Notes	Pause button should be included

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:32
2	End Time	03:33
3	Total Time	79 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	2 (Trying to add notes/photos)
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Paused when buttons in my progress page weren't interactive
8	Participant Quotes	"I expected the buttons within the my progress page to be interactive"
9	Notes	Buttons within my progress should be interactive

Figure 19: Data Collection (Participant e (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:34
2	End Time	03:34
3	Total Time	54 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	1
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Took time locating the Community Tab
8	Participant Quotes	"Took a few seconds to find the community content"
9	Notes	Clearer navigation needed

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:35
2	End Time	03:35
3	Total Time	11 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Emergency help is very visible"
9	Notes	No issues

Figure 20: Data Collection (Participant e (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 4
2. What did you like most? Breathing exercise and mood check-ins
3. What did you like least? My progress page
4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference
5. Why? I am comfortable using any version
6. One thing to change? Make more interactive features
7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
   Yes, because the app provides mood tracking and relaxation exercises

Figure 21: Data Collection (Participant e (iv))

4.2. Version B

DATA COLLECTION SHEET

We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 22325413 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:15
2	End Time	10:15
3	Total Time	21 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"I like that it gives me a message after selecting a mood"
9	Notes	Task smoothly completed without guidance

Figure 22: Data Collection (Participant a (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:16
2	End Time	10:17
3	Total Time	72 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The breathing animation is easy to follow"
9	Notes	Participant completed the breathing exercise successfully

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:17
2	End Time	10:18
3	Total Time	79 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Brief pause to think of what to write in the journal entry
8	Participant Quotes	"I like that I can type in the journal entry"
9	Notes	Participant successfully typed a journal entry using interactive keyboard

Figure 23: Data Collection (Participant a (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:19
2	End Time	10:20
3	Total Time	56 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Chat pages look more organized"
9	Notes	Participant entered community chat and successfully opened a chat page

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	10:20
2	End Time	10:20
3	Total Time	11 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"It's good that there is a call button for emergency"
9	Notes	Participant located emergency hotline and call feature easily

Figure 24: Data Collection (Participant a (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 4
2. What did you like most? Journal and breathing exercise features
3. What did you like least? My progress page
4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference
5. Why? Version B has better visuals and more interactive features
6. One thing to change? I
7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
   Yes, because it provides helpful mental health tools and tracking features.

Figure 25: Data Collection (Participant a (iv))

DATA COLLECTION SHEET

We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 21934203 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:40
2	End Time	03:40
3	Total Time	19 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The mood icons look visually appealing"
9	Notes	No guidance needed

Figure 26: Data Collection (Participant b (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:40
2	End Time	03:42
3	Total Time	82 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The congratulations message was nice"
9	Notes	Exercise completed smoothly

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:42
2	End Time	03:43
3	Total Time	71 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"I like that the journal history is accessible from both journal entry and my progress page"
9	Notes	Participant created journal entry and accessed journal history successfully

Figure 27: Data Collection (Participant b (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:44
2	End Time	03:44
3	Total Time	47 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"I like that both group and individual chats are available"
9	Notes	Participant opened public chat and individual chat page successfully.

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:31
2	End Time	03:31
3	Total Time	16 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Emergency call button is easy to find"
9	Notes	Emergency page visuals were clear and participant located hotline quickly

Figure 28: Data Collection (Participant b (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 5

2. What did you like most? Emergency help and journal features

3. What did you like least? Navigation between some features required multiple steps, which slightly affected efficiency

4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference

5. Why? Easier to use

6. One thing to change? Increase font size for readability

7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
Yes, especially for the grounding exercises during stress/anxiety.

Figure 29: Data Collection (Participant b (iv))

DATA COLLECTION SHEET



We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 22574875 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	06:00
2	End Time	06:00
3	Total Time	20 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Deciding between moods
8	Participant Quotes	"Mood check-in is simple"
9	Notes	Participant selected mood and reviewed the reflection page

Figure 30: Data Collection (Participant c (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	06:01
2	End Time	06:02
3	Total Time	84 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"Breathing animation helps timing"
9	Notes	Completed exercise and saw completion message.

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	06:03
2	End Time	06:04
3	Total Time	73 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	1 (Minor typing error)
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Took time writing a journal entry
8	Participant Quotes	"Typing journal entries feels realistic"
9	Notes	Journal entry saved and history accessed from progress page

Figure 31: Data Collection (Participant c (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	06:05
2	End Time	06:06
3	Total Time	57 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Took time to locate community
8	Participant Quotes	"Chat layout looks clean"
9	Notes	Participant opened chat page and report button was visible

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	06:07
2	End Time	06:07
3	Total Time	15 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The call feature is a good addition"
9	Notes	Task completeled smoothly

Figure 32: Data Collection (Participant c (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 4
2. What did you like most? Mood check-in page and progress page
3. What did you like least? Navigation between pages
4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference
5. Why? I would be comfortable using either version
6. One thing to change? Add tutorial for first-time users
7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
   Yes, because it helps with mood tracking and relaxation exercises.

Figure 33: Data Collection (Participant c (iv))

DATA COLLECTION SHEET



We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 21846201 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:30
2	End Time	01:30
3	Total Time	23 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Brief hesitation after mood selection before choosing next action
8	Participant Quotes	"I like that it gives feedback after selecting a mood."
9	Notes	No issues observed

Figure 34: Data Collection (Participant d (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:30
2	End Time	01:32
3	Total Time	88 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The breathing animation was relaxing and easy to follow."
9	Notes	Participant completed the breathing exercise successfully and observed the congratulations message upon completion

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:32
2	End Time	01:33
3	Total Time	79 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"I like the add notes/photos button in my progress page."
9	Notes	Participant successfully typed a journal entry using the interactive keyboard and saved the entry

Figure 35: Data Collection (Participant d (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:34
2	End Time	01:35
3	Total Time	63 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	1
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Brief pause when clicking on chats
8	Participant Quotes	"Opening chats was straightforward and the layout looks organized."
9	Notes	Participant successfully opened both group chat and individual chat pages

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	01:35
2	End Time	01:35
3	Total Time	16 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The emergency call feature is easy to find and an important addition."
9	Notes	Participant located emergency hotline information and call feature successfully

Figure 36: Data Collection (Participant d (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 5

2. What did you like most? Overall design and journal feature

3. What did you like least? Navigation between some features required returning to the home page, which added extra steps.

4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference

5. Why? Version B has better visuals, more interactive features, and clearer task flow compared to Version A.

6. One thing to change? Improve navigation flow so users can switch between features more quickly

7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
Yes, because it provides helpful features like mood tracking and breathing exercises for stress management.

Figure 37: Data Collection (Participant d (iv))

DATA COLLECTION SHEET



We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: 22660994 Date:

Facilitator:

Note-taker: Maria Waheed

Version: □ A OR □ B

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	3:45
2	End Time	3:45
3	Total Time	22 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"It's nice that the app suggests journaling after selecting a mood."
9	Notes	Task completed without assisstance

Figure 38: Data Collection (Participant e (i))

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	3:45
2	End Time	3:47
3	Total Time	87 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The breathing feature was calming and easy to complete."
9	Notes	Participant completed the breathing exercise successfully and viewed the congratulations message.

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:47
2	End Time	03:49
3	Total Time	79 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	2 (Trying to add notes/photos)
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	Brief pause when checking add notes/photos feature in my progress page
8	Participant Quotes	"I didn't notice the journal history button at first."
9	Notes	Buttons within my progress should be interactive

Figure 39: Data Collection (Participant b (ii))

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:49
2	End Time	03:50
3	Total Time	55 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	1
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"The chat pages are easy to open and navigate."
9	Notes	Participant entered public chat, and opened a private chat successfully

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	03:50
2	End Time	03:50
3	Total Time	14 seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	0
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	None
8	Participant Quotes	"I really like the call hotline services feature"
9	Notes	No issues

Figure 40: Data Collection (Participant e (iii))

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): 5
2. What did you like most? Emergency help and journal feature along with mood check-ins
3. What did you like least? Accessing certain features required returning to the home page first
4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference
5. Why? I am comfortable using any version
6. One thing to change? Maybe add reminders for mood check-ins and journal entries.
7. Would you use this app? Why/why not?
   Yes, because the app provides mood tracking and relaxation exercises

Figure 41: Data Collection (Participant e (iv))

5. Analysis of Usability Testing Results

5.1. Participant Demographics

A large amount of user research has been used to inform the development of Help Era by identifying possible user characteristics, behaviours and needs. The participants of the user research were selected based on whether they were experiencing mental health issues themselves or assisting someone who has mental health issues. The following section will summarize the dominant demographics of participants in each user research group.

5.1.1. Age Distribution

Most participants were between the ages of **18 and 25**. This reflects a population of college and young adult users who engage heavily on digital platforms and would be one of the largest target populations for HelpEra.

There were also participants between the ages of **26 and 35**, with most participants being early career professionals who have taken on increased responsibilities. Many of these participants may also be supporting others.

In summary, HelpEra was able to design for mobile accessibility, simplicity, and immediacy, as young users want to quickly and easily access information and solutions digitally.

5.1.2. Occupation

Participants were mostly:

- University/college student (large segment)
- Young professionals: managing job related stress and their own wellbeing.
- Informal caregivers/ care providers (friends/family) which is the smaller segment.

Due to the diversity in occupations, the system must cater both self-help users and to those providing support to others, further emphasizing the need for 2 user paths in the app.

5.1.3. User Roles and Needs

The participant group is separated into two primary users.

- **Primary Users (Help-Seeking)**

  These users are experiencing stress, anxiety or emotional distress, and seek out ways to easily find low-pressure support options.

- **Secondary Users (Supporters)**

  These users provide support to other users with mental health challenges. For the most part, they do not have clear guidance on how to respond to the user's need to provide help.

The design of Help Era is heavily influenced by user roles and each of the user's needs have different pathways to follow in "I need help" and "I am supporting someone".

5.1.4. Technology Usage and Behaviour

It was discovered through research that many users use mobile apps very often, especially for messaging/communication purposes, socializing, and personal growth.

Some key behavioural insights are:

1. Users usually use mobile platforms first.
2. They expect apps to be fast, responsive and easy to navigate.
3. They are familiar with chat based and interactive features.
4. They prefer short digestible sections of information rather than long articles or content.

HelpEra has successfully created the app so that it's easy to use, has low cognitive load, and provides access to features quickly.

5.1.5. Mental Health Experience and Attitudes

Almost half of participants reported that they are dealing with typical mental health issues such as:

- Stress from their school or workplace.
- Anxiety and being overwhelmed by emotions.
- Not knowing where or how to get help.

Other common attitudes that emerged from our research are:

- Many people prefer anonymous or low-stakes support before looking for a supportive professional.
- People feel anxious and uncomfortable sharing their experience multiple times.
- People want to feel safe, accepted, and not judged when looking for support.
- Supporting people in need can be an overwhelming experience for supporters.

These insights directly led to features like healing guide and articles, professional matching, and "My Journey" continuous system.

5.2. Team Roles During Testing

Role	Team Member	Responsibilities
Facilitator	Maria Waheed	Leads session, reads tasks, asks neutral prompts
Note-Taker	Blessed Dendere	Records time, errors, quotes, hesitation points
Tech Support	Natalee De Silva	Ensures prototype works, helps with remote setup
Observer	Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba	Watches for non-verbal cues, identifies confusion
Manager	Resham Furqan	Schedules sessions, manages consent forms

Table 6: Team Roles During Testing

5.3. Task Completion Results

A total of 5 participants completed usability testing sessions for both Version A and Version B of the HelpEra prototype. Each participant was asked to complete 5 core tasks, and data was collected on task success, time-on-task, errors, and observed behaviors. The results below summarize quantitative metrics and qualitative observations for both versions.

5.3.1. Task Completion Success Rates

The table below presents the overall success rates for each task across all participants. Success was categorized as:

- **Success:** User completed the task without assistance or major errors
- **Partial:** User completed the task but required hints, made errors they corrected, or took significantly longer than expected
- **Fail:** User was unable to complete the task, gave up, or required facilitator intervention to proceed

Task	Success	Partial	Fail	Completion Rate
Task 1: Daily Mood Check-In	4 (80%)	1 (20%)	0	100%
Task 2: Create and Find Journal Entry	3 (60%)	1 (20%)	1 (20%)	80%
Task 3: Locate Emergency/Crisis Resources	5 (100%)	0	0	100%
Task 4: Find and Complete Breathing Exercise	3 (60%)	2 (40%)	0	100%
Task 5: Explore and Interact with Community Section	4 (80%)	0	1 (20%)	80%

Table 7: Task Completion Success Rate

Metric	Version A	Version B
Overall Success Rate	68%	84%
Average Time on Task	2;15 min	1:42 min
Assistance Requests	6	2
User Confidence (1-5)	3.6	4.2

Table 8: Key Metrics by Version

5.3.2. Summary Of Findings

- **Emergency Access (Task 3):** 100% success rate. All participants located crisis resources within 5-12 seconds using the SOS button. Research goal achieved.
- **Journal Task (Task 2):** Lowest success rate at 60%. Users struggled to find journal history in Version A (sidebar location). Version B's guided prompts and relocated history button improved performance.
- **Breathing Exercise (Task 4):** 100% completion with guidance, but only 60% direct success. Version B's contextual suggestions from check-in flow improved discoverability.
- **Version Comparison:** Version B outperformed Version A across all metrics. Guided prompts and functional interactive elements reduced cognitive load and increased user confidence.
- **Non-Functional Elements:** Users questioned app reliability when encountering inactive buttons (call icons, keyboards). Fully functional interactions in Version B restored trust.

5.4. A/B Testing Results

The A/B testing of the HelpEra application highlights the evolution from a basic mental health support prototype (Version A) to a more advanced, user-centered platform (Version B). This comparison demonstrates how thoughtful design improvements can significantly increase user trust, engagement, and effectiveness in digital mental health support.

5.4.1. Version A

Version A of the HelpEra application focused on establishing the core concept of a mental health support platform. It included the foundational features required for users to check in on their emotions, access basic learning resources, and engage in journaling. However, the overall experience was relatively limited in depth, interactivity, and flexibility.

The startup experience allowed users to sign up, log in, and access hotline services. However, there was no dedicated Terms and Conditions page or structured privacy guidance, which meant users were not clearly informed about how their data would be used or what the app's limitations were. This reduced transparency and could impact on user trust.

The check-in system included a wider range of emotions such as calm, lonely, stressed, anxious, panicky, fatigued, overwhelmed, and low. While this provided variety, the responses were highly repetitive and primarily directed users toward journaling or basic grounding exercises. This created a one-dimensional experience, where users had limited options for how they could respond to their emotions.

The Learn section provided access to mental health topics such as anxiety, depression, PTSD, and eating disorders. However, the structure was simpler, with fewer interactive elements. Features such as breathing exercises for multiple conditions, completion feedback for healing guides, and emergency escalation pathways were not present. Additionally, articles could not be reported, limiting content accountability.

The Community section allowed users to communicate through chats, but functionality was basic. There were no voice messages, message interaction options (such as report or reply), or interactive call features. The call icon existed but was non-functional, reducing realism and usability. Group categorization and navigation were also less intuitive.

The Talk to a Professional feature existed but lacked depth in interaction. Communication features such as transcription, call controls, and reporting were either limited or not fully interactive, reducing the effectiveness of professional support.

The Journal section allowed users to write entries and view progress, but many features were not interactive. Users could not effectively engage with notes, photos, or categorized views, and the journal history was placed in the sidebar, making it less accessible. There was also no option to share journal entries with professionals.

The Profile and Settings sections were minimal. Privacy-related controls were limited, and features such as text size adjustment, clear data options, and expanded FAQs were not included. The EraBot chatbot also lacked a clear disclaimer, which could lead to misunderstandings about its role.

Overall, Version A successfully established the foundation of the app but lacked interactivity, personalization, and clarity in areas such as privacy, boundaries, and crisis support. Many features existed conceptually but were not fully functional or user centered.

5.4.2. Version B

Version B builds upon the foundation of Version A by significantly improving interactivity, usability, safety, and clarity, while addressing key concerns related to user trust, privacy, and emotional sensitivity. The startup flow has been enhanced with the addition of a Terms and Conditions page and a dedicated Privacy Resources section, ensuring that users clearly understand the app's purpose, limitations, and data practices before proceeding. The hotline feature has also been improved with descriptions and direct call functionality, making emergency support more accessible and informative.

The check-in experience has been redesigned to include six refined emotional states: Radiant, Steady, Drained, Restless, Heavy, and Exasperated. Instead of repetitive responses, each emotion now offers diverse and flexible actions, such as journaling, skipping, unplugging, breathing exercises, or connecting with support systems. This shift prioritizes user autonomy and avoids forcing a single method of coping.

The Learn section has been significantly expanded to include structured healing guides, interactive modules, and completion feedback, creating a more guided and engaging learning experience. Articles can now be reported, improving content reliability. A major addition is the emergency escalation system, including the "Dangerous State Detected" feature, which provides immediate guidance, alerts support systems, and reinforces responsible crisis handling.

The Community section has evolved into a fully interactive environment. Users can now send voice messages, reply to messages, report inappropriate content, and transcribe voice messages. Call functionality has been fully implemented, including controls such as mute, camera, speaker, and transcription, along with a members list for group calls. Navigation has been improved with clearer categories such as Featured, Similar, and Trending groups.

The Talk to a Professional feature now supports real-time interaction, including chat and call functionalities with advanced controls and reporting options. This creates a more realistic and supportive environment for professional communication.

The Journal section has been enhanced with improved accessibility and functionality. When users first access the My Journal section, they are prompted with an optional guided introduction, allowing them to choose between “Show Me Around” or skipping directly to the page. This feature helps users understand the purpose of each component within the journal section, supporting ease of use, especially for first-time users. Additionally, users can access journal history through a dedicated button, navigate entries using an interactive calendar, and share journal entries with professionals, enabling more personalized support. The My Progress section is now fully interactive, allowing users to add notes and photos with categorized views.

The introduction of the Mood Data page provides users with insights into their emotional patterns over time, supporting self-awareness. Additionally, the EraBot chatbot now includes a clear disclaimer stating that it is not a licensed professional, reinforcing ethical boundaries and preventing user misinterpretation.

The Profile and Settings sections have been expanded to include features such as profile picture editing, improved Private Mode with anonymized identity, a text size adjustment slider, and a Clear My Data option. The FAQs section has been expanded, and privacy resources have been better integrated, improving overall transparency and user control.

Overall, Version B represents a significant improvement over Version A by transforming the app from a conceptual prototype into a fully interactive, user-centered system. It not only enhances functionality but also directly addresses critical aspects of trust, safety, privacy, and emotional support, making the experience more reliable, ethical, and aligned with the needs of its users.

5.5. Key Findings and Themes

Analysis of the usability testing data revealed several recurring themes regarding the HelpEra user experience. These findings highlight the strength of the current architecture and identify critical areas where Version B improved upon the initial Version A design.

Theme 1: Core Feature Usability and Guided Interaction

Testing confirmed that the primary functional pillars, mood check-ins, guided journaling, breathing exercises, and the emergency hotline access, are highly intuitive.

Key Findings:

Users successfully completed core tasks without significant friction. However, a strong preference emerged for guided navigation (Version B) over open-ended interaction. Guided journaling prompt and explicit instructions reduced cognitive load, allowing users to understand the app's value proposition more rapidly.

Theme 2: Interactivity as a Driver of Trust and Realism

A significant gap was identified in Version A regarding system feedback and 'placeholder" elements.

Key Findings:

In Version A, users hesitated when encountering non-functional UI elements (inactive keyboards or static chat screens). Version B addressed this by implementing interactive feedback loops, such as voice message transcriptions and functional call controls. This shift from static to interactive design significantly enhanced the "supportive environment" users expected from a wellbeing app.

Theme 3: Balance of Safety and Emotional Autonomy

The transition from Version A to Version B highlighted a delicate balance between providing crisis intervention and respecting user boundaries.

Key Findings:

While users prioritized the "Dangerous State Detected" feature for safety, they felt restricted when forced into specific recovery activities. Version B's introduction of "Unplug" or "Skip" options provided

necessary emotional autonomy, ensuring the app felt like a tool for the user rather than a rigid set of requirements.

5.6. Prioritized Issues

Based on the testing results, the following issues were identified as high priority for the final design:

Priority	Issue Identified	Heuristic/Theme Violated	Impact on User
High	Lack of Informed Consent	Trust and Transparency	Users were entering the app without a clear understanding of data usage or app limitations.
High	Broken Interaction Handlers	System Feedback	Non-functional buttons (Chat/Notes) caused users to question if the app was broken.
Medium	Weak Navigation Clarity	Findability	Users struggled to locate the “Community” section in Version A, leading to delayed task completion.
Medium	Rigid Mood Responses	User Control and Freedom	Forcing specific journaling tasks after a check-in felt restrictive to some participants.
Low	Visual Differentiation	Cognitive Load	Version A had overlapping UI elements that caused minor mental effort to distinguish between features.

Table 9: Prioritized Issues

5.7. Recommendations for Improvement

To address the findings above, the following recommendations were integrated into the final High-Fidelity design to optimize the HelpEra experience:

- **Enhance Transparency through Onboarding:**
  Implement a mandatory “Terms and Conditions” and “Privacy Resources” checkpoint during the initial launch to establish a foundation of trust.
- **Ensure Full UI Feedback Loops:**
  Replace all placeholder interactions with functional feedback. This includes active keyboard triggers for text fields and realistic call interface simulations to maintain the “Realism” theme.
- **Optimize for Reduced Cognitive Load:**
  Adopt the Version B layout, which utilizes clearer UI differentiation and guided pathways to minimize user uncertainty during high-stress moments.
- **Incorporate “Exit Ramps” for Autonomy:**
  Maintain the “Skip” and “Unplug” functionality within the mood check-in flow to ensure the app supports the user’s current mental state without being overbearing.
- **Strengthen safety Escalation:**
  Ensure the emergency hotline and “Dangerous State” alerts are accessible within one tap from any primary screen, providing a robust safety net for users in crisis.

6. Final High-Fidelity Prototype Design

6.1. Changes and Additions Implemented by the Team

6.1.1. Terms and Conditions & Privacy Resources

- A dedicated Terms and Conditions page has been added with a clear explanation of usage guidelines.
- Users must click “I Understand and Agree” to proceed, ensuring informed consent.
- The Privacy Resources button is prominently displayed to give users easy access to privacy information.

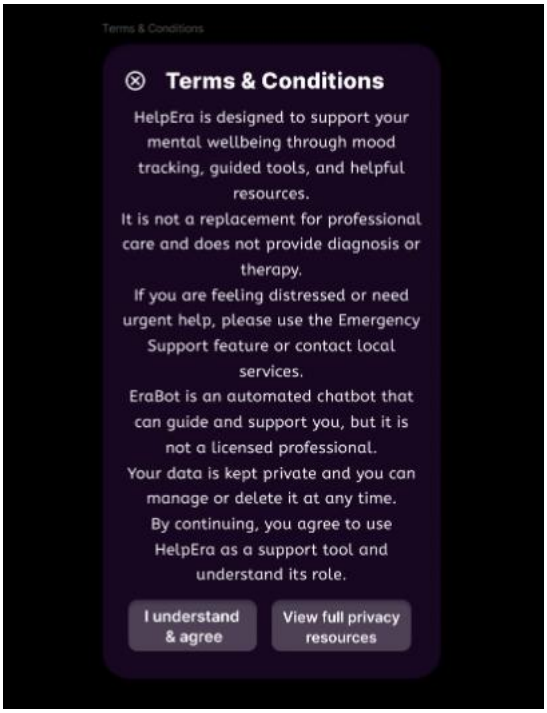


Figure 42: Terms and Conditions

6.1.2. Interactive Keyboard Functionality

- Text fields across the app, including chat and journal inputs, are now fully interactive.
- The keyboard automatically appears when a user clicks on a field and hides when they click outside, improving usability.

6.1.3. Hotline Support Enhancements

- The Hotline Support page now includes descriptions for both emergency and suicide hotlines, providing context about their purpose.
- A call icon has been added next to each hotline, allowing users to initiate a call directly to the selected service.

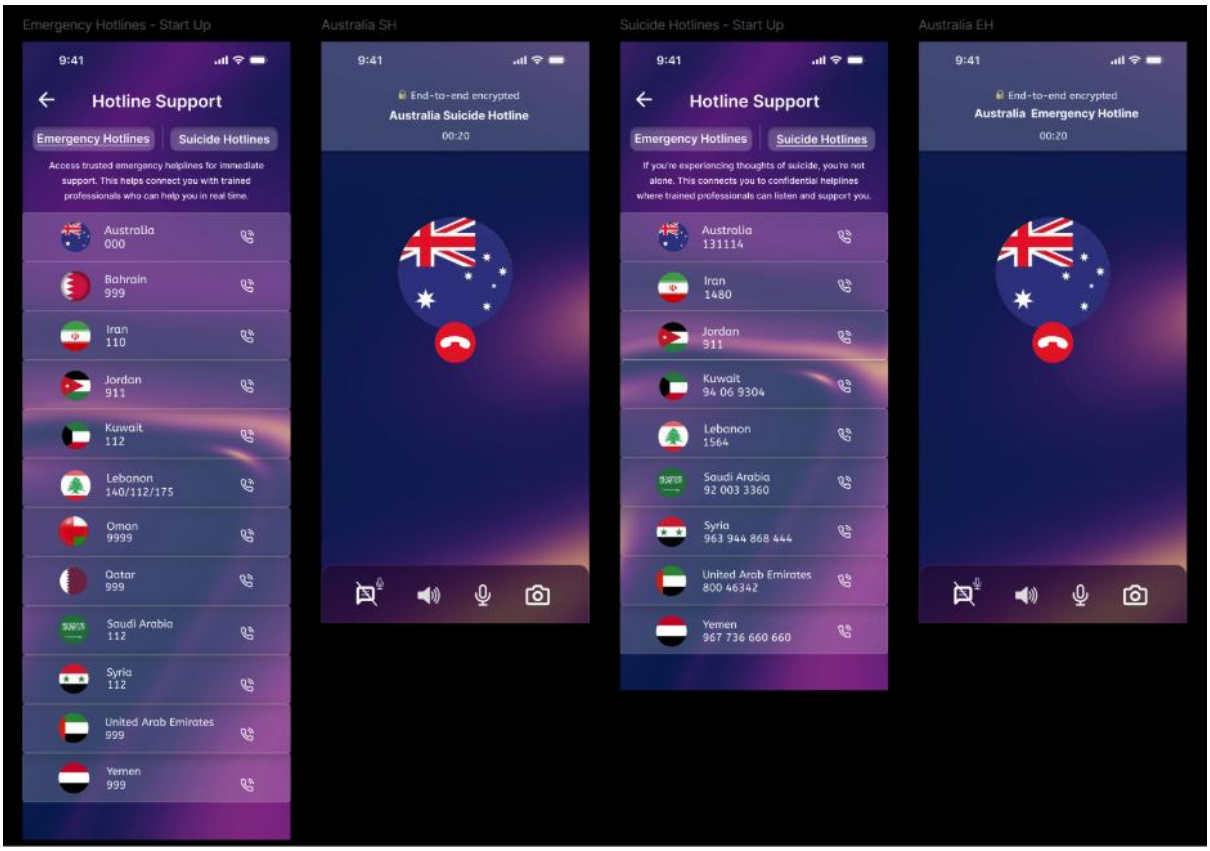


Figure 43: Hotline Support

6.1.4. Check-In Page Improvements

- Mood selection now includes six distinct emotions: Radiant, Steady, Drained, Restless, Heavy, and Exasperated, replacing the previous nine repetitive options.
- The response pages now include multiple user options: Journal, Skip, or Unplug/Professional/Peer interactions depending on the emotion, giving users more flexibility.
- The Unplug page introduces actionable suggestions and mini achievements to help users take small steps each day.

- Breathing exercises are now suggested for the Restless emotion, supporting immediate coping strategies.

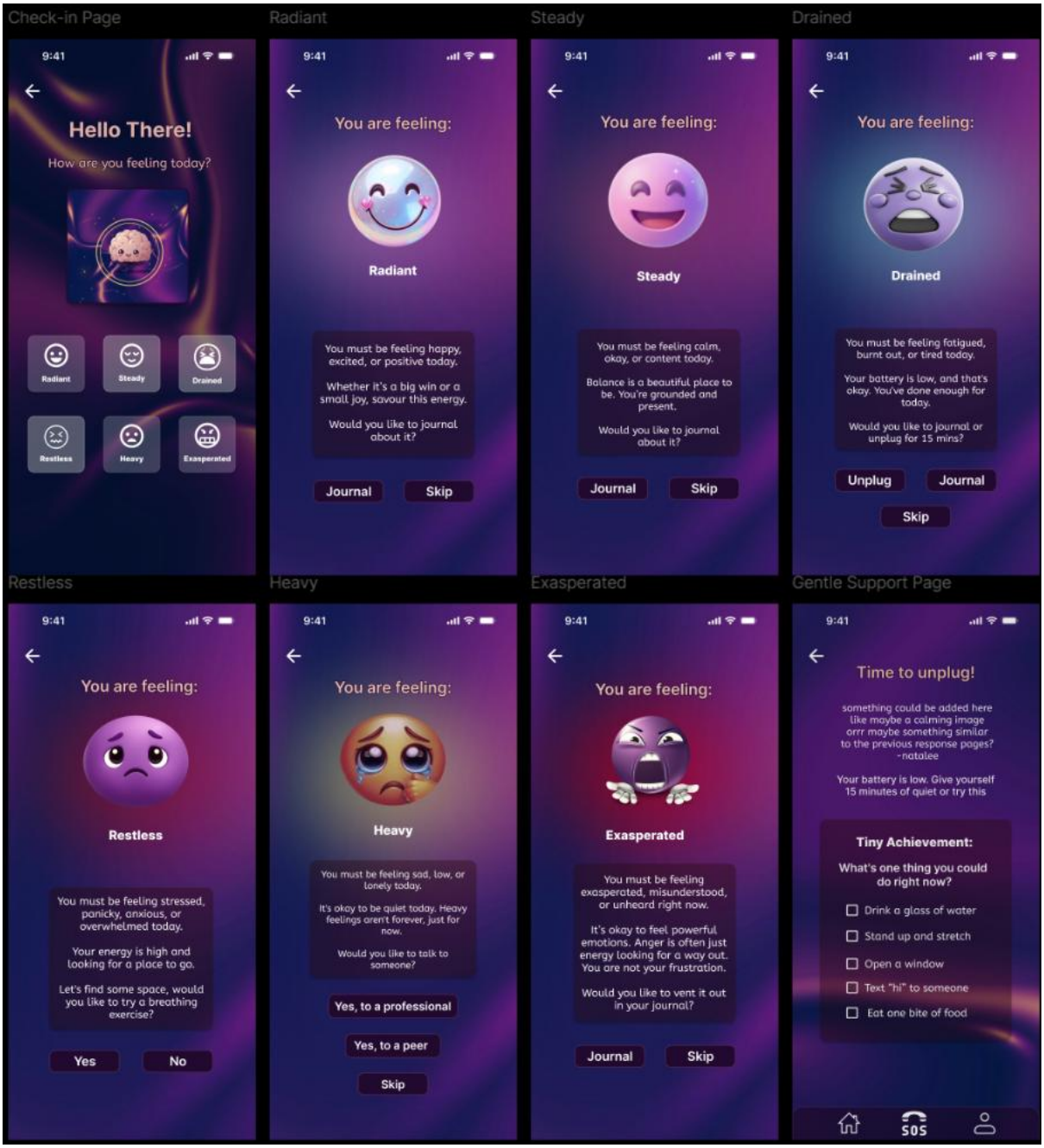


Figure 44: Check-In with Responses

6.1.5. Report Buttons

Users can now report issues across the app regarding self-harm, harassment, inappropriate content, privacy, technical problems, or other concerns.

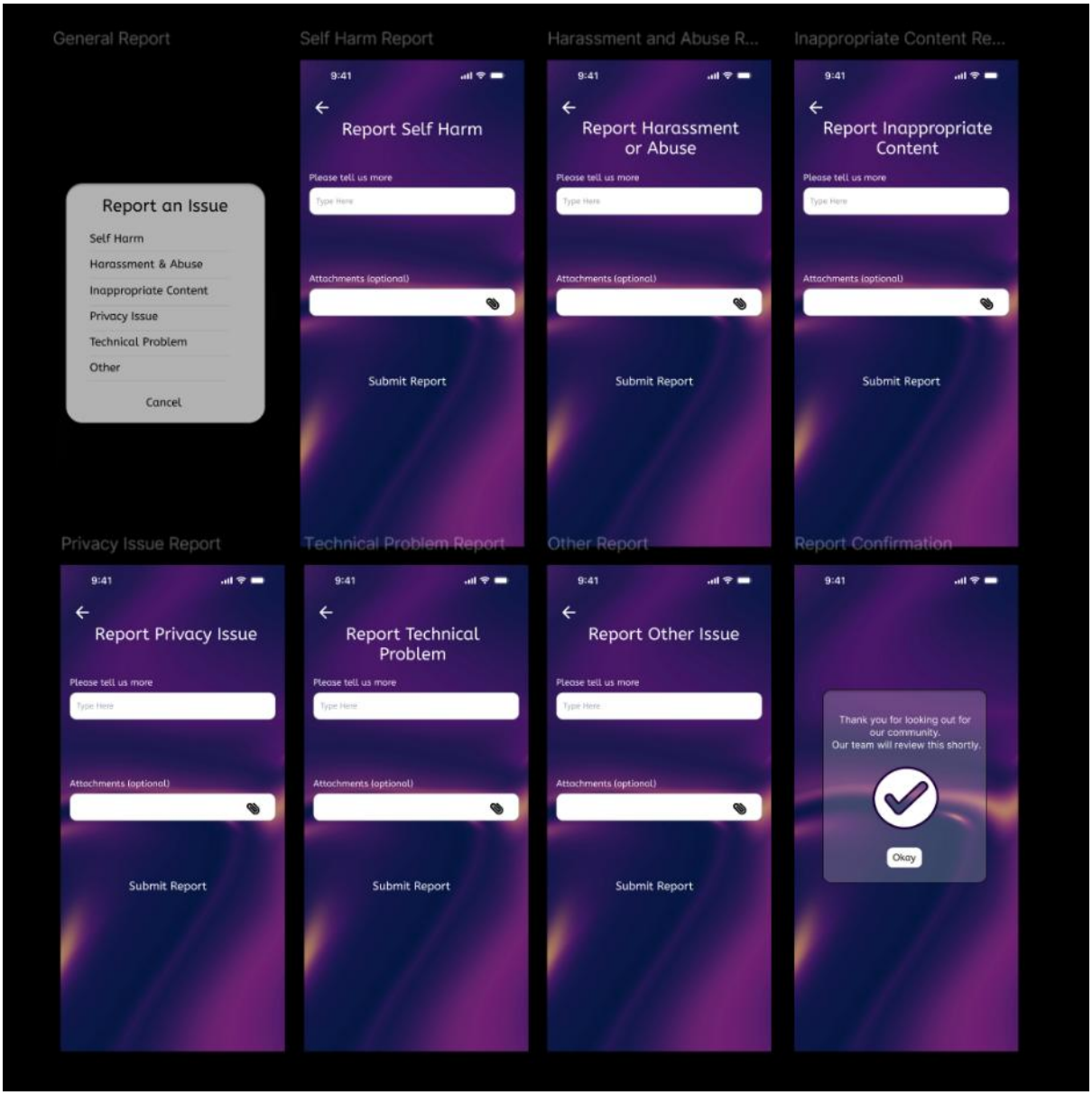


Figure 45: General Report Issue

6.1.6. Professional Support Page

Appointment sessions with professionals are fully interactive, including features such as voice/video calls, transcription feature for those who have trouble hearing, mute/unmute, camera toggle, and speaker control.

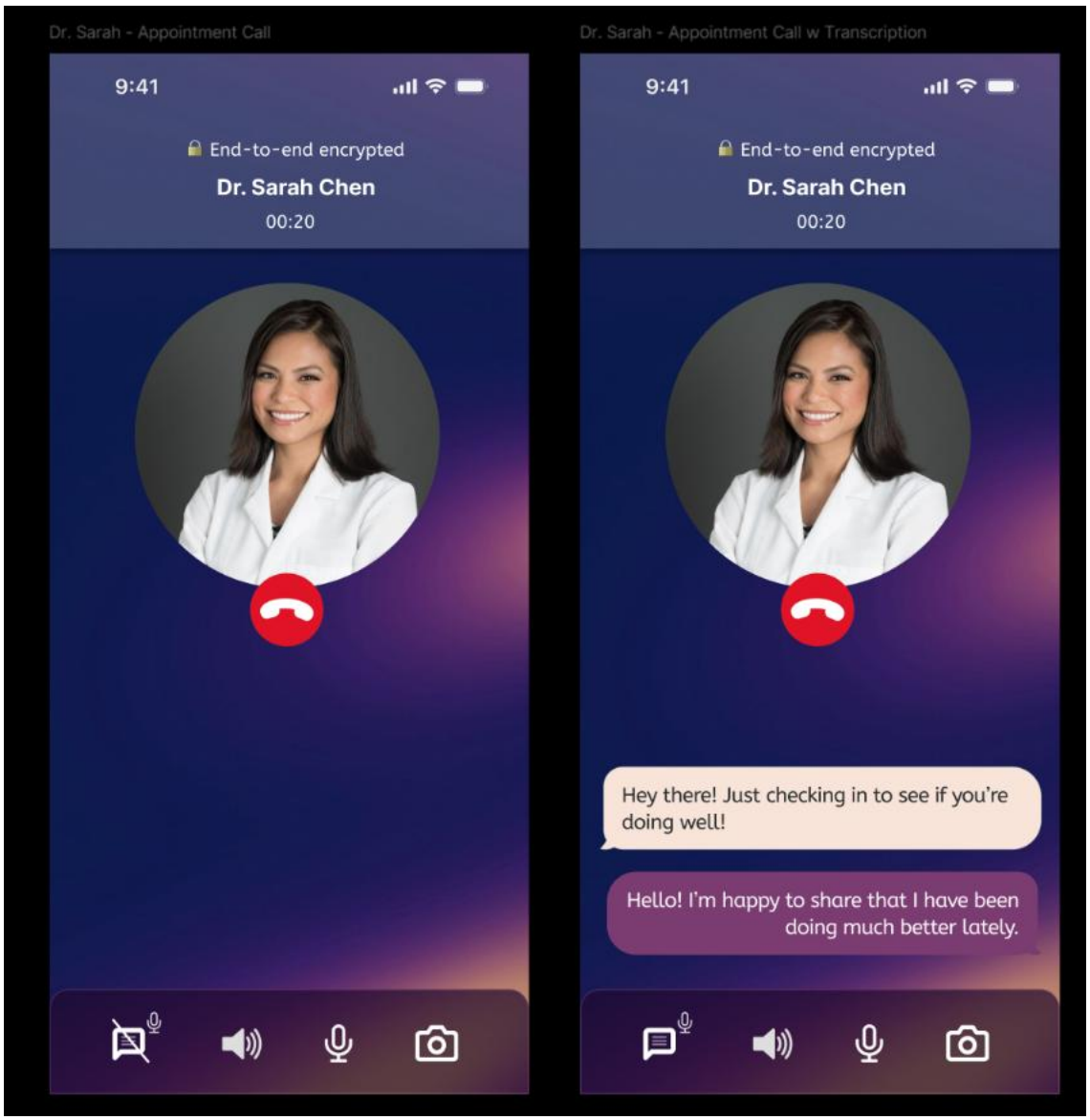


Figure 46: Appointment with Professional

6.1.7. Journal and Progress Enhancements

- When users first access the My Journal section, they are prompted with an optional guided introduction, allowing them to choose between “Show Me Around” or skipping directly to the page. This helps users understand the purpose of each feature within the section.
- The calendar is now interactive, allowing users to select specific dates for entries.
- The Journal History button has been moved from the sidebar to the journal page for better accessibility.
- Users can now share individual journal entries with professionals, supporting more personalized communication.
- The My Progress page is fully interactive, allowing users to add notes and photos and view them under categorized tabs (All, Notes, Photos).
- Visual updates to the journal tracker and progress display improve clarity and usability.

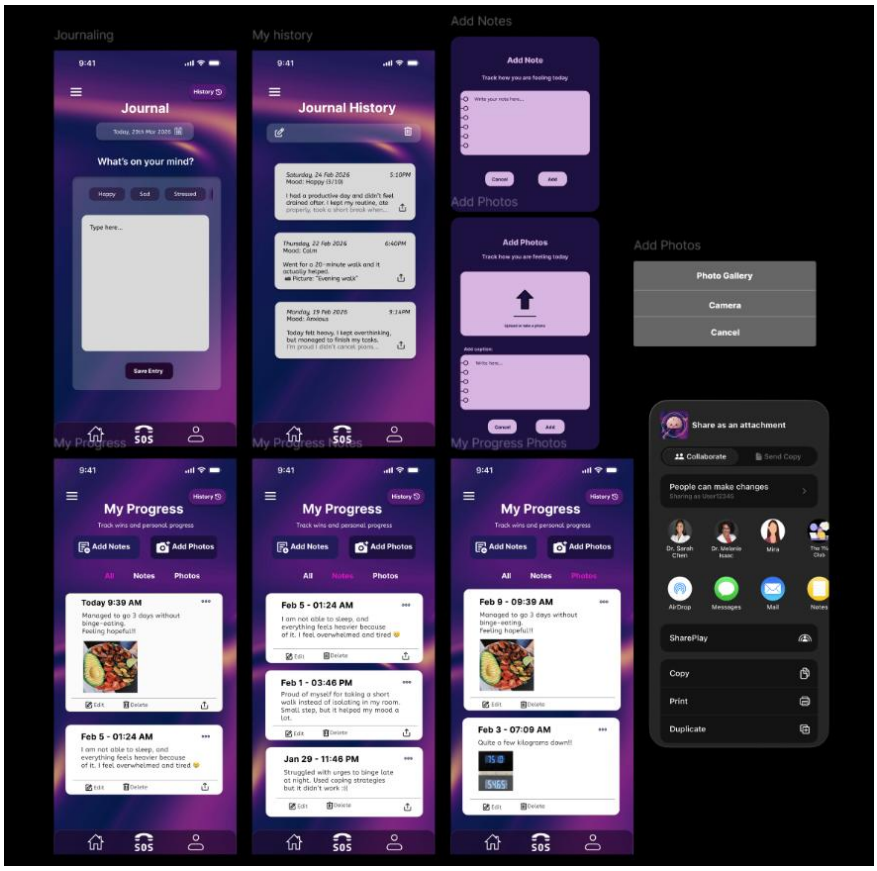


Figure 47: Updated Journaling and Progress Pages

6.1.8. Sidebar and Navigation Updates

- Sidebar in the journal section now includes My Journal, Mood Data, My Progress, and EraBot, replacing the previous layout.
- Mood Data pages are added as a new feature to track patterns and emotional trends over time.

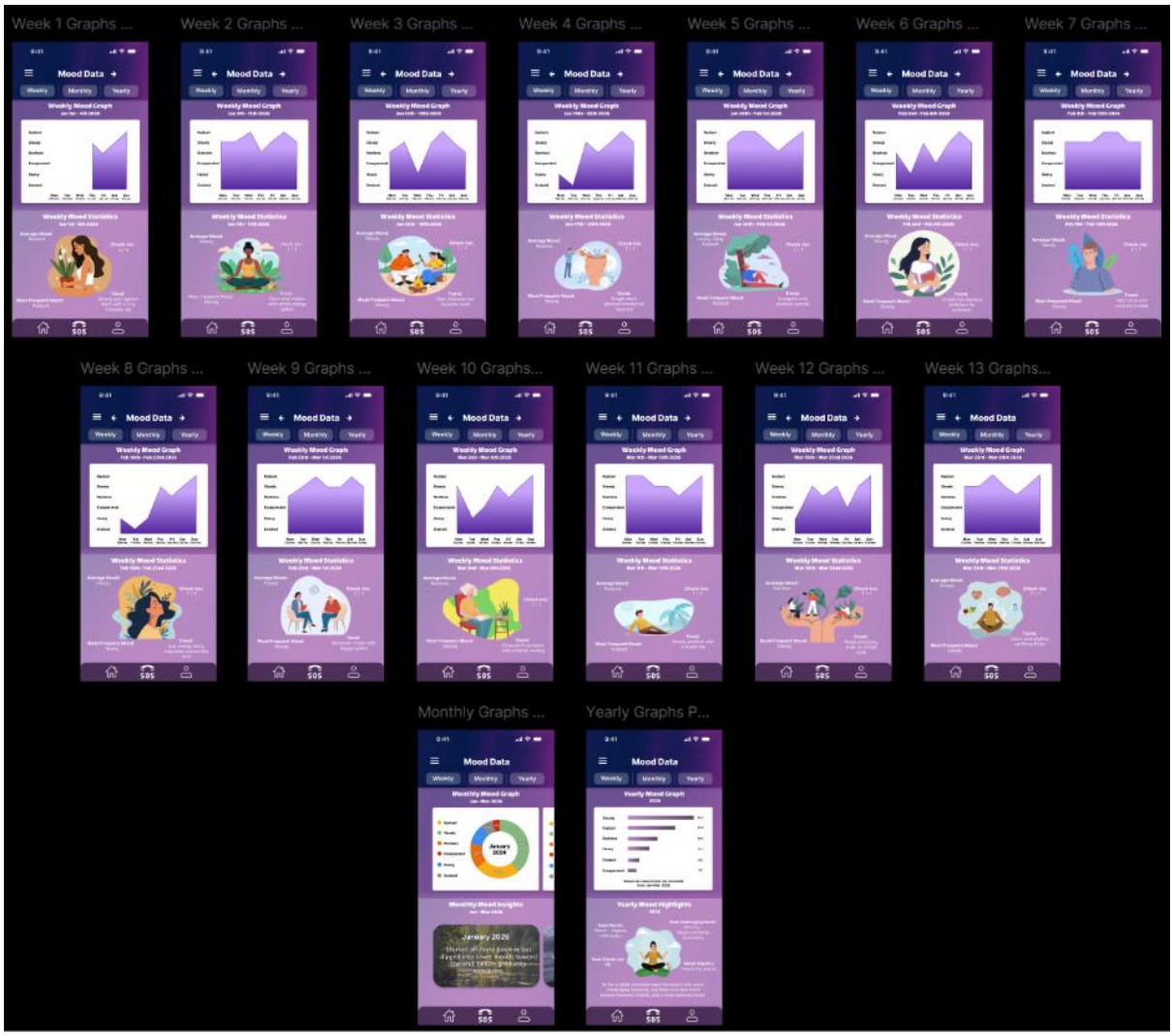


Figure 48: Mood Data

6.1.9. EraBot Updates

Greeting message updated to clarify boundaries and scope, emphasizing that EraBot provides guidance and coping suggestions but is not a licensed professional.

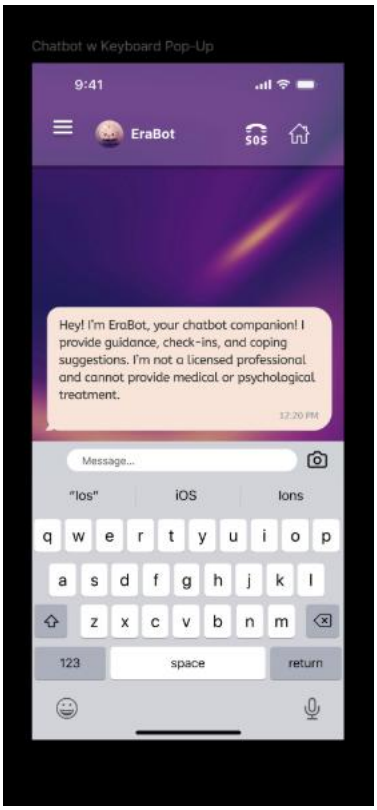


Figure 49: EraBot Message Update

6.1.10. Learn Page Updates

- Breathing exercises added to Depression and PTSD content.
- Completion message “Congratulations, you’ve completed your healing guide” added across all learning modules.
- Emergency information flow updated to support immediate crisis escalation, including alerts, professional notification, and calming guidance.
- Articles now include report options for content accuracy, technical issues, or inappropriate material.

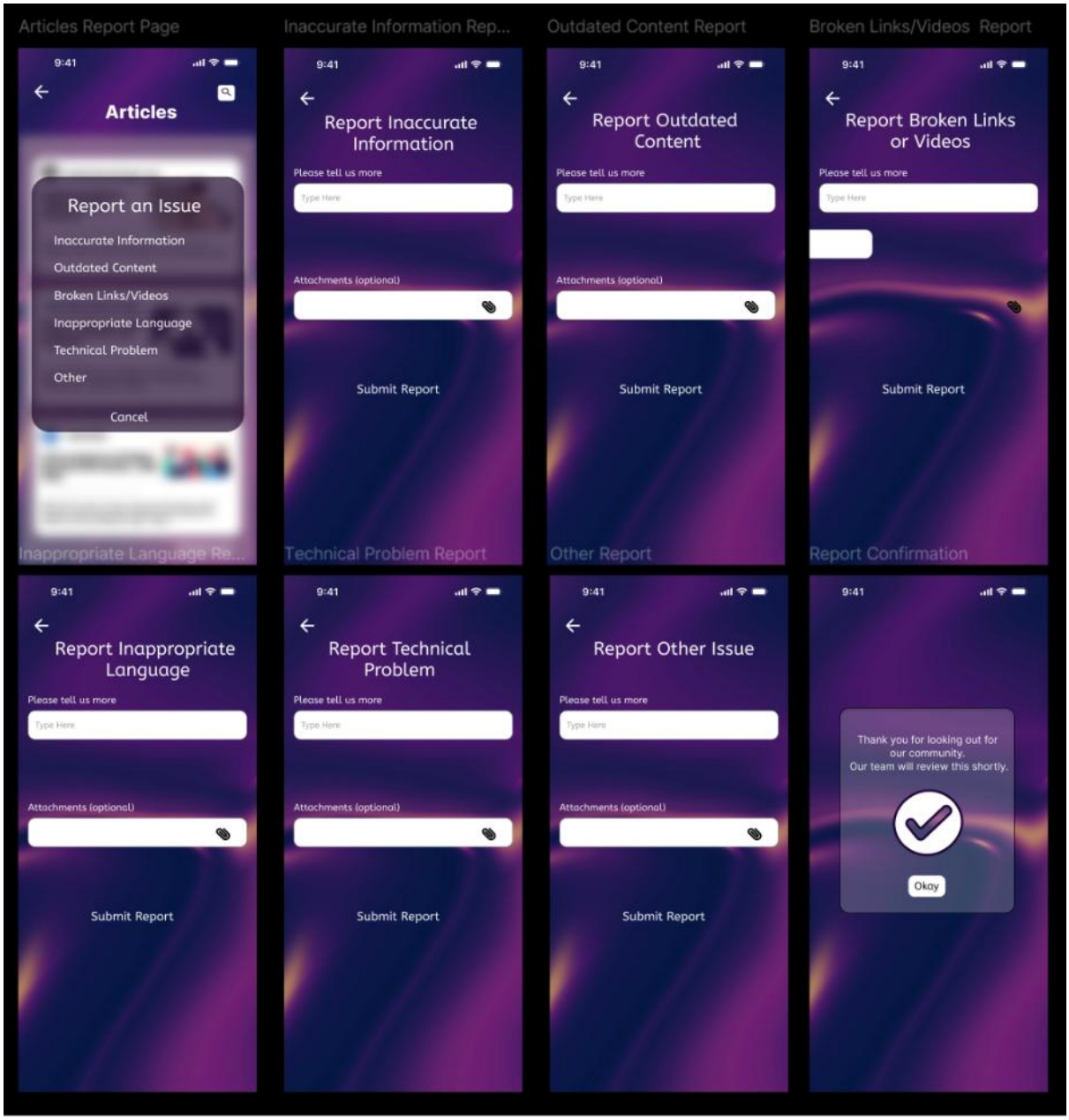


Figure 50: Articles Report Page

6.1.11. Community Page Enhancements

- Improved visual hierarchy for chat lists, group chats, and private chats.
- Tabs reorganized for clarity: All, Unread, and Favorites (Private Chats/Groups); Featured, Similar, and Trending (Discover Groups).
- Voice messages are added, with options to report, reply, or transcribe.

- Calls are now fully functional with members list visibility in group/public calls. They are also fully interactive, including features such as voice/video calls, transcription feature for those who have trouble hearing, mute/unmute, camera toggle, and speaker control.

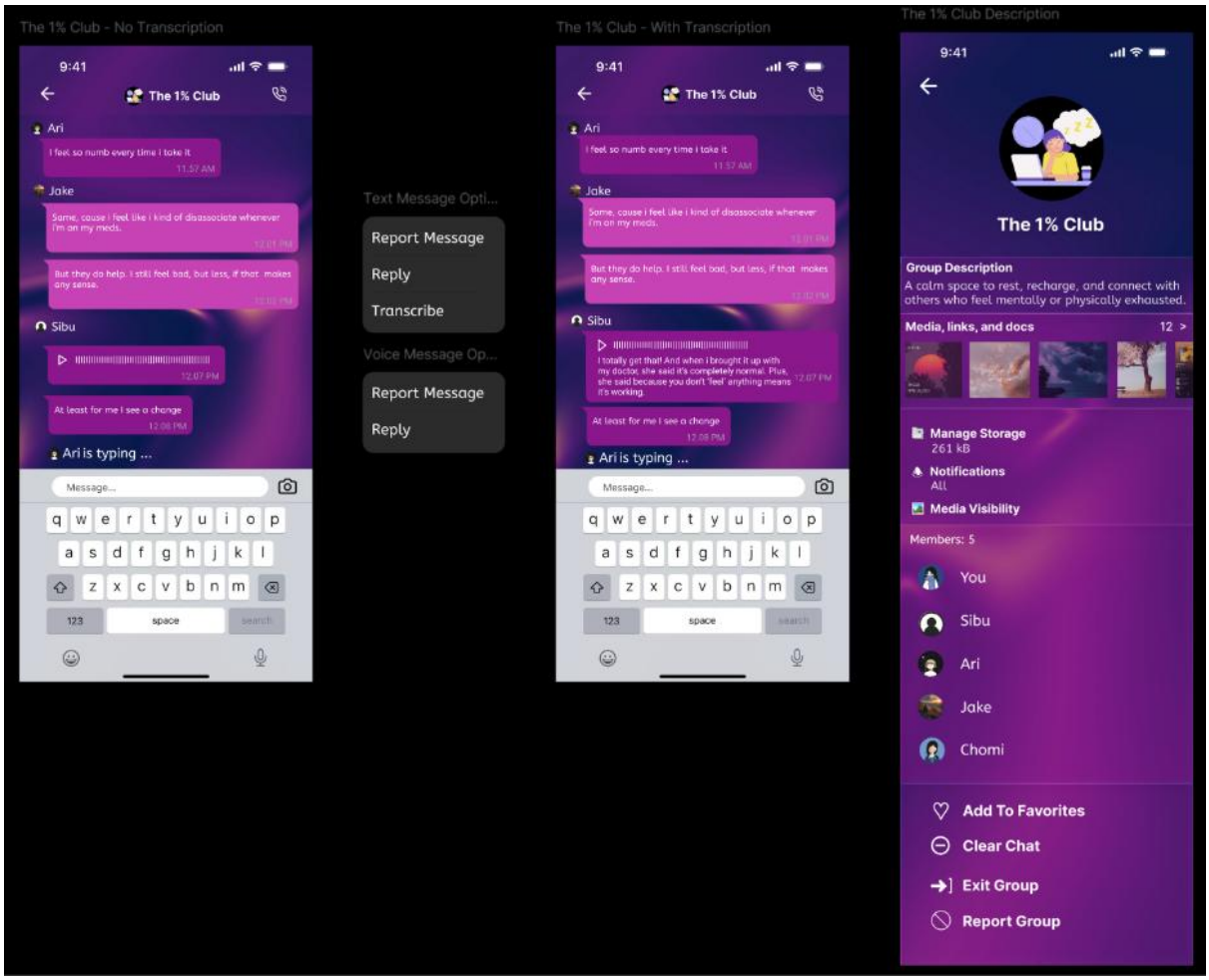


Figure 51: Community Message Interface Improvements

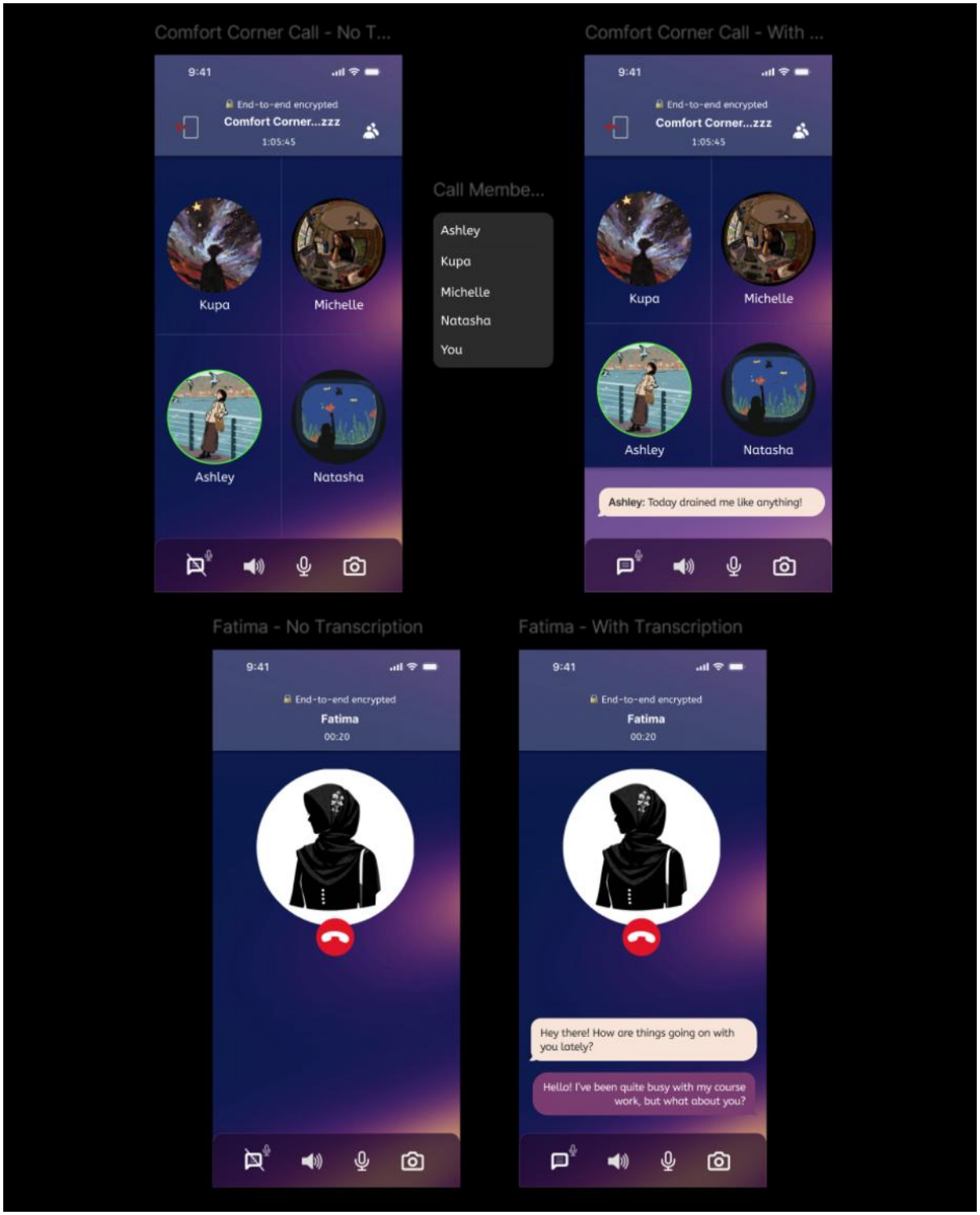


Figure 52: Community Call Page Additions

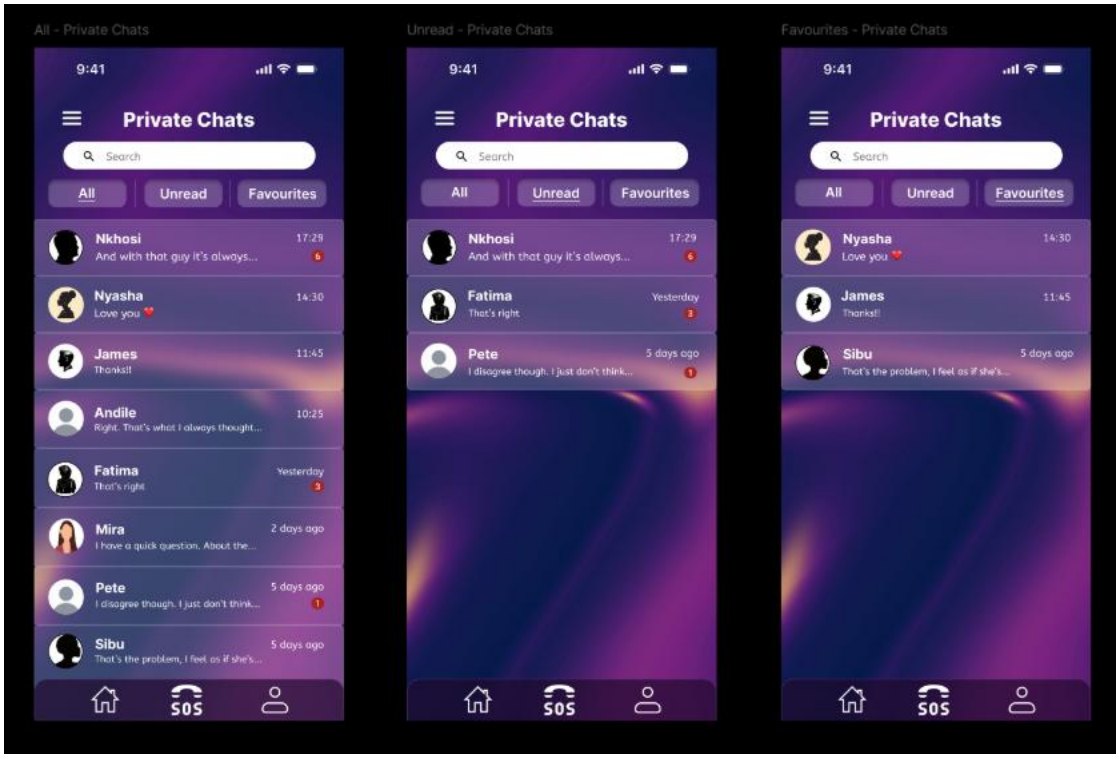


Figure 53: Private Chats Update

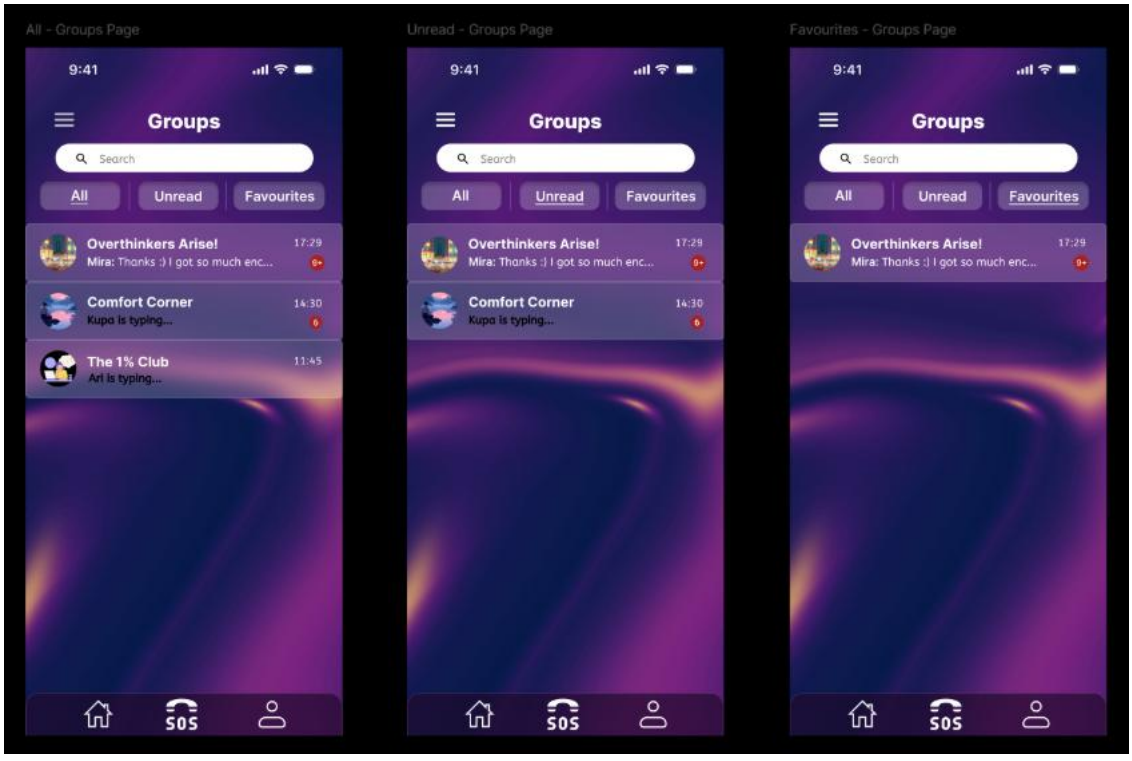


Figure 54: Group Chat Update

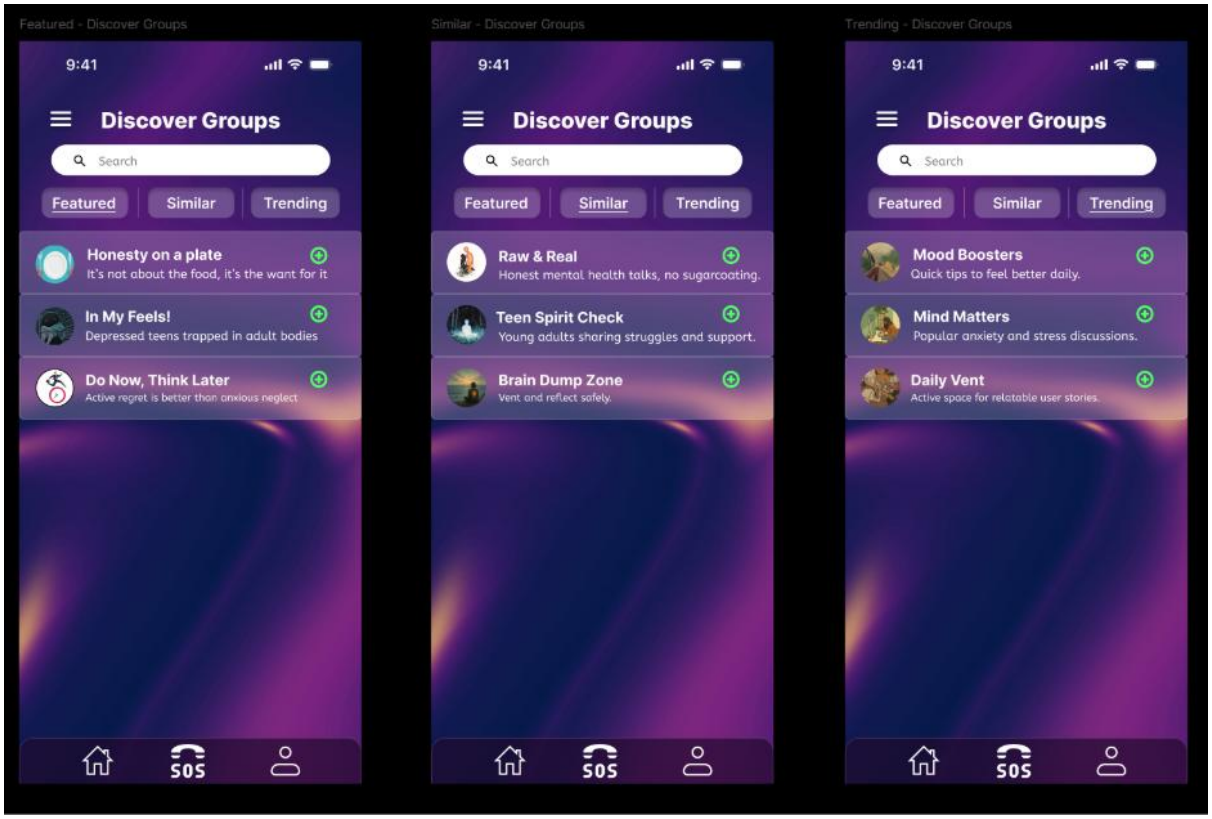


Figure 55: Discover Groups Update

6.1.12. Profile and Settings Updates

- Users can now edit profile pictures and use Private Mode, which anonymizes the username and hides the avatar.
- Profile buttons updated: Settings, Hotline Services, Report, and Logout.
- Settings enhancements: Text size slider (App Preferences), Clear My Data (Security & Privacy), expanded FAQs (12 questions), Privacy Resources, and contact email for support.

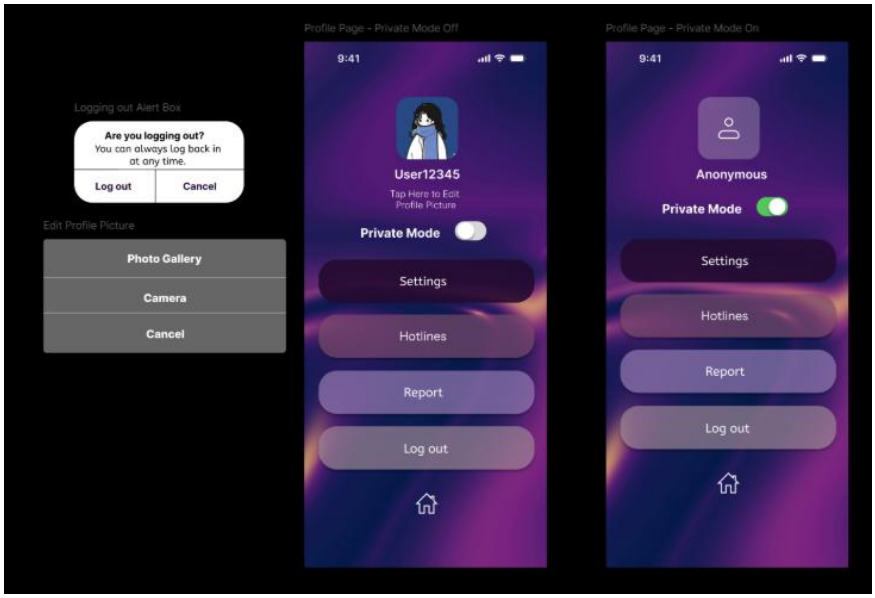


Figure 56: Updates Profile Pages

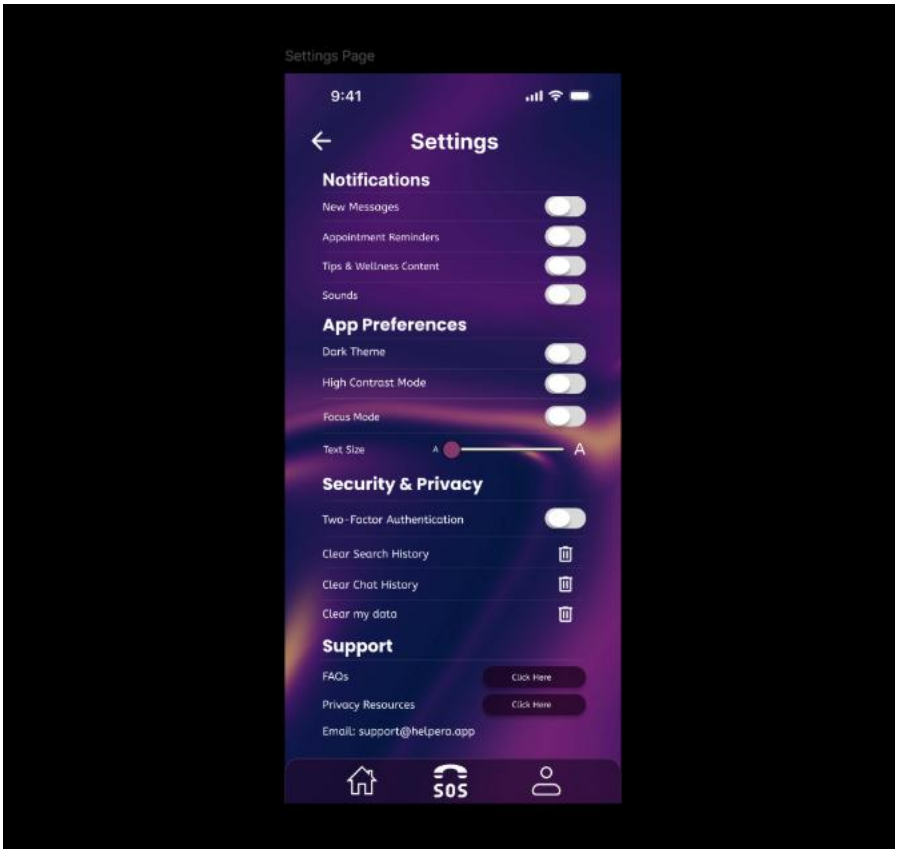


Figure 57: Updates Settings Page

6.2. Changes Implemented Based on Feedback Received

6.2.1. Clarity and Boundaries

- EraBot greeting updated to emphasize that the app is not a replacement for therapy and cannot provide medical or psychological treatment.
- Terms and Conditions, Privacy Resources, and FAQs have been expanded and made more visible, ensuring users understand what the app can and cannot do.
- Emotional check-ins now provide clear user options, including skipping journaling or unplugging, so users are not forced into any activity, respecting personal boundaries.

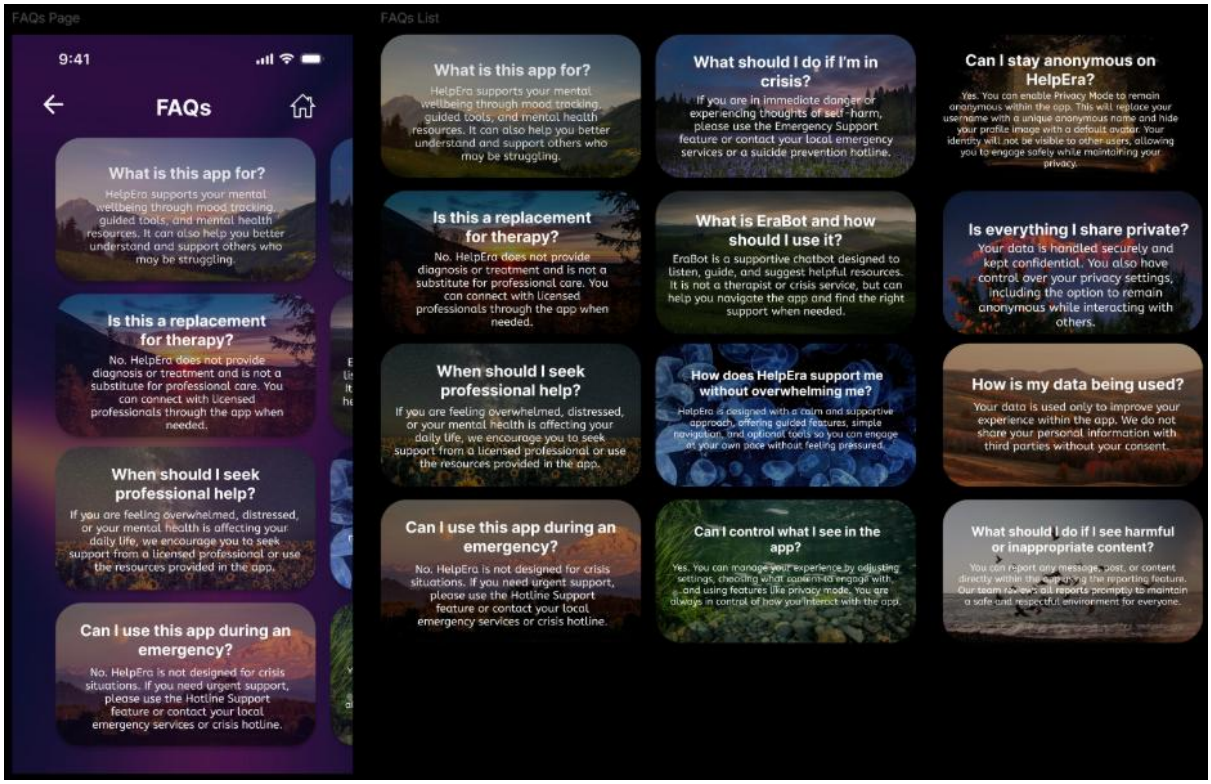


Figure 58: FAQs

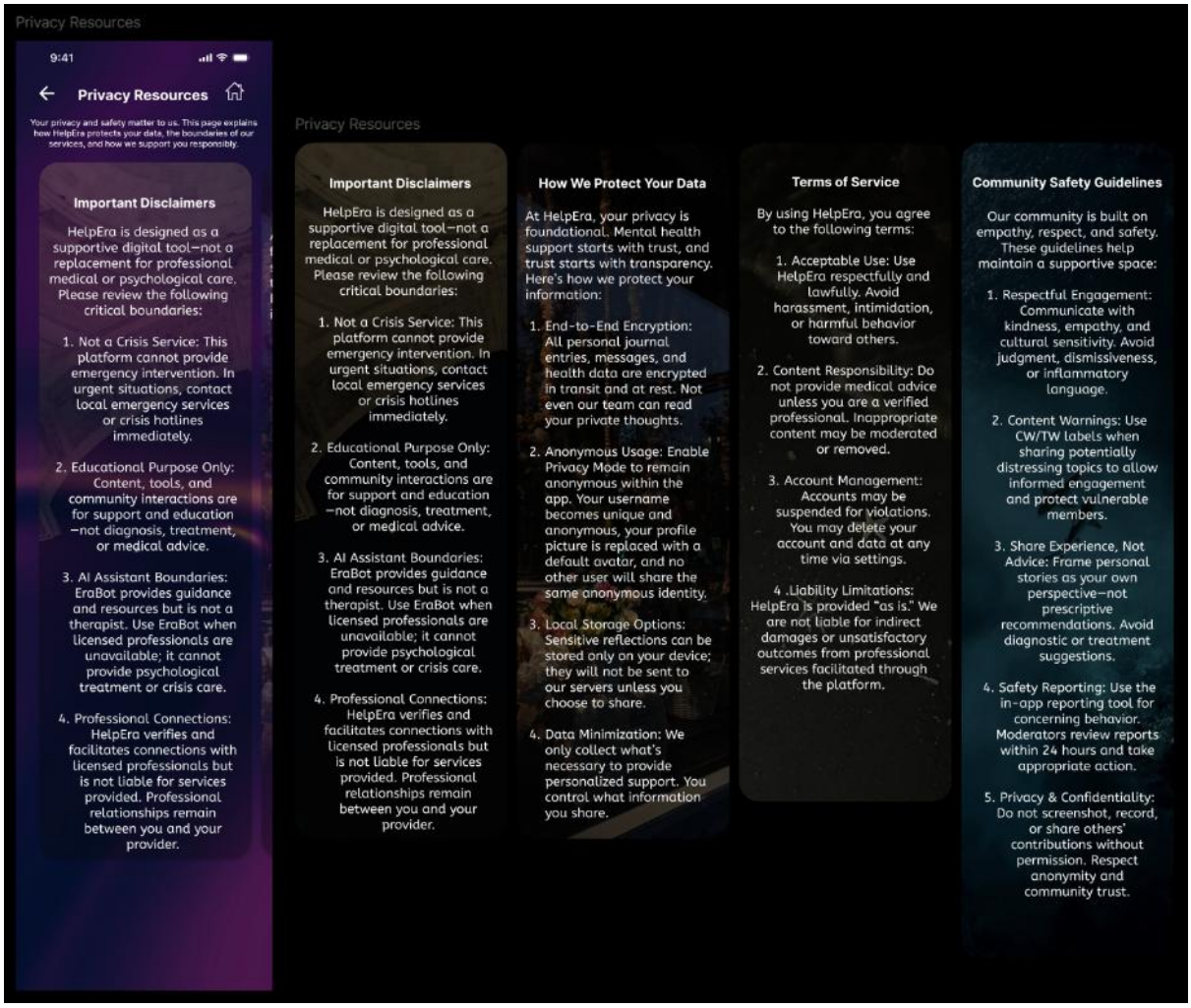


Figure 59: Privacy Resources

6.2.2. Privacy and Data Control

- Private Mode now ensures anonymity and unique usernames for safety.
- Clear My Data functionality added to empower users to remove personal data if desired.
- Journal sharing and professional communication flows include explicit consent steps, reinforcing privacy and user control.

6.2.3. Crisis and Escalation Protocols

- Emergency information updated to provide immediate guidance for users in danger, with alert notifications to professionals and an optional cancel mechanism.
- The app now clearly communicates help availability, including breathing exercises and professional escalation, reducing ambiguity in high-risk situations.

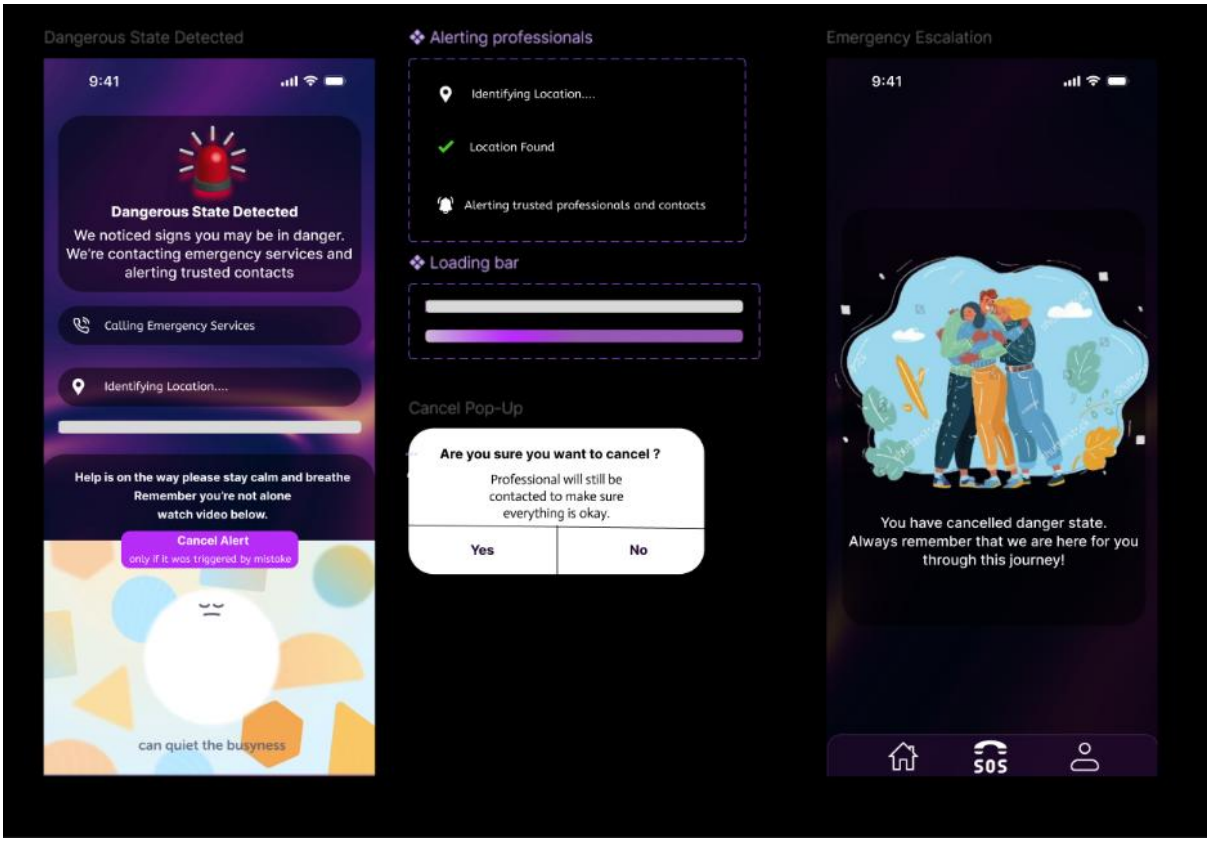


Figure 60: Emergency Escalation

6.2.4. Content and User Experience

- Learning modules include completion confirmation and clear progression steps, helping users understand their journey.
- Reporting mechanisms expanded across articles, messages, and chats to maintain safety and accountability.
- Visual and functional updates across community, journal, and progress pages improve usability and transparency, supporting a calm, trust-building user experience.

7. Handoff Report

7.1. Figma Prototype Link

https://www.figma.com/proto/dsLX75NhBuBNsLqNu9tgYn/Uxplorers---HelpEra?node-id=1161-2608&p=f&t=cPaprE9YcWbbc4hj-1&scaling=scale-down&content-scaling=fixed&page-id=0%3A1&starting-point-node-id=1161%3A2608&show-proto-sidebar=1

7.2. Design System

This section outlines the visual design elements used in the app, focusing on color and typography. These components work together to create a consistent, accessible, and user-friendly interface while reinforcing the app's identity. Thoughtful use of color and text styling helps improve readability, guide user interaction, and enhance the overall user experience, ensuring both aesthetic appeal and functional clarity throughout the design.

7.2.1. Colors

Proper contrast improves legibility and accessibility, while consistent color usage shows branding and usability. Color choices can influence user emotions and highlight system status. In high-fidelity prototypes, color must serve both aesthetic and functional purposes rather than decorative. Effective color use enhances clarity, hierarchy, and user engagement.

HelpEra's color palette is chosen to promote emotional calm and tranquility, while yellow hue streaks add warmth and subtle visual interest. Sidebar images with low opacity, home page boxes, bottom navigation bars, and learn page visuals use complimentary soft colors to differentiate content without overwhelming the user. Color is also used functionally, such as toggle buttons and animations in the breathing exercise to use soft transitions to guide attention and promote relaxation.

7.2.2. Typography

Help Era's typography system is chosen because it helps create a calm and comforting user experience, which is particularly important given the nature of mental health. The typography has been chosen due to clarity and reduction of cognitive node. This all helps create an emotional connection between users and the Help Era app.

7.2.2.1. Font Selection

The Help Era utilizes a variety of typefaces, inter (for headings) & ABeeZee (for Body Text), to create an approachable yet clear user experience.

- Inter is chosen as a typeface for headings because it is simple, elegant and possesses extreme legibility making it useful in providing emphasis on important content.
- ABeeZee has been chosen, as the body text typeface, due to its simplicity, high legibility and clarity aiding in reading long quantities of text comfortably.

The use of these two typefaces creates a balanced visual identity for both contributors and users that is professional and approachable.

7.2.2.2. Structure and Hierarchy

Designed to allow users to quickly absorb content by implementing a clearly defined typographic hierarchy throughout the site

- **Headings (H1, H2):**
  Large and bold (Inter) to help clearly position major sections of the site to allow for easy navigation.
- **Subheadings:**
  Medium weight to organize the content on the page and provide easy reading.
- **Body Text:**
  The body text on the pages (ABeeZee) is sized for comfortable reading with no strain on the user's vision.
- **Labels and Captions:**
  The label/caption text size is smaller than the body text to provide for the addition of secondary content (hint, tag, alert messages).

This structure aids users in quickly finding relevant information that can be crucial for someone during emotional distress.

7.2.2.3. Reliability and accessibility

When designing the typography to maximize inclusive accessibility, our goal was to have:

- Fonts that can be resized based on individual user's vision-related requirements.
- Text that has high-contrast rates to easily be read in both dark and light backgrounds.
- Sufficient line-spacing and padding around text items so there is not too much visual "clutter".
- Limited use of decorative fonts to provide clear text layout

We also created the application for use with screen reader applications and converting speech into text, so that visually impaired and hearing-impaired users can access all the application text elements using their respective assistive devices and still interact in real-time with the application.

7.2.2.4. Tone and Emotional Design

The use of typography contributes to an overall welcoming, calming, non-clinical tone. The clean, simple appearance of both Inter and ABeeZee create an environment where users will feel encouraged to interact independently and comfortably with content that may be sensitive in nature.

7.2.2.5. Consistency

The typography is consistently applied throughout the entire screen set, creating a coherent experience for users when using Help Era. By using the same font, size, and spacing throughout the application it makes the user's interaction with the product much easier to learn and creates a strong sense of familiarity with the Help Era interface.

7.3. Components and Assets

This section outlines the key interactive elements and visual assets used throughout HelpEra. These components, including buttons, icons, and navigation elements, are designed to support user interaction, ensure consistency, and enhance usability. By maintaining a clear hierarchy and standardized design, these elements help create a seamless and intuitive user experience across all features of the app.

7.3.1. Primary Action Buttons

The app utilizes primary action buttons to guide users through key tasks such as Login, Sign-Up, Submit, and Save Entry. These buttons are prominently displayed to ensure visibility and encourage user

interaction at critical stages of the user flow. They are consistently styled across the app to maintain familiarity and usability.

7.3.2. Secondary Action Buttons

Secondary buttons are used for supportive or optional actions, such as Skip, Cancel, Go Back, and Explore Articles. These buttons allow users to navigate flexibly without disrupting the main flow. While still accessible, they are visually less dominant than primary buttons to maintain a clear hierarchy.

7.3.3. Confirmation and Decision Buttons

Throughout the app, users encounter confirmation-based buttons that support decision-making processes. Examples include “I Understand and Agree”, Logout Confirmation (Confirm/Cancel), and Finish or Continue options in activities like breathing exercises. These buttons ensure that users intentionally proceed with important actions.

7.3.4. Emotion Selection Buttons

On the Check-In Page, emotion-based buttons such as Radiant, Steady, Drained, Restless, Heavy, and Exasperated allow users to express their current emotional state. These buttons are designed to be intuitive and visually engaging, enabling quick and meaningful interaction.

7.3.5. Navigation Buttons

Navigation is supported through both sidebar and bottom navigation elements. The sidebar menu buttons including Learn, Community, Talk to a Professional, and My Journal allow users to move between major sections of the app. Additionally, the bottom navigation bar includes three key icons: Home, SOS, and Profile, ensuring quick access to essential features from any page.

7.3.6. Interactive Content Buttons

Within content sections such as the Learn Page and Healing Guides, buttons like Start Healing Guide, Explore Articles, and module-specific options (e.g., Understanding, Coping, Helping Someone) allow users to engage with educational material. These buttons help structure the learning experience into manageable steps.

7.3.7. Communication and Interaction Icons

The app includes several icons to support communication features within chats and calls. These include:

- Reply icon for responding to messages
- Report icon for flagging inappropriate content
- Call icon for initiating voice or video calls
- Microphone (Mute/Unmute) icon
- Speaker toggle icon
- Camera toggle icon
- Transcription icon for converting voice messages into text

These icons are designed to be universally recognizable and are consistently applied across public chats, private chats, and group interactions.

7.3.8. Search and Filter Icons

Search functionality is supported by a **search icon and search bar**, allowing users to find content, professionals, or conversations efficiently. Filter options are also provided, particularly in Talk to a Professional section, to refine search results based on user preferences.

Journal and Content Interaction Buttons

In the journal section, users interact with buttons such as Save Entry, History, and navigation options within the sidebar (My Journal, My Progress, Mood Data). These buttons support content creation and review without adding unnecessary complexity.

7.3.9. Sharing and Action Buttons

The app also includes a Share button within the Journal History section, allowing users to share specific journal entries with a selected professional. This feature supports more personalized and context-aware communication by enabling users to provide direct insight into their thoughts and experiences. The share functionality is designed to be simple and intentional, ensuring that users have control over which entries are shared. This enhances the connection between users and professionals while maintaining user privacy and consent.

7.3.10. Journal and Content Interaction Buttons

In the journal section, users interact with buttons such as Save Entry, History, and navigation options within the sidebar (My Journal, My Progress, Mood Data). These buttons support content creation and review without adding unnecessary complexity.

Additionally, within the journal guidance feature, users are provided with structured navigation buttons including Next, Back, and Skip. These allow users to either follow the guided walkthrough of the journal section, revisit previous instructions, or skip the guide entirely based on their preference. This ensures that users can learn the feature at their own pace without feeling restricted or overwhelmed.

7.3.11. Support and Reporting Buttons

The app includes dedicated buttons for reporting issues, accessible in multiple sections such as chats and the profile page. Users can report concerns related to self-harm, harassment, inappropriate content, privacy issues, or technical problems. These buttons ensure user safety and platform accountability.

7.3.12. Profile and Settings Icons

Within the Profile Page, users can interact with icons and buttons such as Settings, Hotlines, Report, and Logout. The toggle icon for private mode allows users to control anonymity. In the Settings section, additional options like FAQs and Privacy Resources are accessible through clearly labeled buttons.

7.4. HTA of User Interactions

This Hierarchical Task Analysis (HTA) outlines the step-by-step breakdown of how users interact with the HelpEra app to manage their mental health and access support systems.

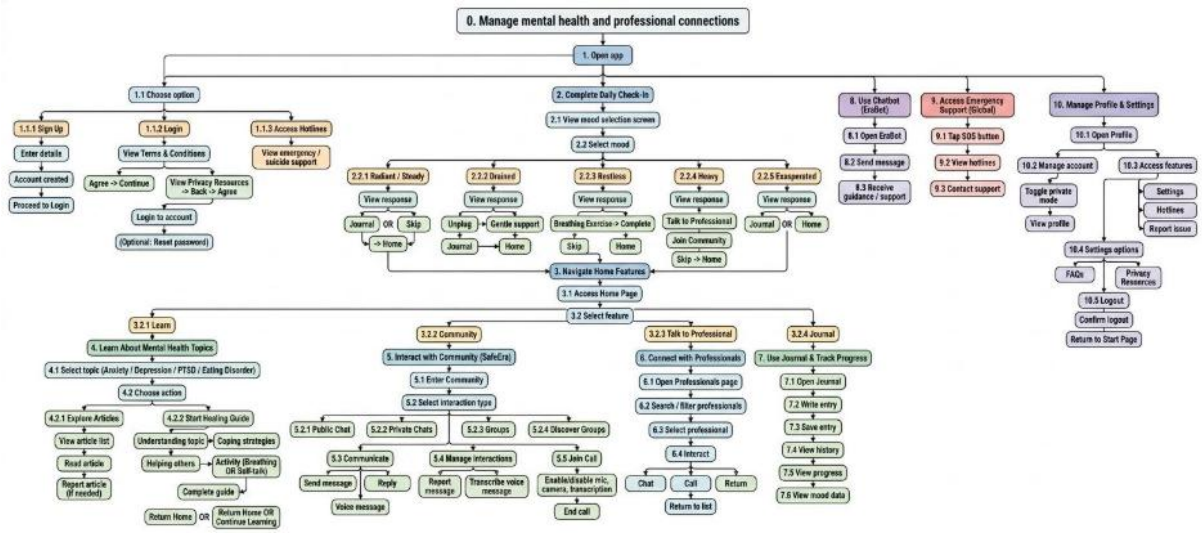


Figure 61: HTA Diagram

7.4.1. Startup Page

Upon opening the Safe Era app, users are presented with the startup page, which provides three primary options: Login, Sign-Up, and Hotlines. Selecting the sign-up option prompts the user to enter their details. Upon successful account creation, the user receives confirmation and is guided to log in. When proceeding to log in, users are directed to a Terms and Conditions page, where they can either select “I Understand and Agree” to continue to the login page or “View Full Privacy Resources”, which leads to a dedicated privacy resources page. From the privacy resources page, users may return to the account-created confirmation page to complete the login process. Users may also reset their passwords as needed before logging in. The Hotlines option provides access to emergency and suicide hotlines, now supported with clear descriptions and direct call functionality.

7.4.2. Check-In Page

After logging in, users arrive at the Check-In Page, which prompts them to indicate how they are feeling through a selection of six emotions: Radiant, Steady, Drained, Restless, Heavy, and Exasperated. Based on the selected emotion, a supportive response message is displayed, with options tailored to each state. Users feeling radiant or steady may choose to journal their thoughts or skip directly to the homepage. Users who feel drained are offered options to Unplug, journal, or skip. Selecting Unplug directs them to

a gentle support page that encourages small, manageable actions before returning to the homepage. For the restless emotion, users may choose to engage in a breathing exercise. Users who are feeling heavy are given the option to connect with a professional or a peer or skip to the homepage. Those feeling exasperated may journal or skip. The addition of flexible options such as skips, unplugs, and guided support ensures that users are not forced into a single action, supporting user autonomy and emotional boundaries.

7.4.3. Homepage and Sidebar Navigation

The Homepage features a sidebar menu with four sections: Learn, Community, Talk to a Professional, and My Journal, allowing users to easily navigate between core features of the app.

7.4.4. Learn Page

On the Learn page, users can explore topics including depression, anxiety, PTSD, and eating disorders, or search for other topics. Selecting a topic directs users to the "You're Not Alone" page, which offers two primary pathways: Start Healing Guide or Explore Articles, along with access to emergency support.

- **Start Healing Guide:** For anxiety, depression, and PTSD, the guide includes modules on Understanding, Coping, Helping Someone, and Breathing Exercises. For eating disorders, the fourth module is replaced with Practice Positive Self-Talk. Users can navigate each module and return to the guide. Upon completion, a completion page confirms progress and allows users to continue learning or return home.
- **Explore Articles:** Users can browse and search articles related to the selected topic. Articles can also be reported for issues such as inaccurate information, outdated content, or inappropriate material.

In addition, the Learn section now includes an enhanced emergency escalation feature. When users indicate a potential crisis or access emergency information, they may be directed to a "Dangerous State Detected" page, which provides immediate guidance, alerts support systems and offers calming resources such as breathing exercises. Users are given the option to cancel the alert, while still ensuring that appropriate support measures are considered. This feature strengthens user safety and reinforces responsible crisis handling.

7.4.5. Community Page

The Community section includes Public Chat, Private Chats, Your Groups, and Discover Groups, creating spaces for both open and controlled interactions.

• **Public Chat:** Users can communicate with all users, with options to reply, report messages, or transcribe voice messages. Voice messages are supported, and calls include features such as mute/unmute, speaker, camera controls, transcription, and a members list for group visibility.

• **Private Chats:** These function similarly to public chats but are one-on-one. Users can reply, report, copy text, or transcribe voice messages, and initiate calls with similar controls.

• **Your Groups:** Displays joined groups with tabs for All, Unread, and Favorites, and group chats follow the same interaction structure as public chats. Within each group chat, users can tap on the group name to view the group's information page, which includes the group's description, member list, and other relevant details.

• **Discover Groups:** Users can explore groups under Featured, Similar, and Trending categories and join them. All group interactions follow consistent chat and call functionalities.

7.4.6. Talk to a Professional Page

Talk to a Professional page allows users to connect with mental health professionals through a searchable and filterable directory. Featured professionals are displayed with profiles, and users can initiate chat or call sessions. Communication includes features such as transcription, mute/unmute, camera controls, and reporting options. Searching for professionals directs users to a matched results page, ensuring efficient access to appropriate support.

7.4.7. My Journal Page

The My Journal section enables users to write, save, and review journal entries. Users can access their journal history through a dedicated History button and navigate entries by selecting specific dates using an interactive calendar. Additionally, users can share selected journal entries with professionals, enabling more personalized and context-aware support.

To support first-time use, a journal guidance feature is introduced when users enter this section. Users are prompted with the option to view a guided walkthrough ("Show Me Around") or skip it. If selected, the guide explains key features within the journal page, helping users better understand its functionality.

During this walkthrough, users can navigate using Next, Back, or Skip options, allowing them to proceed at their own pace or exit the guide at any time.

The sidebar within this section includes My Journal, Mood Data, My Progress, and EraBot. The Mood Data page allows users to track emotional patterns over time, while the My Progress page supports interactive features such as adding notes and photos, with categorized viewing options.

7.4.8. EraBot

The EraBot feature allows users to interact with a chatbot designed to provide guidance, check-ins, and coping suggestions. The chatbot now clearly communicates its limitations by stating that it is not a licensed professional and cannot provide medical or psychological treatment. This ensures transparency and reinforces appropriate boundaries within the app.

7.4.9. Bottom Navigation Bar

A persistent bottom navigation bar is available across all pages, featuring Home, SOS, and Profile icons. The SOS button provides immediate access to emergency hotline services, ensuring quick support when needed.

7.4.10. Profile Page

The Profile page displays the user's avatar and username and includes an option to edit the profile picture. Users can toggle Private Mode, which anonymizes their identity by hiding their profile picture and assigning a unique anonymous username. The page also includes options for Settings, Hotline Services, Report, and Logout. Logging out prompts a confirmation pop-up and returns the user to the startup page.

7.4.11. Settings Page

The Settings page allows users to manage notifications, app preferences, security, privacy, and support. Enhancements include a text size adjustment slider, a Clear My Data option for improved privacy control, and expanded support features. The Support section now includes FAQs, Privacy Resources, and contact email access. FAQs have been significantly expanded to address user concerns regarding app usage, privacy, and when to seek professional help. Navigation from the Settings page returns users to the Profile page and then to the Homepage as needed.

7.5. Developer Instructions

This section outlines the potential future development of the app beyond its current Figma prototype. These instructions serve as a guide for how the app could evolve if further development is pursued, ensuring scalability, reliability, and an enhanced user experience.

7.5.1. Backend Development and Infrastructure

As the current prototype has been developed using Figma, the next major step involves building a robust backend infrastructure to support the app's functionality. This includes implementing secure user authentication systems for login and sign-up, database management for storing user data such as journal entries, chat histories, and progress tracking, and real-time communication systems for messaging and calling features. Additionally, APIs must be developed or integrated to support features such as emergency hotline access, professional directories, and content delivery for learning resources. Ensuring data privacy, encryption, and compliance with relevant regulations will be critical at this stage.

7.5.2. Integration of Advanced Features and AI Support

Future development should focus on enhancing the app's functionality through intelligent features. This includes implementing AI-driven components such as the Error Bot for responsive and context-aware conversations, mood analysis based on user inputs, and personalized recommendations for content and support resources. Features like voice transcription, sentiment detection, and adaptive check-in responses can further improve user experience. These additions will require training models, integrating third-party AI services, or developing custom algorithms to ensure accuracy and reliability.

7.5.3. Cross-Platform Development and Scalability

To ensure wider accessibility and long-term growth, the app should be developed for multiple platforms, including iOS, Android, and potentially a web-based version. This involves choosing appropriate frameworks and technologies that support cross-platform compatibility while maintaining performance and design consistency. Additionally, the system should be designed with scalability in mind, allowing it to handle increasing numbers of users, real-time interactions, and large volumes of data without performance issues. Planning for cloud integration, server optimization, and efficient data handling will be essential to support future expansion.

7.5.4. Partnerships and Content Validation

For future development, establishing partnerships with certified mental health professionals, organizations, and support networks will be essential to ensure the accuracy and reliability of the app's content. This includes collaborating with licensed therapists to validate learning materials, healing guides, and chatbot responses. Additionally, partnerships with emergency hotline providers and mental health organizations can help strengthen the app's support system and improve accessibility to real-world resources. Regular content reviews and updates will also be necessary to maintain credibility, ensure ethical standards, and provide users with safe and trustworthy guidance.

7.5.5. User Feedback and Iterative Development

Help Era will require future development to include well-structured strategies used to collect customer feedback, including in app surveys, ratings, and feedback forms. Customer feedback will be used to help the development team identify any problems with usability and determine how well the features of Help Era are being utilized and support ongoing improvements to the platform.

Help Era must continue to utilize an iterative development methodology, such as Agile, to respond to customer input and real-world usage through regular, iterative releases of the product based on customer and system feedback. Through continuous releases, Help Era will remain relevant and user-centred in meeting mental health needs.

7.5.6. Notification and Engagement System

Help Era needs an effective adaptive notification system to enhance users' continued engagement. This means that the app will send reminders to users to: Journal, check-in emotionally, and attend scheduled appointments with a professional.

Help Era Notifications will allow users to personalise their notification preferences and reduce the risk of becoming overwhelmed by the number of notifications they receive. Furthermore, all notifications must use a supportive, non-intrusive tone of voice that aligns with the app's intended emotional safety. Over time, the system will adapt to the individual user's behaviour and send messages in a more personalised and contextualised manner to increase relevance and engagement.

7.5.7. Deployment and maintenance

The Help Era application will be made available for download from major application stores like the Apple App Store and Google Play. Throughout this process, the Help Era project will ensure the application meets all necessary compliance standards and guidelines of each respective application store prior to it being made available for people to download.

There will be a constant need for ongoing maintenance of the Help Era application to maintain reliable use and performance of the application. Ongoing maintenance will include regular features and bug fixes to continue to provide a smooth user experience, and ongoing updates to ensure continued compatibility with all operating system and device updates as technology changes.

Each application will be equipped with monitoring tools to capture user usage and system performance, which will aid in identifying issues early and maintaining a high-quality and dependable Help Era platform.

8. Contribution Matrix

Contribution Matrix for the final prototype (Figma) development:

Team Member	Contribution to High-Fidelity Prototype
Resham Furqan	Designed the Report Button, Forms and Submission pages, Mood Pages, and Journal Pages
Blessed Dendere	Designed the Structured Prompts to guide user interactions
Natalee De Silva	Designed the Graph Visualization component and implemented dynamic data display
Maria Waheed	Designed the Interactive Keyboard component and its associated interactions
Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba	Designed the Article Cards component, including the layout and content hierarchy
All Members	Participated in design critiques, user flow discussions, and iterative refinement of all components.

Table 10: Contribution Matrix 1

Contribution Matrix for the Final Report Writing

Section	Task Description	Assigned Member
Front Matter	Title Page, table of Contents, List of Tables and Figures	Resham Furqan
Section 1	Introduction, Purpose, and Ethical Considerations	Resham Furqan
Section 2	Usability Testing Plan	Resham Furqan
Section 3	Piloting	Blessed Dendere
Section 4	Experimental Data Collection Summary	Maria Waheed
Section 5.1	Participant Demographics	Kekeweditse Mogoba
Section 5.2	Task Completion Results	Maria & Blessed
Section 5.3	A/B Testing Results	Natalee De Silva
Section 5.4	Key Findings and Themes (Synthesis)	Team
Section 5.5	Prioritized Issues	Resham Furqan
Section 5.6	Recommendations for Improvement	Team
Section 6	Final high-Fidelity Prototype Design Description	Natalee De Silva
Section 7.1	Figma Prototype Link	Resham Furqan
Section 7.2 – 7.5	Design System, Components, User Flows, Developer Instructions	Natalee & Kekweditse
Section 8	Contribution Matrix	Resham Furqan
Section 9	References	Team
Section 10	Appendices (Consent, Data Sheets, Screenshots)	Resham Furqan
Appendix D	Meeting Minutes	Natalee De Silva
Appendix E	Curtin Ignition Form	Team
Posters	Conference Poster and Advertising Poster	Team
Final Steps	Report Compilation and Formatting	Resham Furqan
Final Steps	Final Proofread	Team

Table 11: Contribution Matrix 2

9. References

1. Moran, Kate. 2019. “Usability (User) Testing 101.” Nielsen Norman Group. December 1, 2019. https://www.nngroup.com/articles/usability-testing-101/.
2. Canva 2025. “Canva.” Canva. 2025. https://www.canva.com/.
3. Google. 2025. “Gemini.” Gemini.google.com. Google. 2025. https://gemini.google.com/.

10. Appendices

Appendix A: Consent Forms

HELPERA USABILITY TESTING

Consent Form



Project Title: HelpEra Mental Health Support App Usability Testing	
Research Team: UXplorers	Course: Human Computer Interface
Tutor: Ms Shahra Jafar Ali	
Tutor Contact: shahra.jaffarali@curtin.edu.au	Team contact: 22526025@student.curtin.edu.au

PURPOSE OF THIS STUDY

This usability test is being conducted to evaluate the HelpEra mobile application prototype. The goal is to understand how users interact with the app and identify areas for improvement. This is a student project, and the prototype is for educational purposes only; it does not provide actual mental health advice or services.

PARTICIPANT INVOLVMENT

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to:

- Complete 5 tasks using the HelpEra prototype (approximately 20-25 minutes)
- "Think aloud" as you complete the tasks, sharing your thoughts and reactions
- Answer a few brief questions after testing about your experience

RISKS AND BENEFITS

- **Risks:** Minimal. Some topics relate to mental health support, but you are not required to share personal information. If you feel uncomfortable, you can stop at any time.
- **Benefits:** You will help improve a mental health support tool for young adults and gain insight into the usability testing process.

Figure 62: Consent Form Participant c (i)

CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA USE

- Your participation is completely anonymous
- You will be referred to only as "Participant 1, 2, 3..." in all notes and reports
- No personal identifying information will be collected or stored
- Screen recording and/or audio may be recorded for analysis purposes only
- All recordings and notes will be stored securely and deleted after the project is graded
- No real mental health information or personal experiences are required

VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION

- Your participation is completely voluntary
- You may withdraw at any time without giving a reason
- You may refuse to answer any questions
- There is no penalty for withdrawing

CONSENT AND AGREEMENT

I have read and understood the information above. I understand that:

- My participation is voluntary
- I can withdraw at any time
- My data will be anonymized
- This is a student prototype, not a clinical tool

□ I agree to participate in this usability study
□ I agree to audio/screen recording (optional)

PARTICIPANTS'S NAME: DAKSH CHAUHAN	PARTICIPANT'S SIGNATURE: DAKSH.C
DATE:	RESEARCHER SIGNATURE: MARIA.W

Figure 63: Consent Form Participant c (ii)

HELPERA USABILITY TESTING

Consent Form



Project Title: HelpEra Mental Health Support App Usability Testing	
Research Team: UXplorers	Course: Human Computer Interface
Tutor: Ms Shahra Jafar Ali	
Tutor Contact: shahra.jaffarali@curtin.edu.au	Team contact: 22526025@student.curtin.edu.au

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- **Benefits:** You will help improve a mental health support tool for young adults and gain insight into the usability testing process.

Figure 64: Consent Form Participant d (i)

CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA USE

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- My data will be anonymized
- This is a student prototype, not a clinical tool

□ I agree to participate in this usability study
□ I agree to audio/screen recording (optional)

PARTICIPANTS'S NAME: ADIL KHAN	PARTICIPANT'S SIGNATURE: ADIL.K
DATE:	RESEARCHER SIGNATURE: MARIA.W

Figure 65: Consent Form Participant d (ii)

HELPERA USABILITY TESTING

Consent Form



Project Title: HelpEra Mental Health Support App Usability Testing	
Research Team: UXplorers	Course: Human Computer Interface
Tutor: Ms Shahra Jafar Ali	
Tutor Contact: shahra.jaffarali@curtin.edu.au	Team contact: 22526025@student.curtin.edu.au

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- **Benefits:** You will help improve a mental health support tool for young adults and gain insight into the usability testing process.

Figure 66: Consent Form Participant e (i)

CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA USE

- Your participation is completely anonymous
- You will be referred to only as "Participant 1, 2, 3..." in all notes and reports
- No personal identifying information will be collected or stored
- Screen recording and/or audio may be recorded for analysis purposes only
- All recordings and notes will be stored securely and deleted after the project is graded
- No real mental health information or personal experiences are required

VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION

- Your participation is completely voluntary
- You may withdraw at any time without giving a reason
- You may refuse to answer any questions
- There is no penalty for withdrawing

CONSENT AND AGREEMENT

I have read and understood the information above. I understand that:

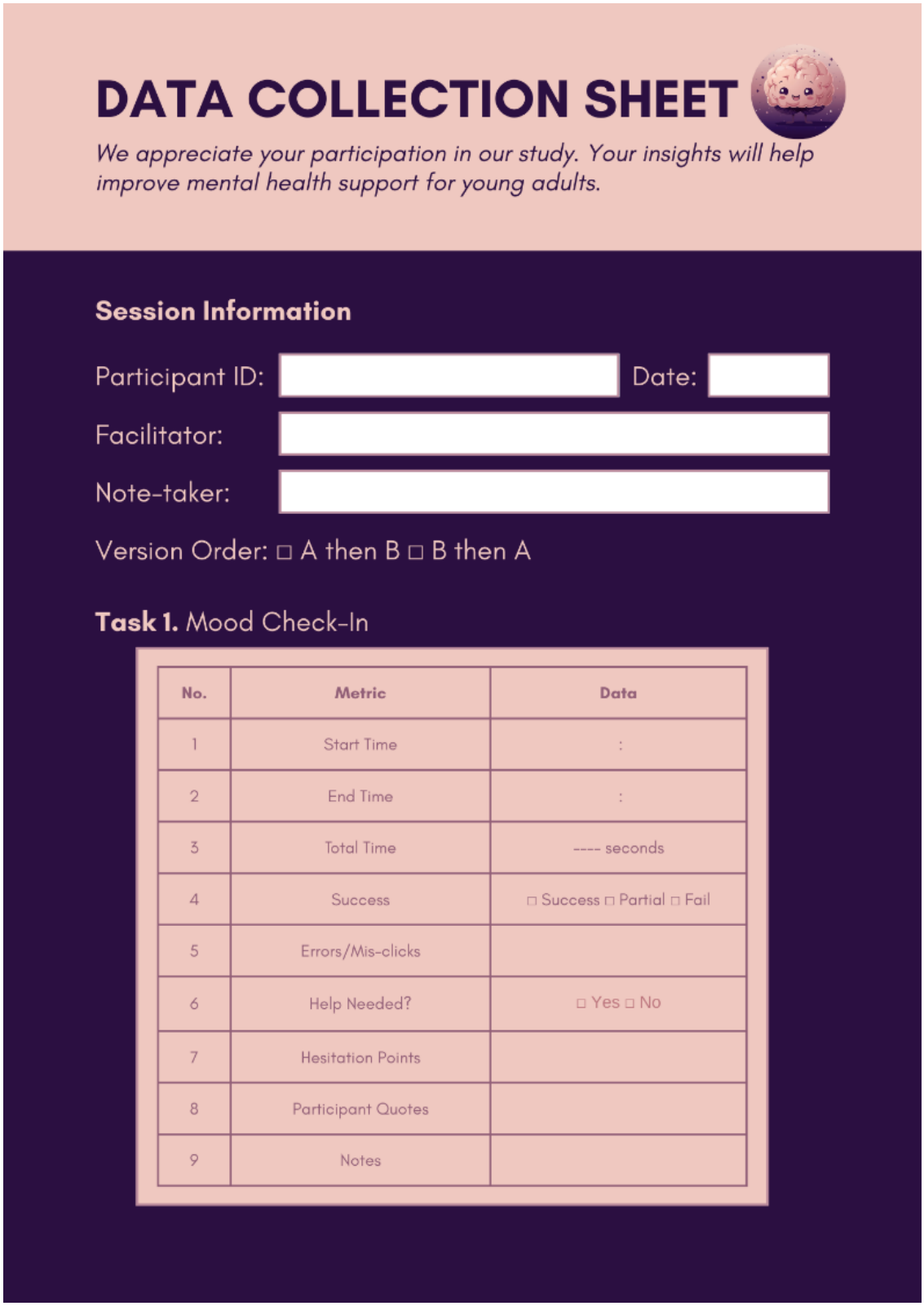
- My participation is voluntary
- I can withdraw at any time
- My data will be anonymized
- This is a student prototype, not a clinical tool

□ I agree to participate in this usability study
□ I agree to audio/screen recording (optional)

PARTICIPANTS'S NAME: NIMRA ASIF	PARTICIPANT'S SIGNATURE: NIMRA.A
DATE:	RESEARCHER SIGNATURE: MARIA.W

Figure 67: Consent Form Participant e (ii)

Appendix B: Data Collection Sheet



DATA COLLECTION SHEET

We appreciate your participation in our study. Your insights will help improve mental health support for young adults.

Session Information

Participant ID: _____ Date: _____

Facilitator: _____

Note-taker: _____

Version Order: □ A then B □ B then A

Task 1. Mood Check-In

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	:
2	End Time	:
3	Total Time	---- seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	
8	Participant Quotes	
9	Notes	

Figure 68: Data Collection Sheet (a)

Task 2. Breathing Exercise

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	:
2	End Time	:
3	Total Time	---- seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	
8	Participant Quotes	
9	Notes	

Task 3. Journal + History

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	:
2	End Time	:
3	Total Time	---- seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	
8	Participant Quotes	
9	Notes	

Figure 69: Data Collection Sheet (b)

Task 4. Community Interaction

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	:
2	End Time	:
3	Total Time	---- seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	
8	Participant Quotes	
9	Notes	

Task 5. Emergency Help

No.	Metric	Data
1	Start Time	:
2	End Time	:
3	Total Time	---- seconds
4	Success	□ Success □ Partial □ Fail
5	Errors/Mis-clicks	
6	Help Needed?	□ Yes □ No
7	Hesitation Points	
8	Participant Quotes	
9	Notes	

Figure 70: Data Collection Sheet (c)

Post-Test Questions:

1. Overall rating (1-5): _____
2. What did you like most? _____
3. What did you like least? _____
4. Version preference: □ A □ B □ No preference
5. Why? _____
6. One thing to change? _____
7. Would you use this app? Why/why not? _____

Figure 71: Data Collection (d)

Appendix C: Additional Screenshots

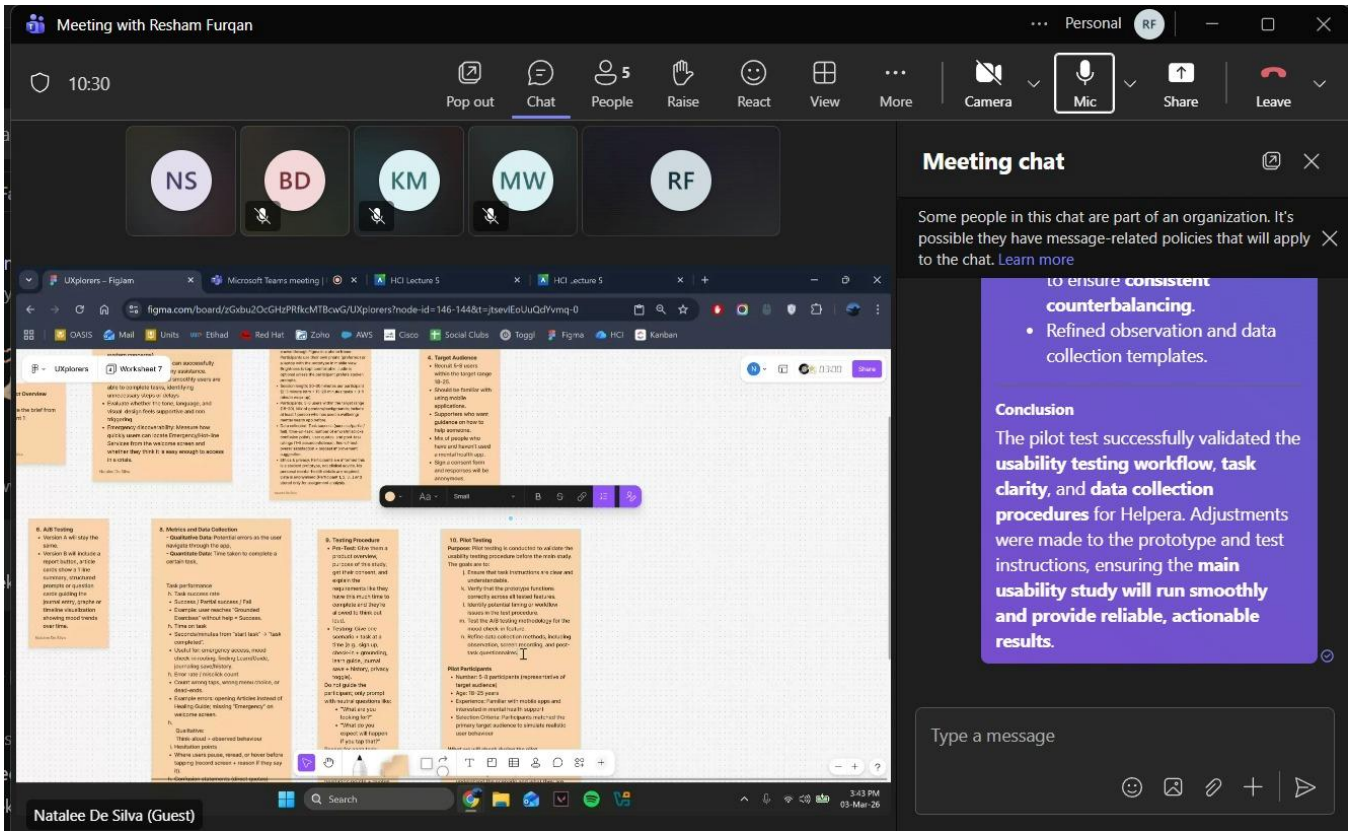


Figure 72: Team Collaboration (i)

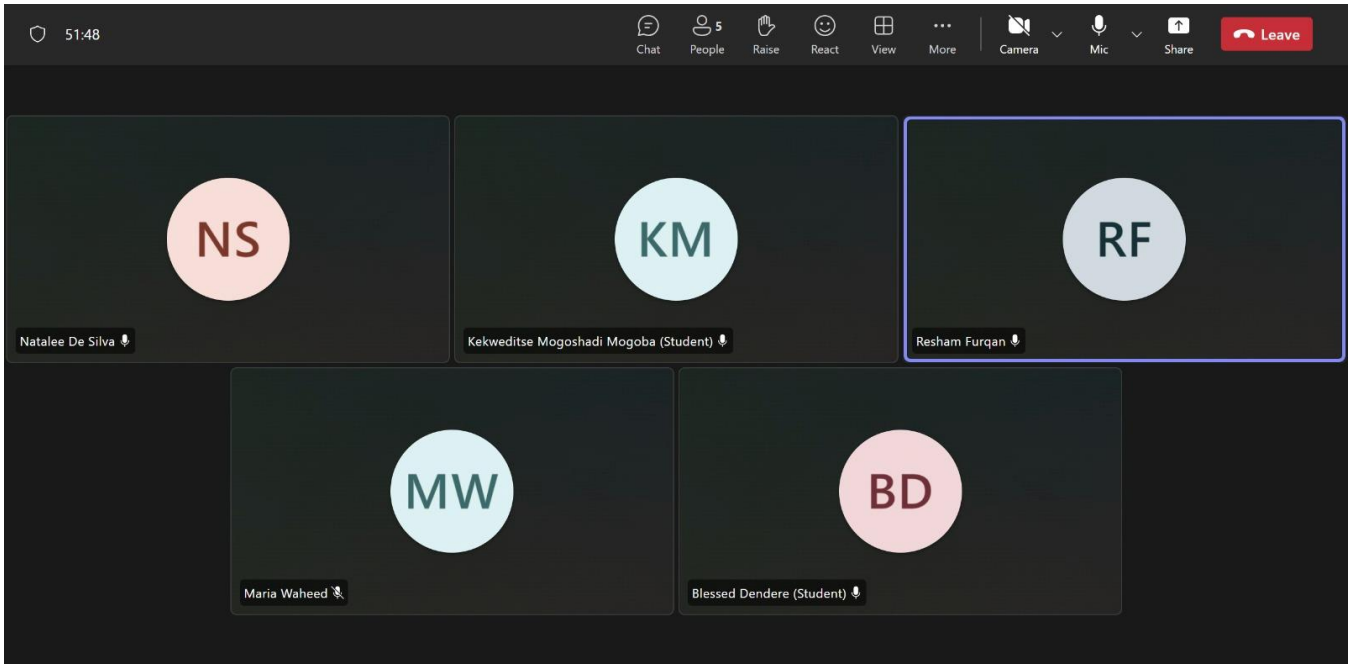


Figure 73: Team Collaboration (ii)

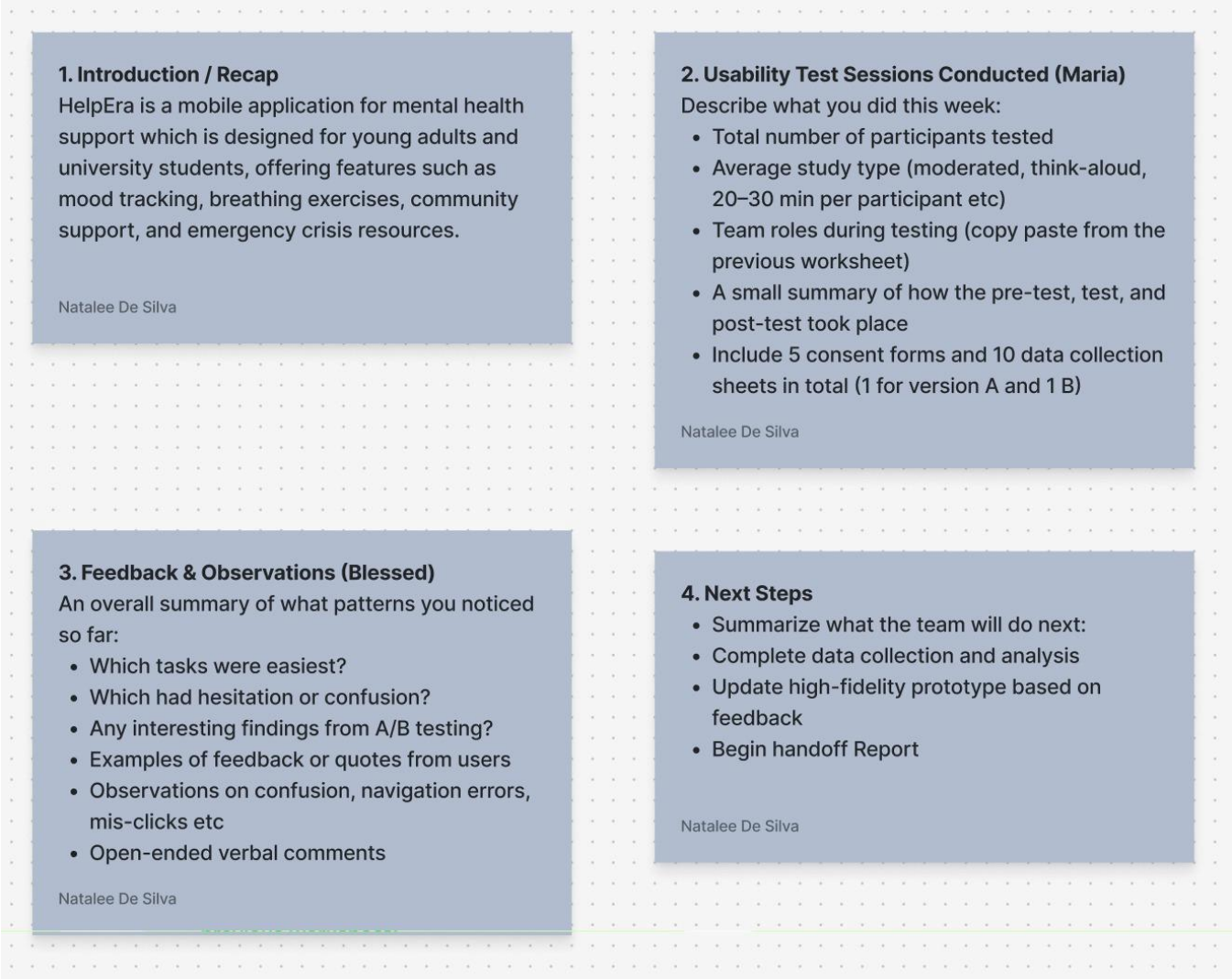


Figure 74: Team Collaboration (iii)

Appendix D: Meeting Minutes / Project Management Evidence

UXplorers – Minutes of Meeting – Worksheet 7

Name of Organisation/Committee/Board: UXplorers Team – HelpEra Project

Day & Date: Tuesday, 3rd of March 2026

Time: 2:30 – 3:45 PM

Location: Microsoft Teams (Virtual Meeting)

MINUTES PRESENT:

Resham Furqan

Maria Waheed

Blessed Dendere

Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba

Natalee De Silva

APOLOGIES:

None

ABSENT:

None

1. CALL TO ORDER / OPENING REMARKS

The meeting was called to order at **2:30 PM** by **Resham Furqan (Project Manager)**.

Opening remarks focused on planning the usability testing phase for the HelpEra mobile mental health support application. The team discussed the purpose of conducting usability testing to ensure that the high-fidelity prototype is intuitive, accessible, and supportive for users experiencing emotional stress.

During the discussion, **Natalee De Silva (Figma and Documentation Leader)** guided the team through the structure of the worksheet and explained several usability testing concepts, including A/B testing, usability metrics, and the think-aloud testing method. A collaborative FigJam board was opened during the meeting to allow team members to contribute ideas and responses in real time.

Natalee documented the team's inputs on the FigJam board while encouraging each member to provide feedback and suggestions. The team collectively discussed and refined the responses for each section of the usability testing plan.

2. APPROVAL OF THE AGENDA

Motion: To approve the agenda as circulated.

Motion By: **Resham Furqan**
Seconded By: **Natalee De Silva**

Carried.

Resolution: The meeting agenda was approved.

3. BUSINESS ARISING OUT OF THE PREVIOUS MEETING

a. The team reviewed progress on the HelpEra high-fidelity prototype and confirmed readiness to begin planning the usability testing phase.

b. The team agreed that usability testing would focus on evaluating core user tasks and the emotional experience of interacting with the application.

4. ITEM #1 TO BE DISCUSSED – Usability Testing Plan

a. **Summary of Discussion**

The team discussed the overall usability testing strategy for HelpEra. The usability study will use moderated usability testing with a think-aloud protocol, where participants verbalise their thoughts while interacting with the prototype.

Testing sessions will be conducted one-on-one, lasting approximately 20–30 minutes per participant. Participants will complete five key tasks representing the main features of the application:

- Completing a daily mood check-in
- Finding and starting a breathing exercise
- Creating a journal entry and locating it in journal history
- Exploring the community section and interacting with content

- Locating emergency or crisis support resources from the welcome screen

The team also discussed the importance of measuring both qualitative and quantitative data during testing.

Qualitative insights will include:

- Participant comments and think-aloud statements
- Hesitation points or confusion
- Observed behaviours and reactions

Quantitative metrics will include:

- Task success rate
- Time on task
- Error rate and mis-click count
- Post-task usability ratings

These measures will help identify usability issues and areas where the interface may not match user expectations.

b. **Motion**

No formal motion is required.

c. **Follow-Up Required**

The team agreed to recruit 5–8 participants who match the target audience for the application (HCI students aged 18–25).

d. **Action**

Resham Furqan will coordinate participant recruitment and manage consent forms prior to the start of usability testing in Week 10.

5. ITEM #2 TO BE DISCUSSED – Pilot Testing and Team Roles

a. **Summary of Discussion**

The team discussed the importance of conducting a pilot usability test before the main study. The pilot test will help ensure that:

- Task instructions are clear and understandable
- The prototype functions correctly
- Testing sessions fit within the planned timeframe
- Data collection methods work effectively

The pilot test will also verify the A/B testing variation, which introduces additional features such as guided journal prompts and mood trend graphs.

The team confirmed the following roles during usability testing sessions:

Maria Waheed – Facilitator

Responsible for guiding the session, reading task scenarios, and asking neutral questions.

Blessed Dendere – Note-Taker

Responsible for recording time on task, errors, user comments, and hesitation points.

Natalee De Silva – Technical Support and Documentation

Responsible for ensuring the Figma prototype functions correctly, managing the prototype interface, and documenting updates or adjustments to testing materials.

Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba – Observer

Responsible for monitoring participant behaviour, identifying confusion points, and noting non-verbal cues.

Resham Furqan – Project Manager

Responsible for scheduling testing sessions, managing consent forms, and coordinating project documentation.

b. **Motion**

No formal motion is required.

c. **Follow-Up Required**

The team agreed to conduct a pilot test with 1–2 participants before beginning the full usability testing study.

d. **Action**

Natalee De Silva will review the prototype and ensure that all screens, links, and interactive elements are functioning correctly before pilot testing begins in Week 10.

6. ADJOURNMENT

The meeting was adjourned at 3:45 PM by the Project Manager.

7. NEXT MEETING

The next meeting will take place during the Week 10 tutorial session, where the team will review pilot testing outcomes and begin conducting full usability testing sessions.

DISTRIBUTION OF MINUTES

The minutes will be finalised and reviewed by Natalee De Silva before being shared with the rest of the team. The minutes will be distributed within one week of the meeting.

Following the meeting, Natalee De Silva adjusted the answers captured in the FigJam board, and Resham Furqan integrated the responses into the final Word document as part of the project documentation.

UXplorers – Minutes of Meeting – Worksheet 8

Name of Organisation/Committee/Board: UXplorers Team – HelpEra Project

Day & Date: Tuesday, 10th March 2026

Time: 3:00 - 4:05 PM

Location: Microsoft Teams (Virtual Meeting)

MINUTES

PRESENT:

Resham Furqan

Maria Waheed

Blessed Dendere

Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba

Natalee De Silva

APOLOGIES:

None

ABSENT:

None

1. CALL TO ORDER / OPENING REMARKS

The meeting was called to order at 2:30 PM by Resham Furqan (Project Manager).

Opening remarks focused on reviewing and finalizing the Usability Test Plan for the HelpEra application. The team discussed the importance of conducting structured usability testing to evaluate effectively users can interact with the app's key features.

Team members contributed suggestions and feedback throughout the session, and the responses were refined collaboratively to ensure the test plan aligned with HCI usability testing guidelines.

2. APPROVAL OF THE AGENDA

Motion: To approve the agenda as circulated.

Motion By: Resham Furqan

Seconded By: Natalee De Silva

Carried.

Resolution: The meeting agenda was approved.

3. BUSINESS ARISING OUT OF THE PREVIOUS MEETING

a. The team reviewed progress on the usability test preparation following
the previous planned meeting.

b. It was confirmed that the usability testing plan would include moderated testing sessions, A/B testing comparisons, and both qualitative and quantitative data collection methods.

c. The team agreed to begin preparing materials required for usability testing, including participant recruitment and testing scripts.

4. ITEM #1 TO BE DISCUSSED – Usability Testing Plan

a. Summary of Discussion

The team discussed the structure of the usability testing study for the HelpEra prototype.

The usability study will use moderated usability testing with a think-aloud protocol, allowing participants to verbalise their thoughts while interacting with the application.

Testing sessions will be conducted one-on-one, lasting approximately 20–30 minutes per participant. The sessions may take place in a quiet tutorial room or remotely via Microsoft Teams.

Participants will interact with the mobile prototype displayed in a phone frame within Figma.

The team agreed to recruit 5–8 participants aged 18–25, representing the primary target audience of university students who regularly use mobile applications.

The discussion also addressed ethical considerations, including:

- Informing participants that the prototype is part of a student project and does not provide clinical advice
- Avoiding the collection of sensitive personal mental health data

- Anonymizing participant information (Participant 1, Participant 2, etc.)
- Obtaining signed consent forms before testing

b. Motion

No formal motion required.

c. Follow-Up Required

The team agreed to recruit participants who match the target audience and prepare screening questions to ensure they meet the study criteria.

d. Action

Resham Furqan will organise the participant recruitment and schedule testing sessions before Week 10.

5. ITEM #2 TO BE DISCUSSED – User Tasks and A/B Testing

a. Summary of Discussion

The team reviewed the usability testing tasks designed to evaluate the main features of the HelpEra application.

Participants will complete five key tasks:

- Completing a daily mood check-in
- Finding and starting a breathing exercise
- Creating a journal entry and locating it in journal history
- Exploring the community section and interacting with posts
- Locating emergency crisis resources from the welcome screen

These tasks were selected to evaluate how easily users can navigate core functions and access support features.

The team also discussed implementing A/B testing to compare two interface versions:

Version A (Control):

Standard interface with mood check-in, journal, and community features.

Version B (Variation):

- Report button in community posts
- Article cards with one-line summaries
- Guided journal prompts
- Mood trend graphs

The hypothesis discussed by the team was that additional guided prompts and visual mood tracking would increase engagement and satisfaction without increasing cognitive load.

b. Motion

No formal motion required.

c. Follow-Up Required

The team agreed to ensure both prototype versions were functioning correctly before testing.

d. Action

Natalee De Silva will confirm that both prototype variations are functional within the Figma prototype.

6. ITEM #3 TO BE DISCUSSED – Data Collection and Testing Procedure

a. Summary of Discussion

The team discussed the data collection methods that will be used during usability testing.

Two types of data will be collected:

Qualitative Data

- Think-aloud comments
- Confusion statements and hesitation points
- Observed behaviour and body language

- Participant feedback during the post-test interview

Quantitative Data

- Task success rate (Success / Partial / Fail)
- Time-on-task measurements
- Error rates and mis-click counts
- Post-task usability ratings using a 1–5 scale

The testing procedure will include three stages:

Pre-Test (5 minutes)

Participants will be welcomed, the study purpose explained, and consent forms collected.

Testing Phase (15–20 minutes)

Participants will complete usability tasks while verbalising their thoughts.

Post-Test Interview (5 minutes)

Participants will answer questions regarding their experience, preferred interface version, and suggested improvements.

b. Motion

No formal motion required.

c. Follow-Up Required

Testing scripts and observation templates will be finalised before the pilot study.

d. Action

Blessed Dendere will assist in preparing the observation notes template for recording participant responses.

7. ITEM #4 TO BE DISCUSSED – Pilot Testing and Team Roles

a. Summary of Discussion

The team discussed conducting a **pilot test before the main usability study** to verify that the testing procedure works effectively.

The pilot test will evaluate:

- Whether task instructions are clear
- Whether the prototype functions correctly
- Whether the session fits within the planned time limit
- Whether data collection methods are effective

Adjustments may be made based on pilot results, including improving task wording, fixing navigation issues, and refining observation templates.

The team confirmed the following roles during usability testing sessions:

Maria Waheed – Facilitator
Guides the participant and reads the task scenarios.

Blessed Dendere – Note-Taker
Records task completion times, errors, and participant comments.

Natalee De Silva – Technical Support
Ensures the prototype functions correctly and assists with the Figma interface.

Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba – Observer
Monitors participant behaviour and identifies confusion points.

Resham Furqan – Project Manager
Coordinates testing sessions and manages consent documentation.

b. Motion

No formal motion required.

c. Follow-Up Required

The team agreed to conduct a pilot test with 1–2 participants before full usability testing begins.

d. Action

Pilot testing will be conducted in Week 10, after which necessary adjustments will be made before full testing begins.

8. ITEM #5 TO BE DISCUSSED – Prototype Updates

a. Summary of Discussion

The team reviewed updates made to the **high-fidelity prototype in Figma**. Screenshots of the updated interface were shown, highlighting improvements made to usability and navigation.

These updates ensure the prototype is ready for usability testing and accurately reflects the features being evaluated in the study.

9. ADJOURNMENT

The meeting was adjourned at 4:05 PM by the Project Manager.

10. NEXT MEETING

The next meeting will take place during Week 10, where the team will review the pilot testing outcomes and begin analysing usability data.

DISTRIBUTION OF MINUTES

The minutes will be finalised and reviewed by Natalee De Silva before being shared with the rest of the team. Following the meeting, the responses discussed during the session were documented and organised into the final worksheet submission by Resham Furqan.

UXplorers – Minutes of Meeting - Worksheet 9

Name of Organisation/Committee/Board: UXplorers Team – HelpEra Project

Day & Date: Tuesday, 17th March 2026

Time: 2:00 PM – 4:30 PM

Location: Tutorial Session / Microsoft Teams

MINUTES PRESENT:

Resham Furqan

Maria Waheed

Blessed Dendere

Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba

Natalee De Silva

APOLOGIES:

None

ABSENT:

None

1. CALL TO ORDER / OPENING REMARKS

The meeting was called to order at 2:00 PM by Resham Furqan (Project Manager).

The purpose of the meeting was to conduct usability testing for the HelpEra high-fidelity prototype and evaluate two design variations (Version A and Version B).

Natalee De Silva guided the team through the usability testing process, explaining the structure of the worksheet, testing methodology, and expectations for data collection. She also documented all required tasks and responsibilities on a FigJam board and ensured all members understood their roles.

Natalee facilitated collaboration by gathering input from all team members, providing feedback, and ensuring all ideas were clearly recorded for later documentation.

2. APPROVAL OF THE AGENDA

Motion: To approve the agenda as circulated.

Motion By: Resham Furqan

Seconded By: Natalee De Silva

Carried.

Resolution: The meeting agenda was approved.

3. BUSINESS ARISING OUT OF THE PREVIOUS MEETING

a. The team confirmed that the usability test plan had been finalised and was ready for execution.

b. The team reviewed prototype updates and ensured both Version A and Version B were ready for testing.

4. ITEM #1 TO BE DISCUSSED – Conducting Usability Testing

a. Summary of Discussion

The team conducted usability testing using a moderated think-aloud approach. Participants were asked to complete five key tasks:

- Mood Check-In
- Breathing Exercise
- Journal Entry and History
- Community Interaction
- Emergency Help Access

Each participant interacted with both versions of the prototype while verbalising their thoughts, decisions, and any confusion encountered.

The testing process was divided into three stages:

- **Pre-Test:** Participants were briefed, consent was obtained, and instructions were provided.
- **During Test:** Participants completed tasks while being observed and recorded.

- **Post-Test:** Participants provided feedback through a questionnaire, including preferences between Version A and Version B.

Data was collected through observation, think-aloud feedback, task completion time, error tracking, and post-test responses.

The team evaluated usability based on efficiency, effectiveness, learnability, and user satisfaction.

b. Motion

No formal motion was required.

c. Follow-Up Required

The team agreed to analyse usability testing results and identify key usability issues and user preferences between Version A and Version B.

d. Action

Maria Waheed will organise and finalise data collection forms for usability testing results.

Blessed Dendere will compile participant feedback and observations from testing sessions.

Natalee De Silva will compile all findings into the final documented report after the session.

5. ITEM #2 TO BE DISCUSSED – Design Feedback and Task Allocation

a. Summary of Discussion

Natalee De Silva led a feedback session where she provided input to each team member and also gathered feedback from the group. Based on usability testing insights, specific design improvements were assigned:

- Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba will refine alignment, spacing, and layout adjustments, particularly on the Learn pages.
- Resham Furqan will refine the Check-In pages to improve clarity and usability.
- Maria Waheed will improve interactivity by making the keyboard functional and designing hotline call pages.

- Blessed Dendere will ensure consistency across Community pages.
- Natalee De Silva will implement a feature allowing users to share journal entries and progress with other users and professionals.

b. Motion

No formal motion was required.

c. Follow-Up Required

All team members are required to complete their assigned design improvements before the next meeting.

d. Action

All team members will complete assigned updates before the next session.

Resham Furqan will review, refine, and compile all final work into the official document.

6. ADJOURNMENT

The meeting was adjourned at 4:30 PM by Resham Furqan.

DISTRIBUTION OF MINUTES

The minutes will be finalised and reviewed by Natalee De Silva before being shared with the team within one week.

UXplorers – Minutes of Meeting – Worksheet 10

Name of Organisation/Committee/Board: UXplorers Team – HelpEra Project

Day & Date: Tuesday, 24th March 2026

Time: 8:00 PM – 8:30 PM

Location: Microsoft Teams (Virtual Meeting)

MINUTES PRESENT:

Resham Furqan

Maria Waheed

Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba

Natalee De Silva

APOLOGIES:

Blessed Dendere

ABSENT:

None

1. CALL TO ORDER / OPENING REMARKS

The meeting was called to order at 2:00 PM by Resham Furqan (Project Manager).

The purpose of the meeting was to begin analysing the usability testing results for the HelpEra application and assign responsibilities for completing Worksheet 10: Analysis of Results.

2. APPROVAL OF THE AGENDA

Motion: To approve the agenda as circulated.

Motion By: Resham Furqan

Seconded By: Natalee De Silva

Carried.

Resolution: The meeting agenda was approved.

3. BUSINESS ARISING OUT OF THE PREVIOUS MEETING

a. The team confirmed that usability testing had been successfully completed.

b. Initial observations and feedback from participants were briefly discussed, highlighting the need for structured analysis and documentation.

4. ITEM #1 TO BE DISCUSSED – Allocation of Analysis Sections

a. Summary of Discussion

The team reviewed all required sections for Worksheet 10 and assigned responsibilities accordingly:

- **Participant Demographics:** Assigned to Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba, who will compile participant data from all testing sessions.
- **Team Roles During Testing:** Completed by Resham Furqan, with the table already included in the document.
- **Task Completion Results:** Assigned to Maria Waheed and Blessed Dendere, who will collaboratively analyse task success rates, errors, and performance metrics.
- **A/B Testing Results:** Assigned to Natalee De Silva, who will compare Version A and Version B and identify user preferences and performance differences.
- **Key Findings and Themes:** To be completed collaboratively by all team members through group discussion and synthesis of insights.
- **Prioritized Issues:** Assigned to Resham Furqan, who will identify and rank usability issues based on severity and impact.
- **Recommendations for Improvement:** To be completed collaboratively by all team members based on analysed findings.

Natalee ensured that all responsibilities were clearly documented and that each member understood their assigned section.

b. Motion

No formal motion was required.

c. Follow-Up Required

All team members are required to complete their assigned sections before the next meeting to ensure timely submission of the worksheet.

d. Action

Kekweditse Mogoba to compile participant demographics data.

Maria Waheed and Blessed Dendere to complete task completion analysis.

Natalee De Silva to complete A/B testing comparison.

Resham Furqan to finalise prioritized issues.

All team members to contribute to key findings and recommendations.

Resham Furqan to compile, refine, and format the final document.

5. ITEM #2 TO BE DISCUSSED – Approach to Data Analysis

a. Summary of Discussion

The team discussed how to approach analysing usability testing data. It was agreed that both qualitative and quantitative data would be used to generate meaningful insights.

Quantitative data includes task success rates, time-on-task, and error rates, while qualitative data includes participant feedback, think-aloud comments, and observed behaviours.

The team agreed to focus on identifying patterns, common user difficulties, and differences between Version A and Version B to support design decisions.

b. Motion

No formal motion was required.

c. Follow-Up Required

Team members will ensure consistency in analysis methods across all sections.

d. Action

All members to align their analysis with agreed metrics and usability goals.

6. ADJOURNMENT

The meeting was adjourned at 8:30 PM by the Project Manager.

7. NEXT MEETING

The next meeting will focus on the handoff report and finalising the usability findings for submission.

DISTRIBUTION OF MINUTES

The minutes will be reviewed and finalised by Natalee De Silva before being shared with the team within one week.

UXplorers – Minutes of Meeting – Worksheet 11

Name of Organisation/Committee/Board: UXplorers Team – HelpEra Project

Day & Date: Tuesday, 24th March 2026

Time: 8:30 – 9:10 PM

Location: Microsoft Teams (Virtual Meeting)

MINUTES PRESENT:

Resham Furqan

Maria Waheed

Kekweditse Mogoshadi Mogoba

Natalee De Silva

APOLOGIES:

Blessed Dendere

ABSENT:

None

1. CALL TO ORDER / OPENING REMARKS

The meeting was called to order at 2:00 PM by Resham Furqan (Project Manager).

Opening remarks focused on preparing and finalising the Handoff Report for the HelpEra application, ensuring that the design system, user flows, and development considerations were clearly documented for future implementation.

During the meeting, Natalee De Silva (Figma and Documentation Leader) guided the team through the structure of the handoff report and facilitated discussion using a collaborative FigJam board. Team members contributed ideas and content for each section, while Natalee documented inputs in real time and ensured consistency in how responses were structured.

It was agreed that all brainstormed content would be refined and formally compiled into the final document after the meeting.

2. APPROVAL OF THE AGENDA

Motion: To approve the agenda as circulated.

Motion By: Resham Furqan
Seconded By: Natalee De Silva

Carried.

Resolution: The meeting agenda was approved.

3. BUSINESS ARISING OUT OF THE PREVIOUS MEETING

a. The team confirmed completion of usability testing and previous documentation tasks.

b. It was agreed that the next step was to prepare a comprehensive handoff report, including design specifications, system structure, and future development considerations.

4. ITEM #1 TO BE DISCUSSED – Design System

a. Summary of Discussion

The team discussed the design system used in the HelpEra application, focusing on consistency, accessibility, and emotional comfort.

Key elements included:

• **Color System:**

Soft, calming colours were selected to promote emotional safety, with subtle accent tones used to guide attention and highlight system status.

• **Space Guidelines:**

Consistent margins, padding, and alignment were applied across all screens. Elements such as headers, text blocks, and interactive components were evenly spaced to reduce clutter and improve readability.

• **Typography:**

The team acknowledged the need to finalise typography choices to ensure readability and accessibility, especially for emotionally sensitive contexts.

The overall goal of the design system is to maintain a clean, structured, and calming interface that supports users experiencing stress or emotional difficulty.

b. Motion

No formal motion required.

d. Action

Kekweditse and Natalee De Silva will work on the documentation. Natalee De Silva will compile and organise all sections into the final handoff report document.

5. ITEM #2 TO BE DISCUSSED – Components and Assets

a. Summary of Discussion

The team reviewed all interactive components and UI elements used in the application to ensure consistency and usability.

These included:

• Primary and secondary action buttons (e.g., Login, Save, Cancel)
• Confirmation and decision buttons
• Emotion selection buttons for check-ins
• Navigation elements (sidebar and bottom navigation bar)
• Interactive learning and content buttons

• Communication icons (chat, call, transcription, reporting)
• Search and filter tools
• Journal interaction and sharing features
• Profile, settings, and support icons

The team ensured that all components follow a consistent visual hierarchy and support intuitive interaction across the app.

b. Motion

No formal motion required.

c. Follow-Up Required

Ensure all components are consistently labelled and documented in the worksheet.

d. Action

Natalee De Silva will compile and organise all sections into the final handoff report document.

6. ITEM #3 TO BE DISCUSSED – Hierarchical Task Analysis (HTA)

a. Summary of Discussion

The team discussed the Hierarchical Task Analysis (HTA), which outlines how users interact with the HelpEra application step-by-step.

Key user flows discussed included:

• Startup and login process
• Emotional check-in flow
• Homepage and navigation system
• Learning modules and guides
• Community interaction (public, private, and group chats)
• Professional support access
• Journal tracking and sharing
• EraBot chatbot interaction

• Profile and settings management
• Emergency support via SOS feature

These flows demonstrate how the app supports users in managing their mental health while maintaining flexibility and user control.

b. Motion

No formal motion required.

c. Follow-Up Required

The HTA diagram requires further refinement and visual representation.

d. Action

Natalee De Silva will develop and finalise the HTA diagram for inclusion in the handoff report.

7. ITEM #4 TO BE DISCUSSED – Developer Instructions

a. Summary of Discussion

The team discussed future development considerations for transitioning the prototype into a functional application.

These considerations ensure that HelpEra can evolve into a reliable, scalable, and ethically responsible platform.

b. Motion

No formal motion required.

c. Follow-Up Required

Ensure all development considerations are clearly structured and aligned with industry practices.

d. Action

Kekweditse and Natalee De Silva will work on the documentation. Natalee De Silva will compile and organise all sections into the final handoff report document.

8. ADJOURNMENT

The meeting was adjourned at 9:10 PM by the Project Manager.

DISTRIBUTION OF MINUTES

The minutes will be reviewed and finalised by Natalee De Silva before being shared with the team.

Following the meeting, all brainstormed content from the FigJam board was refined, structured, and compiled into the final handoff report document by Natalee.

A copy of the minutes will be stored as part of the HelpEra project documentation.

Appendix E: Toggl Reports

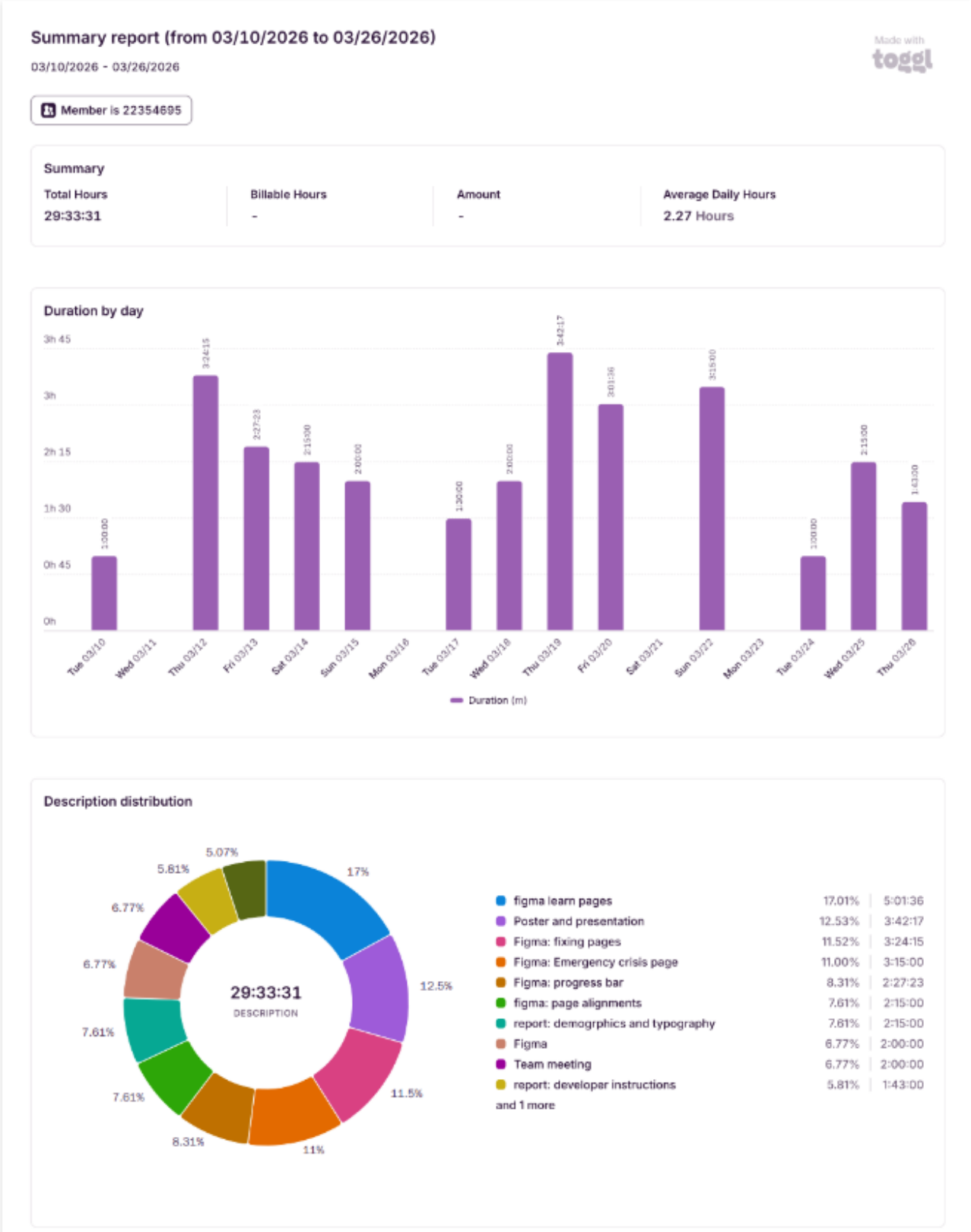


Figure 75: Keke (i)

Made with toggl

Description and member breakdown

DESCRIPTION | MEMBER	DURATION	DURATION %
Figma (1)	2:00:00	6.77%
22354695	2:00:00	6.77%
figma learn pages (1)	5:01:36	17.01%
22354695	5:01:36	17.01%
Figma: Emergency crisis page (1)	3:15:00	11%
22354695	3:15:00	11%
Figma: fixing pages (1)	3:24:15	11.52%
22354695	3:24:15	11.52%
figma: page alignments (1)	2:15:00	7.61%
22354695	2:15:00	7.61%
Figma: progress bar (1)	2:27:23	8.31%
22354695	2:27:23	8.31%
Poster (1)	1:30:00	5.07%
22354695	1:30:00	5.07%
Poster and presentation (1)	3:42:17	12.53%
22354695	3:42:17	12.53%

Figure 76: Keke (ii)

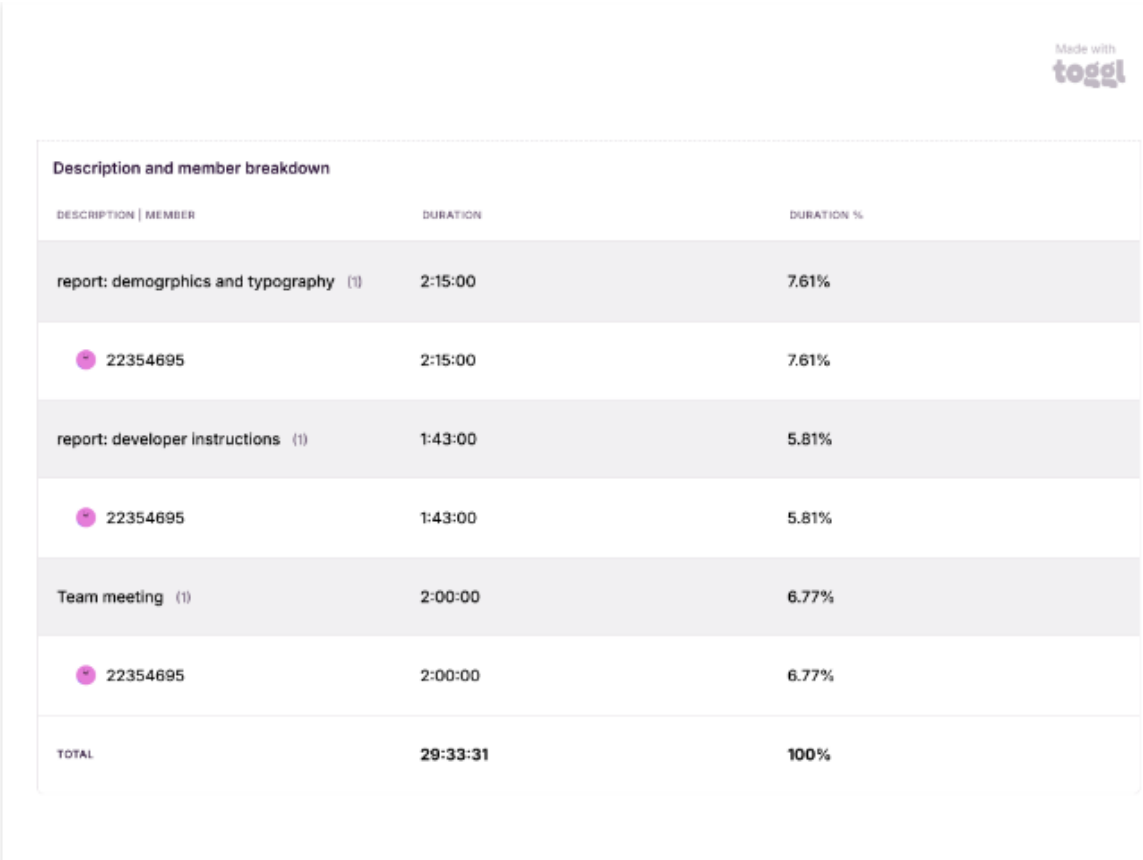


Figure 77: Keke (iii)

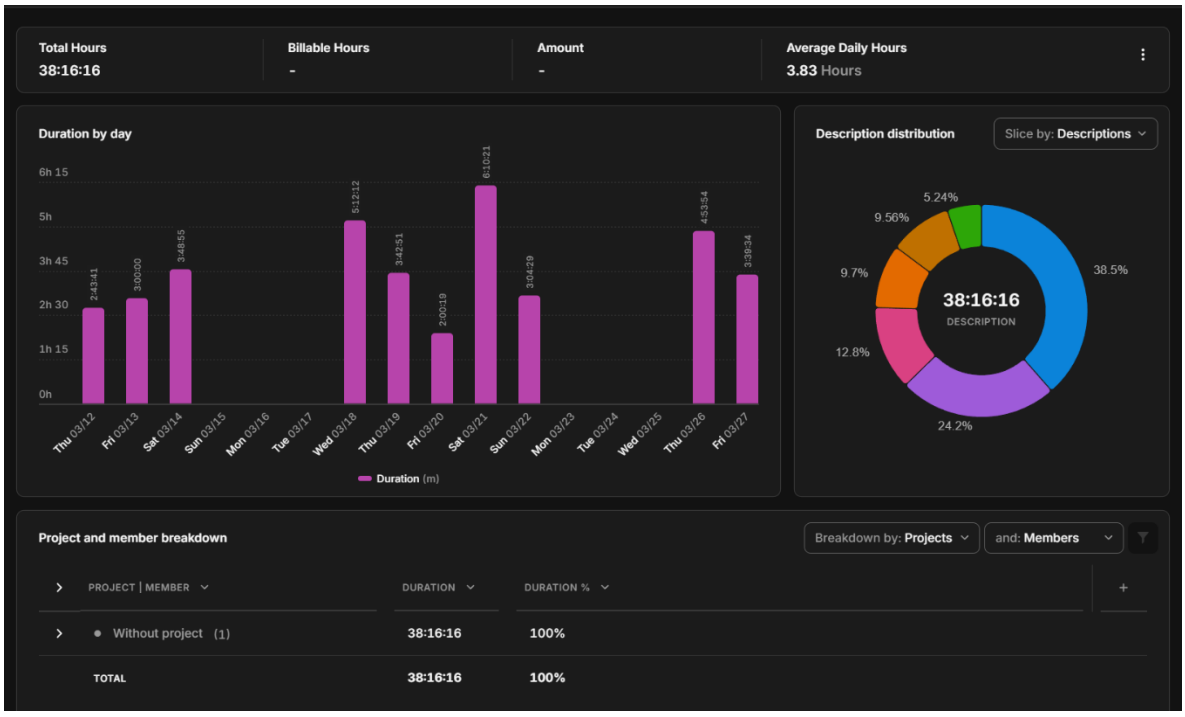


Figure 78: Blessed

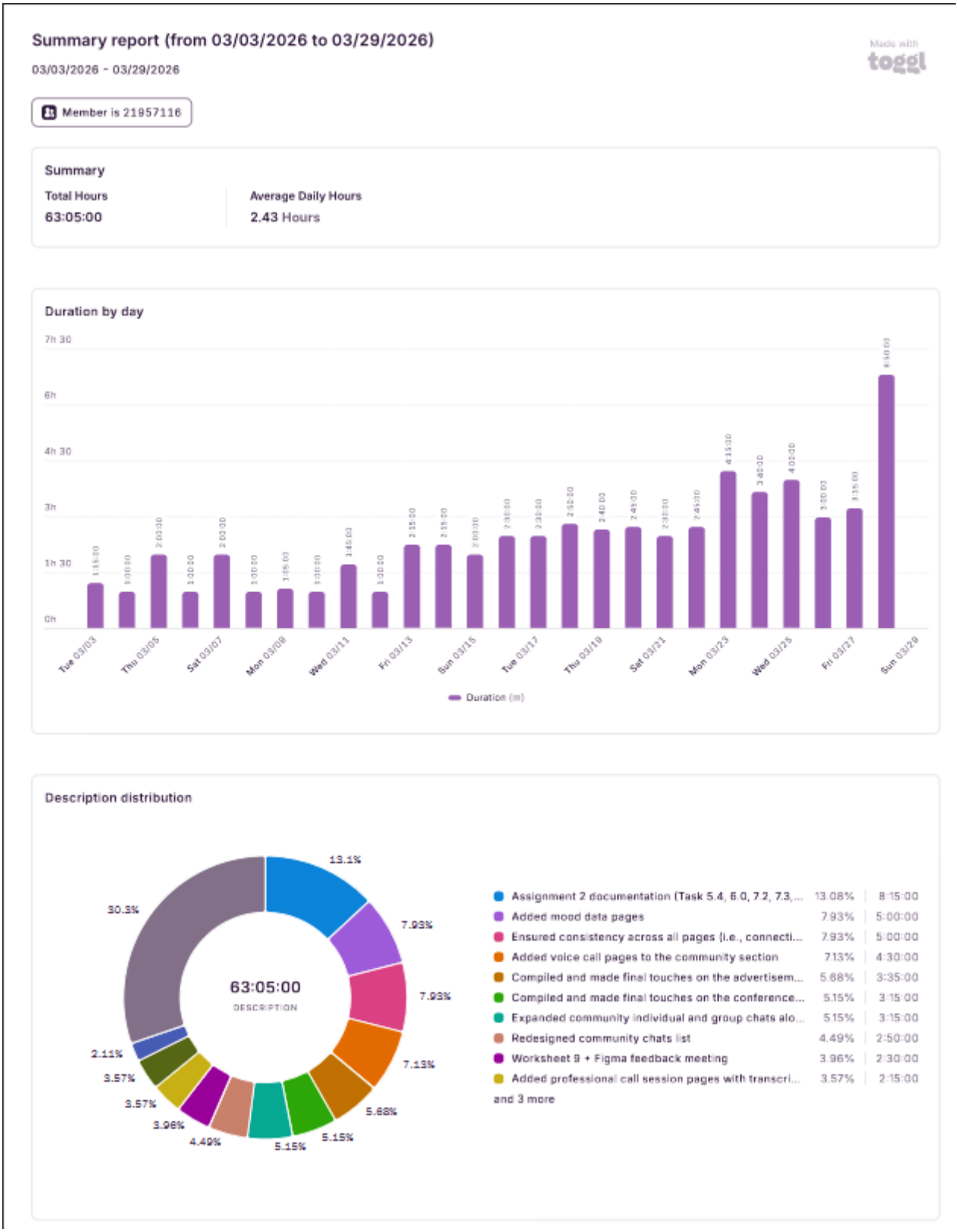


Figure 79: Natalee (i)

Project and description breakdown

PROJECT | DESCRIPTION	DURATION	DURATION %
• UXplorers (36)	63:05:00	100%
Added a display text slider feature into settings	0:45:00	1.19%
Added checkboxes in the gentle support response page	0:45:00	1.19%
Added contact support into the settings page	0:15:00	0.4%
Added descriptions and navigation tabs to the hotline pages	1:00:00	1.59%
Added mood data pages	5:00:00	7.93%
Added professional call session pages with transcription feature	2:15:00	3.57%
Added share journal and progress pop-up feature	0:45:00	1.19%
Added terms & conditions page	0:50:00	1.32%
Added voice call pages to the community section	4:30:00	7.13%
Added voice messages and a transcription feature to community chat pages	2:15:00	3.57%
Assignment 2 documentation (Task 5.4, 6.0, 7.2, 7.3, 7.4, and 7.5)	8:15:00	13.08%
Compiled and made final touches on the advertisement poster	3:35:00	5.68%
Compiled and made final touches on the conference poster	3:15:00	5.15%
Connected "Add Photos" pop-up to the attachment icon in all the report pages	0:30:00	0.79%
Connected expanded emergency call pages to the hotline call icons	0:15:00	0.4%

Figure 80: Natalee (ii)

Project and description breakdown

PROJECT | DESCRIPTION	DURATION	DURATION %
Created updated HTA diagram	1:00:00	1.59%
Ensured consistency across all pages (i.e., connections, alignment, spacing, typography, color usage, etc.).	5:00:00	7.93%
Expanded community individual and group chats along with call pages	3:15:00	5.15%
Minutes of meeting - Worksheet 10	1:00:00	1.59%
Minutes of meeting - Worksheet 11	1:00:00	1.59%
Minutes of meeting - Worksheet 7	1:00:00	1.59%
Minutes of meeting - Worksheet 8	1:00:00	1.59%
Minutes of meeting - Worksheet 9	1:00:00	1.59%
Redesigned community chats list	2:50:00	4.49%
Redesigned journal sidebar menu	0:30:00	0.79%
Redesigned profile page	0:30:00	0.79%
Refined privacy resources and FAQs contents	1:20:00	2.11%
Worked on advertisement poster	0:45:00	1.19%
Worked on conference poster	1:15:00	1.98%
Worked on Curtin ignition	1:00:00	1.59%
Worksheet 10 meeting	0:30:00	0.79%

Figure 81: Natalee (iii)

Made with toggl

Project and description breakdown

PROJECT | DESCRIPTION	DURATION	DURATION %
Worksheet 11 compilation	0:30:00	0.79%
Worksheet 11 meeting	0:40:00	1.06%
Worksheet 7 meeting	1:15:00	1.98%
Worksheet 8 meeting	1:05:00	1.72%
Worksheet 9 + Figma feedback meeting	2:30:00	3.96%
TOTAL	**63:05:00**	**100%**

Figure 82: Natalee (iv)

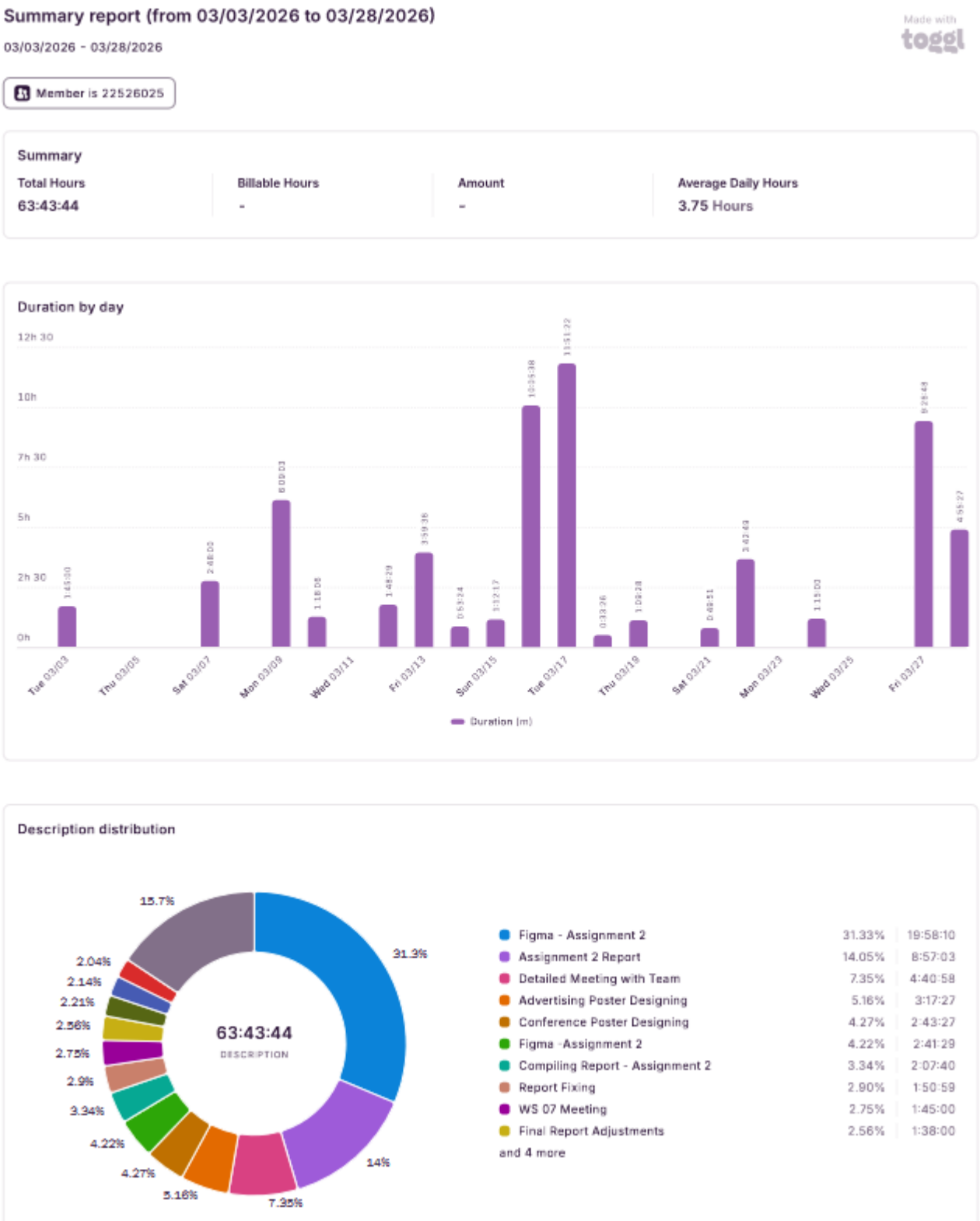


Figure 83: Resham (i)

Description and member breakdown

DESCRIPTION | MEMBER	DURATION	DURATION %
Adding data Sheets - Report Assignment 2 (1)	0:56:12	1.47%
22526025	0:56:12	1.47%
Advertising Poster (1)	0:26:01	0.68%
22526025	0:26:01	0.68%
Advertising Poster Designing (1)	3:17:27	5.16%
22526025	3:17:27	5.16%
Assignment 2 Report (1)	8:57:03	14.05%
22526025	8:57:03	14.05%
Compiling Report - Assignment 2 (1)	2:07:40	3.34%
22526025	2:07:40	3.34%
Complinig WS 09 (1)	1:24:40	2.21%
22526025	1:24:40	2.21%
Conference Poster (1)	0:23:50	0.62%
22526025	0:23:50	0.62%
Conference Poster Designing (1)	2:43:27	4.27%
22526025	2:43:27	4.27%

Figure 84: Resham (ii)

Description and member breakdown

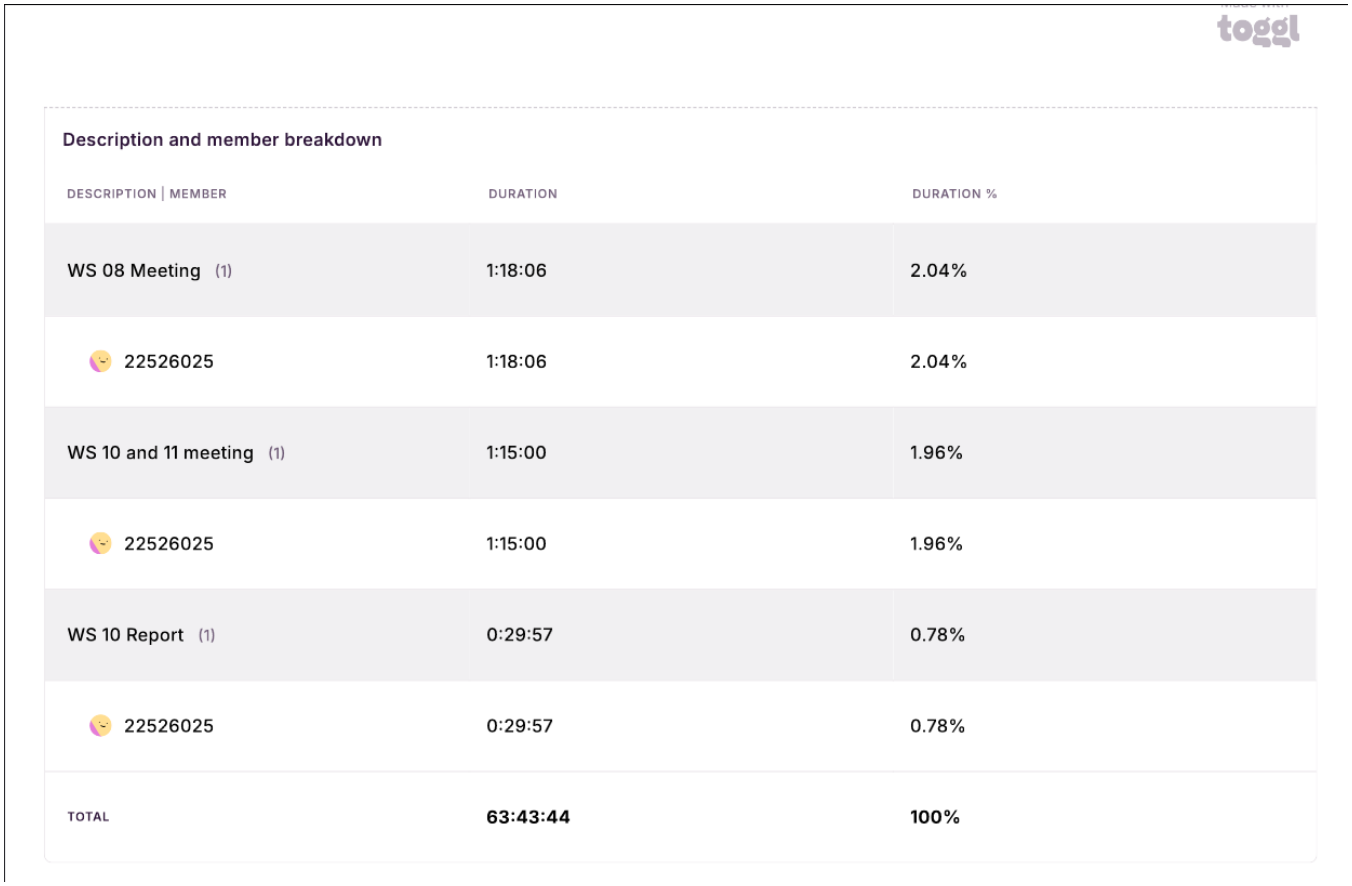
DESCRIPTION | MEMBER	DURATION	DURATION %
Detailed Meeting with Team (1)	4:40:58	7.35%
22526025	4:40:58	7.35%
Figma - Assigment 2 (1)	0:53:24	1.4%
22526025	0:53:24	1.4%
Figma - assignment 2 (1)	1:07:02	1.75%
22526025	1:07:02	1.75%
Figma - Assignment 2 (1)	19:58:10	31.33%
22526025	19:58:10	31.33%
Figma -Assignment 2 (1)	2:41:29	4.22%
22526025	2:41:29	4.22%
Final Report Adjustments (1)	1:38:00	2.56%
22526025	1:38:00	2.56%
Individual Feedback (1)	0:40:26	1.06%
22526025	0:40:26	1.06%
Posters Task Allocation (1)	0:39:30	1.03%
22526025	0:39:30	1.03%

Figure 85: Resham (iii)

Description and member breakdown

DESCRIPTION | MEMBER	DURATION	DURATION %
Preparing meeting agenda after receiving feedback (1)	0:59:06	1.55%
22526025	0:59:06	1.55%
Report (1)	1:08:46	1.8%
22526025	1:08:46	1.8%
Report 2 (1)	0:10:00	0.26%
22526025	0:10:00	0.26%
Report - Assignmnet 2 (1)	0:24:01	0.63%
22526025	0:24:01	0.63%
Report Compiling - Assignment 2 (1)	1:21:57	2.14%
22526025	1:21:57	2.14%
Report Fixing (1)	1:50:59	2.9%
22526025	1:50:59	2.9%
Team Review Agreement (1)	0:25:33	0.67%
22526025	0:25:33	0.67%
WS 07 Meeting (1)	1:45:00	2.75%
22526025	1:45:00	2.75%

Figure 86: Resham (iv)



Description and member breakdown

DESCRIPTION | MEMBER	DURATION	DURATION %
WS 08 Meeting (1)	1:18:06	2.04%
22526025	1:18:06	2.04%
WS 10 and 11 meeting (1)	1:15:00	1.96%
22526025	1:15:00	1.96%
WS 10 Report (1)	0:29:57	0.78%
22526025	0:29:57	0.78%
TOTAL	**63:43:44**	**100%**

Figure 87: Resham (v)

Summary report (from 03/02/2026 to 03/29/2026)

03/02/2026 - 03/29/2026

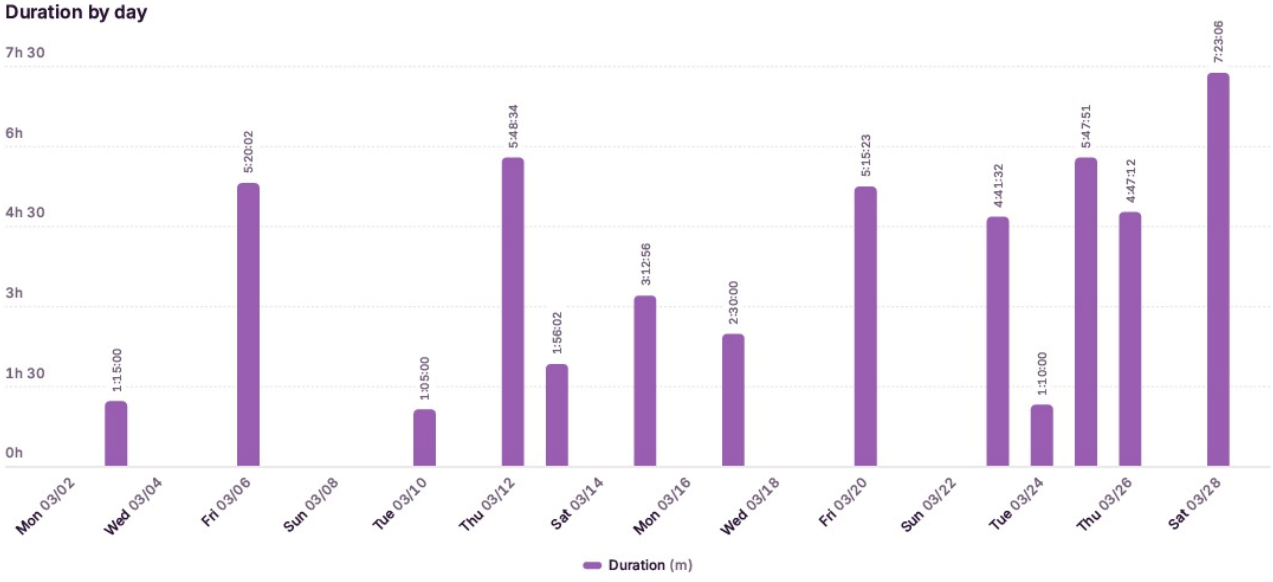
Made with toggl

Member is Maria Waheed

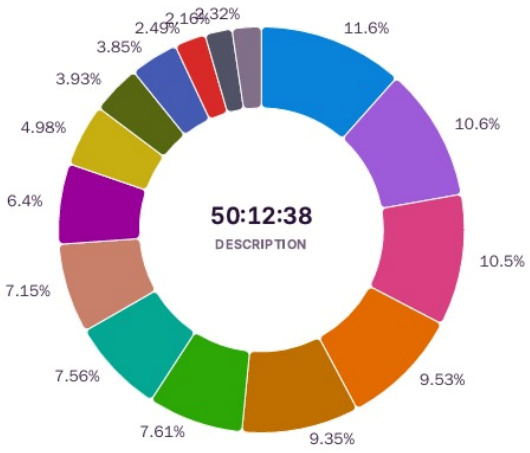
Summary

Total Hours	Billable Hours	Amount	Average Daily Hours
50:12:38	-	-	3.86 Hours

Duration by day



Description distribution



Hotline Call Pages and Poster content	11.57%	5:48:34
Made My Progress page interactive: Add notes, Add...	10.62%	5:20:02
Compiled data collection sheets and modified my jo...	10.47%	5:15:23
Both Posters content: Key features and user research	9.53%	4:47:12
Created My Journal Guide Pages modified My progr...	9.35%	4:41:32
Final editing and modifying of figma pages	7.61%	3:49:24
Individual Report	7.56%	3:47:43
Poster editing	7.15%	3:35:23
Created Interactive Keyboard	6.40%	3:12:56
Worksheet 9 Meeting	4.98%	2:30:00

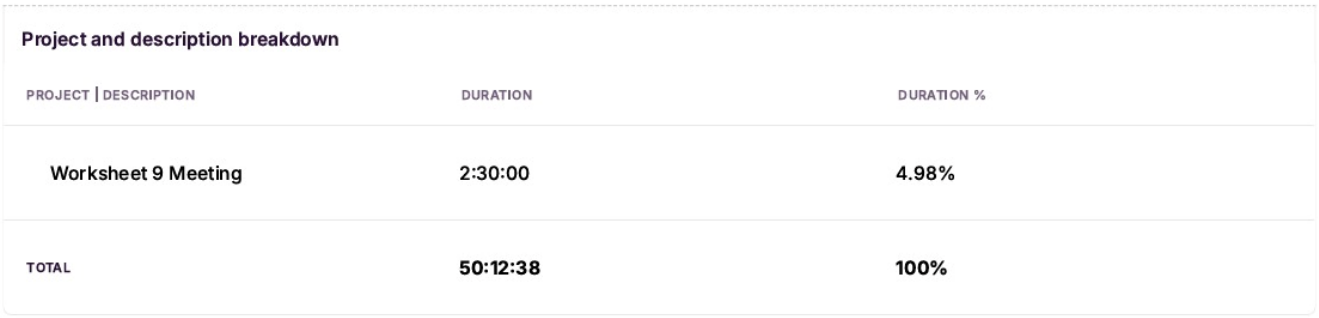
and 5 more

Figure 88: Maria (i)

Project and description breakdown

PROJECT | DESCRIPTION	DURATION	DURATION %
UXplorers (16)	50:12:38	100%
Both Posters content: Key features and user research	4:47:12	9.53%
Compiled data collection sheets and modified my journal page	5:15:23	10.47%
Created Interactive Keyboard	3:12:56	6.4%
Created My Journal Guide Pages modified My progress page	4:41:32	9.35%
Curtin Ignition Form	1:58:27	3.93%
Final editing and modifying of figma pages	3:49:24	7.61%
Fixed alignment and images in the hotline call pages	1:56:02	3.85%
Hotline Call Pages and Poster content	5:48:34	11.57%
Individual Report	3:47:43	7.56%
Made My Progress page interactive: Add notes, Add photos	5:20:02	10.62%
Poster editing	3:35:23	7.15%
Worksheet 11 Meeting	0:40:00	1.33%
Worksheet 10 Meeting	0:30:00	1%
Worksheet 7 Meeting	1:15:00	2.49%
Worksheet 8 Meeting	1:05:00	2.16%

Figure 89: Maria (ii)



Project and description breakdown

PROJECT | DESCRIPTION	DURATION	DURATION %
Worksheet 9 Meeting	2:30:00	4.98%
TOTAL	50:12:38	100%

Figure 90: Maria (iii)

Appendix F: Curtin Ignition Application

Curtin Ignition 2021 Application - Perth

Start of Block: Default Question Block

Welcome to the Curtin Ignition 2021 Application – Perth

This application should take you no more than 40 minutes to complete. Instructions and information

We advise you to please attend an information session prior to completing this form. Dates are available on our website - Curtin Ignition.

All applicants to Ignition must complete this form. Please be aware that if you are applying for a scholarship places are highly competitive and award will be made based on the written information you provide in this form only, no other documentary information will be accepted.

For ALL applicants the information you provide in this form will be used to assess your business/concept's suitability for the Curtin Ignition program. We ask for personal information as well as details of your new business/concept, please be aware that this information will be treated in the strictest confidence and complies with Curtin University privacy policy.

As you progress your application please be aware it can be saved and will stay 'live' from the time you commence the form. Use the arrows at the bottom of the page to move backwards and forwards through the form. Please contact us on 08 9266 4555 if you have any problems.

Scholarship applications close 5pm Friday 16th July

Full Fee Paying applications close 5pm Wednesday 28th July

Late applications will not be accepted

What is your full name?

(As you wish it to appear on your Ignition certificate e.g. Jonathon Smith)

First name (1) Resham

Last name (2) Furqan

What is your preferred name?

(As you wish it to appear on your Ignition name badge e.g. Jon Smith)

Resham

Email address

Email (1) 22526025@student.curtin.edu.au

Confirm email (2) 22526025@student.curtin.edu.au

Contact numbers

Mobile (1) +971 50 232 8219

Address (mailing address)

Address (1) Curtin University Dubai

Suburb (2) Dubai International Academic City

State (3) Dubai

Postal code (4) 00000

Gender: How do you identify

- Female (1)
- Male (2)
- Prefer not to answer (4)
- Not listed (3)

Are you an Australian Resident?

Please check on the Australian Taxation Website if you are unsure.

- Yes (1)
- No (2)

If you were not born in Australia, please indicate your country of birth (for statistical purposes only):

Pakistan

Do you identify as of Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander descent?

- Yes (1)
- No (2)

Education

Indicate below the highest level of your education to date:

- High school (1)
- TAFE, trade, or VET certificate (2)
- Undergraduate degree (3)
- Postgraduate degree (4)
- PHD (6)
- Other (5)

How did you find out about the Perth Curtin Ignition Program?

- Referral from previous delegate - Please indicate name (1)
- Referral from a business - Please indicate name (2)
- Web search (3)
- Information session (4)
- Curtin Ignition Alumni Event (5)
- Expo / Scholarship / Open Day etc (6)
- Radio - Please indicate station (7)
- Newspaper - Please indicate which paper (8)
- Other - Please indicate (9) BlackBoard

Are you a Curtin University:

- Staff (Please insert your staff ID) (1)
- Current Student (Please insert your student ID) (2)
- Alumni (Please insert your student ID) (3)
- None of the above (this will not impact your application) (4)

Will you be applying for Credit for Recongnised Learning (CRL) for the MBA, MIBE or other?

(We will contact you for further information)

- Yes (1)
- No (2)

Which of the following best describes you?

- I am applying as an individual (1)
- I am applying as an academic (2)
- I am representing an established business (3)

Business details (if applicable):

Business name (1) HelpEra

Website address (2) _

Business Address (3) _

Is this business the entity through which you plan to commercialize your concept/idea?

- Yes (1)
- No (2)

What is your title?

Project Manager

Your Business Idea / Innovation

To be eligible to apply for Curtin Ignition you must choose ONE specific business idea/project to work on over the duration of the program.
Please describe the problem that you are solving and why it needs to be solved.
(maximum 700 characters)

Many people, especially students and young adults, struggle to access reliable and immediate mental health support when they are feeling stressed, anxious, or overwhelmed. Traditional support options such as therapy or counselling can involve long waiting times, high costs, or limited availability. In addition, some individuals hesitate to seek help due to stigma or fear of judgment. As a result, many people do not receive the support they need at the right time. There is a clear need for a more accessible, private, and user-friendly solution that helps individuals manage their mental health and connect with appropriate support when they need it.

Please describe your solution/business idea/innovation that you have devised?

(maximum 1000 characters)

HelpEra is an online mental health support, aimed at young adults and university students who require emotional help on an early stage but do not use professional assistance at the moment. The platform incorporates mood monitoring, journaling, breathing exercises, and educational mental health content into a single available mobile app. HelpEra emphasizes on prevention, self-awareness, and peer support instead of clinical treatment only. The site also offers access to emergency support and resources to assist friends and family on behalf of someone in emotional distress. HelpEra is innovative in its approach to integrating self-reflection tools, guided help, and mental health education into a central user-friendly system and decreasing the stigma as well as promoting early intervention. The overall business potential is the collaboration with universities, wellness programs, and organizations that are concerned with student wellbeing and mental health awareness.

Please outline your target market.

(maximum 250 characters)

Our target audience was comprised of young adults aged 18 to 25, namely university students, graduates and early career individuals. After careful evaluation and consideration, we decided on this age group as this group has high involvement with digital technology but are also the most susceptible to mental sickness including, but not limited to, anxiety, stress and fatigue.

Who are your competitors for your idea/startup, and why will people choose your solution over others? If you believe there are no competitors, what are people currently doing to solve the problem (substitutes)?

(maximum 250 words)

While investigating our competitors, we singled out TalkLife and 7Cups. While these apps are statistically great, they do not provide as wide a variety as our app does. HelpEra focuses on more than just peer support, but also provides structured guidance, mood tracking and a personalized support system, providing the user with a more interactive and user-centred mental health experience.

Where are you on the road to commercialisation?

For example: is it just an idea, have you developed a business plan and identified a marketing opportunity, do you have revenue or are you looking for major funding?

(maximum 250 characters)

Help Era has reached its Prototype stage in the commercialization process, with a validated concept, completed user research, and a finished UX design. We have found evidence that there is a defined market opportunity and are now developing the product and pursuing potential funding.

How do you see your business, idea or innovation developing over the next year?

(maximum 250 characters)

In the next year, Help Era plans to complete the development of our App, including user testing of actual users, further refining of functionality, and establishing partnerships with mental health professionals in order to launch an App that is scalable and ready for market.

What do you want to achieve by attending Ignition 2021?

(maximum 250 characters)

By attending Ignition, I hope to move beyond simply having an idea and begin shaping it into a viable venture. Developing an idea independently is exciting but limiting, and I'm eager to challenge my assumptions, test my thinking, and refine the concept with guidance from experienced founders, mentors, and peers who understand the realities of building a business. I'm particularly interested in learning how to evaluate whether the problem I'm solving is meaningful and whether my solution creates real value. Ignition's structured approach to exploring opportunities, validating ideas, and developing a business model feels like the ideal environment to critically assess the foundations of my concept.

Beyond refining the idea, I hope to gain a deeper understanding of the entrepreneurial process from identifying a target market and testing assumptions to developing a sustainable model and thinking strategically about growth. I'm also excited to collaborate with other aspiring entrepreneurs, as these conversations often spark insights you can't reach alone. Ultimately, I want to leave Ignition not just with knowledge, but with clarity: a stronger sense of whether this idea could be impactful and sustainable, and a clear roadmap for developing and launching it.

Most importantly, I want to live with stronger entrepreneurial thinking, which is the ability to question assumptions, approach problems creatively, and build solutions that are innovative, practical, and grounded in real-world needs. I also hope to gain the confidence and resilience needed to navigate the inevitable challenges of turning an idea into a real, lasting venture.

If you are applying for Ignition as part of a team (ie 2 or more people from the same business will attend Ignition) please indicate below. Please note: only one person per business will be eligible for consideration for a scholarship - the second person will be required to complete an application also and to pay full program cost.

- I am applying as part of a team (maximum 2 people) who will attend Ignition together and work on the same project - please insert name of other person below - This person also

needs to complete an application and indicate that they are part of a team. (1)

- I will be attending Ignition on my own (2)

Which of the statements below applies to you?

- I will be paying for this program (1)
- I am applying for a fully funded scholarship (2)
- I would like to apply for a scholarship. If I am unsuccessful I may be interested in a paid position. (3)

Please indicate which scholarship(s) you are applying for:

Please read the scholarship eligibility criteria as listed after selecting scholarship, prior to answering this question (this criteria can be found on the Curtin Ignition Website). Please note that you are able to apply for more than one scholarship, however, only one scholarship will be offered per business (subsequent applicants from the same businesses will be expected to pay for the program). If you are unsuccessful in receiving a scholarship but your application to attend the program is approved by the panel, the same application will be converted to "self-funded", and you will have the option to fund yourself onto the program. *Please right click and open the below criteria's in a new webpage to avoid loosing any information in your application form.*

- City of Canning (Click HERE to view criteria) (1)
- City of Cockburn (Click HERE to view criteria) (15)
- City of Vincent (Click HERE to view criteria) (3)
- City of Wanneroo (Click HERE to view criteria) (4)
- Constable Care Foundation (Click HERE to view criteria) (17)
- Curtin Business School - Female (Click HERE to view criteria) (13)
- Curtin Business School - Indigenous (Click HERE to view criteria) (19)

- Curtin University - Commercialisation (Click HERE to view criteria) (5)
- Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development (Click HERE to view criteria) (7)
- Landgate (Click HERE to view criteria) (14)
- RSM (Click HERE to view criteria) (20)
- Startup News (Click HERE to view criteria) (21)
- Town of Victoria Park (Click HERE to view criteria) (9)
- The University of Western Australia (Click HERE to view criteria) (10)
- WA AustCyber Innovation Hub (Click HERE to view criteria) (8)
- Woodside (Click HERE to view criteria) (18)
- Wrays (Click HERE to view criteria) (22)

Industry Classification

- Accommodation and Food Services (1)
- Administrative and Support Services (2)
- Agriculture, Forestry and Fishing (3)
- Arts and Recreation Services (4)
- Construction (5)
- Education and Training (6)
- Electricity, Gas and Water and Waste Services (7)
- Financial and Insurance Services (8)
- Health Care and Social Assistance (9)
- Information Media and Telecommunications (including Gaming and Apps) (10)
- Manufacturing (11)
- Mining (12)
- Professional, Scientific and Technical Services (13)
- Public Administration and Safety (14)
- Rental, Hiring and Real Estate Services (15)
- Retail Trade (16)

- Transport Postal and Warehousing (17)
- Wholesale Trade (18)
- Other/unsure (19)

Please note that you will be expected to be available for all sessions for the full 5.5 days (Sunday 5 September to Friday 10 September 2021). Please mark your calendar with these dates now.

Please print name below to confirm.

I confirm that if I am successful in gaining a place on the Perth Curtin Ignition Program I will commit to attending all sessions.

Resham Furqan

We look forward to welcoming you to Curtin Ignition 2021 - Perth.

Receipt of your application will be acknowledged by email within 3 business days. Questions? Please contact us:

Phone: 08 9266 4555 (9:00am - 5:00pm Mon-Fri) Email: execed@curtin.edu.au

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End of Block: Default Question Block